



Anderson
School of Management

PairWell Marketplace Business Plan

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Prepared and Written by:

Guillermo Hernandez, Jenny Huang, Jordan Hutkin-Schwartz, Robert Morrison and Logan Wood

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Section I: Executive Summary

PairWell is a dual-sided marketplace platform designed to bridge the fragmented social impact ecosystem by efficiently connecting corporate donors with nonprofits in need of funding. Our mission is to transform charitable discovery from an inefficient, time consuming, and search heavy experience to a more efficient informed matching experience, fostering trust and propagating measurable impact by increasing the number and quality of corporate gifts.

The Concept and Product

PairWell's core innovation is an intelligent, push-based recommendation engine that moves beyond simple content matching to leverage collaborative similarity, connecting users to nonprofits they might not have otherwise discovered. The platform offers a unified ecosystem for:

- **Opportunity Discovery:** Nonprofits can feature specific projects, and donors are pushed recommendations aligned with their cause, geography, and desired impact.
- **Project Tracking & Transparency:** Built-in, clear progress tracking helps donors visualize their impact.
- **Engagement:** Tools for storytelling allow nonprofits to cultivate sustained donor relationships.
- **Unified Giving:** Starts with monetary donations, with plans to add in-kind donations and volunteer opportunities.

The Market and Opportunity

We are targeting the **U.S. corporate giving market (\$44.4 billion in 2024)**. This segment includes:

- **Corporate Donors:** Mid-sized businesses (\$50M - \$1B revenue) with 100–1,000 employees who lack the resources for enterprise CSR platforms and seek transparent, local, and measurable giving opportunities.
- **Nonprofits:** Small- to mid-sized organizations (\$500k to \$5M annual budget) that struggle with visibility and donor acquisition.

PairWell occupies a white space by offering an accessible, affordable CSR solution tailored for this mid-market segment, differentiating itself from enterprise-focused CSR platforms (e.g., Benevity) and transactional fundraising tools (e.g., GoFundMe).

Financials

The platform will operate on a monthly subscription model with three tiers (Core, Plus, Premium) for both sides. We forecast an annual revenue of over \$5M by the end of Year 5 and are seeking \$250,000 in an initial seed round

Milestones & Strategy

PairWell will begin operations by individually onboarding users in Southern California to leverage the founders' network and foster community-driven local investment. The next critical steps include hiring a full-time CTO and a web developer to complete the transition from prototype to MVP. We are starting with a partial vertical integration on the supply side of our market to attract donor users before launching a true two-sided platform. Successful initial adoption will then trigger national expansion, supported by cross-side network effects.

Section II: The Company

Brief Description

PairWell is a dual-sided marketplace platform that connects nonprofits in need of funding with the corporate donors who want to support them. PairWell proposes an intelligent push-based discovery algorithm, ease of use, and payment processing, providing nonprofits with a powerful platform to showcase and fund their projects. PairWell enhances discoverability and searchability while fostering trust between donors and nonprofits through verification and performance ratings. Additionally, PairWell empowers donors to make a meaningful impact by supporting organizations within their city or neighborhood, directly benefiting their local communities.

PairWell will begin operating in Southern California and eventually expand nationally. We will individually onboard nonprofit and donor users in Southern California due to our founders' network and familiarity with the region. Onboarding users by geographical location will foster investment by donors in their own community, which interviews showed us is a priority for companies. Further sales accompanied by cross-side network effects will generate national growth. PairWell's team is based in Southern California.

PairWell will be incorporated as a C Corporation and currently holds no assets or liabilities. We have five team members.¹ Our next step is to bring on a full-time CTO and a web developer to take PairWell from the prototype stage to an MVP.

Section III: The Opportunity

There is currently an unmet need in the giving ecosystem, and current solutions are siloed and fragmented.² Nonprofits struggle to raise sufficient funds because they lack visibility, discoverability, and tools to communicate their ongoing impact.^{3 4} Meanwhile, corporate donors face inefficiencies in finding trustworthy organizations that align with their values, location, and other desired impact areas.^{5 6} While there are several platforms that can help in these areas, it would require the use of multiple platforms to address these concerns, resulting in high costs, time-consuming efforts, underfunded projects, disengaged donors, and lost opportunities for meaningful partnerships.⁷

No single platform exists where nonprofits can create personalized profiles and donors are actively *pushed* recommendations of organizations to engage with, engagement and the payment process are facilitated through the platform (saving time and money), and donors can keep up with the nonprofits they donated to through readily available impact reports, tax acknowledgements, and progress tracking for funded projects.⁸ Furthermore, no platform allows nonprofits to feature specific projects in need of funding and puts those projects in front of donors through a push-based recommendation system.

PairWell's Competitive Advantage

PairWell's differentiation lies in connecting these adjacent silos. Instead of functioning as a single-purpose tool, PairWell is designed as a multi-sided platform built around a powerful push-based recommendation engine that connects corporate donors and nonprofits through

¹ See appendix for full team biographies.

² See appendix for Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis

³ William Chertok, interview by Logan Wood, 9/3/25

⁴ See appendix for Nonprofit and Donor Surveys Summary

⁵ Paul Popon, interview by Logan Wood, 8/1/25

⁶ See appendix for Nonprofit and Donor Surveys Summary

⁷ Michael Lima-Sabatini, interview by Jordan Hutkin-Schwartz, 11/4/25

⁸ See appendix for Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis

opportunity discovery, project tracking and transparency, platform engagement, multiple giving opportunities, accessible pricing, and certification. As we continue to grow and expand, cross-side network effects will help us expand nationally.

- Opportunity Discovery: Nonprofits can feature specific projects and funding needs; donors can filter by cause, geography, and impact area.⁹
- Project Tracking & Transparency: Built-in, visually clear progress tracking and reporting, helping donors visualize their impact over time.¹⁰
- Platform Engagement: Tools for storytelling allow nonprofits to foster authentic connections with corporate donors, allowing donors to stay in the loop with updates.
- Personalized Matching: Recommendations will be sent to donors via push-based notifications and email newsletters. These will be powered by our recommendation engine.
- Unified Platform for Multiple Giving Types: We will begin by connecting donors with nonprofits for monetary donations. We plan to include in-kind donations and volunteer opportunities in the future but have left it out in the initial product launch and financial model.¹¹
- Pairwell will offer verification of non-profits in core areas of performance to ensure donors can trust PairWell matches
- Accessible Pricing: Tiered subscriptions that scale with organizational appetite, lowering barriers for small to mid-sized participants.¹²
- Certification: Pairwell will seek registration and certification as a certified benefit corporation and commit to giving 1% of revenue to nonprofit organizations.

There are currently several converging trends that make this the ideal moment to launch PairWell, including the technology adoption, the generational shift in giving behavior, and corporate social responsibility growth.

- Technology Adoption: Digital philanthropy is accelerating, with online donations growing from 8% to 12% of nonprofits' total revenue in 2023.¹³
- Generational Shift: Millennials and Gen Z are becoming the largest donor demographic to value transparency, social proof, and measurable outcomes over traditional checkbook philanthropy. These donor demographics are more likely to engage in activities beyond donating money, including volunteering, fundraising, and mentorship.¹⁴
- Corporate Social Responsibility Growth: CSR spending has risen steadily from about \$40.7 billion in 2023 to \$44.4 billion in 2024, a 9.1% increase.¹⁵

Looking ahead, PairWell's long-term viability will be supported by three reinforcing trends: data-driven impact measurement, corporate-nonprofit partnerships, and community-driven brand value. With data-driven impact measurement, we can help organizations and donors access quantifiable data supporting their social impact goals, especially as the demand for real-time impact dashboards will continue to grow. This will also help facilitate corporate-nonprofit partnerships to continually grow and maintain these relationships. Lastly, we plan to offer the infrastructure for companies to integrate giving into their brand identity and employee engagement efforts.

⁹ See appendix for Algorithm Overview

¹⁰ Roger Castle, interview by Jenny Huang, 8/7/25

¹¹ See appendix for Nonprofit and Donor Surveys Summary

¹² See appendix on Van Westendorp results

¹³ <https://www.goharness.com/blog-posts/online-vs-offline-donor-trends>

¹⁴ <https://www.cnn.com/2024/10/10/wealthy-millennials-gen-z-are-redefining-philanthropy-.html>

¹⁵

<https://givingusa.org/giving-usa-2025-u-s-charitable-giving-grew-to-592-50-billion-in-2024-lifted-by-stock-market-gains/>

Section IV: The Market and Customer Segments

Market Research

Our team conducted over 80 hours of team research via interviews and prototype development. We interviewed 16 corporate professionals, 14 nonprofit professionals, and six industry experts and asked questions about their work and experience with fundraising or giving. We found that all of the corporate professionals we interviewed faced challenges with giving and 93% of the nonprofit staff we interviewed faced challenges with fundraising.

Our team also conducted two surveys for nonprofits and donors. Our nonprofit-side survey received 91 complete responses from full-time nonprofit professionals. The organizations they came from are of varying size, and respondents were from various departments including development, leadership, program management, finance, and marketing. Respondents answered a range of questions on fundraising challenges, focuses, and techniques. Our donor-side survey received 38 complete responses from full-time for-profit professionals. Respondents answered a range of questions on giving practices and challenges. Respondents on both sides answered questions about PairWell's product offerings and preferred features.. Summaries of both surveys are included in the Appendix¹⁶.

Willingness to Pay

Our research showed both sides are willing to pay for a beneficial product. 12 out of the 14 nonprofit professionals we interviewed are willing to pay for a product that will help them bring in money. 12 out of the 16 corporate professionals we interviewed are willing to pay for a product that will help them find and vet nonprofit organizations.

To complement the interview findings, we conducted a Van Westendorp price sensitivity analysis with screened respondents directly involved in giving and fundraising decisions. The results indicate clear and economically viable pricing ranges for both nonprofits and donors. For nonprofits, the acceptable monthly subscription range falls between \$60 and \$140, with an optimal price point of \$95. For donors, the acceptable monthly range is wider, from \$387 to \$540, with an optimal price point of \$450. These results validate that decision-makers perceive meaningful value in the platform and provide a data-driven foundation for our initial tiered pricing strategy. Full charts, intersection plots, and methodological details are included in the Appendix¹⁷.

Market and Opportunity

The U.S. corporate giving market represents a significant and expanding opportunity for PairWell, with total annual contributions reaching \$44.4 billion in 2024.¹⁸ While large and very large enterprises account for the majority of total giving, small- to mid-sized businesses represent a high-potential but underserved segment.

Research shows that 86% of total corporate giving (\$38 billion) comes from large corporations with 250+ employees, who typically use sophisticated CSR platforms such as Benevity, CyberGrants, or YourCause. In contrast, small- and mid-sized businesses, comprising over 840,000 U.S. firms, represent only 6% of total corporate giving despite being the vast majority by volume. We select mid-sized businesses (\$50M - \$1B revenue) with 100–1,000 employees who lack the resources for existing enterprise CSR platforms as our initial target market in order to build traction and deploy valuable features before moving to larger companies in attempts to supplant active competitors.

¹⁶ See Appendix on Donor and Nonprofit Survey Summary

¹⁷ See Appendix on Price Sensitivity Analysis

¹⁸

<https://givingusa.org/giving-usa-2025-u-s-charitable-giving-grew-to-592-50-billion-in-2024-lifted-by-stock-market-gains/>

These small to mid size businesses often lack the resources to manage structured giving programs or the tools to find trustworthy nonprofits that align with their values. PairWell aims to fill this gap by providing an accessible, affordable, and data-driven platform tailored to their needs, a CSR solution designed for mid-market donors and smaller nonprofits who currently operate outside the enterprise philanthropy ecosystem.

On the nonprofit side, the opportunity is equally strong. The U.S. is home to 1.51 million registered 501(c)(3) nonprofits, with organizations spending an average of 5.5% of total expenses on fundraising and a median of \$57,800 annually on marketing and donor engagement. This indicates a clear willingness to invest in visibility and donor acquisition: two pain points PairWell directly addresses through discovery tools, impact storytelling, and progress tracking.

Segmentation

Target Market and Early Adoption

PairWell's initial focus will be:

- Nonprofits: Small- to mid-sized organizations (annual budgets under \$5 million¹⁹) that may have or lack full-time fundraising or development teams but are motivated to attract new donors
 - By digital and partnership readiness:
 - Digitally capable / fundraising-oriented - primary early adopters
 - Traditional or low-digital-capacity - secondary phase
 - By geography: start in California (LA and Southern California) to leverage proximity and localized opportunities; expand nationally as we obtain traction and understand how to enter local markets
- Donors: Mid-sized businesses²⁰ (100 – 1,000 employees / \$50M - \$1B revenue) seeking purpose-driven giving opportunities that are transparent, local, and measurable²¹
 - By size: mid-sized businesses are defined as \$50 million and \$1 billion in annual revenue
 - By partnership readiness:
 - Emerging or Ad Hoc CSR Teams to establish market, targeting larger and smaller companies in later phases as product gains traction
 - Donors motivated to develop social impact strategies and desire measurable impact

By targeting this dual segment, PairWell occupies a white space between grassroots crowdfunding tools and enterprise CSR platforms, offering personalization, affordability, and verified impact.

After proof of the concept is accomplished and an initial group of users on both sides is onboarded, the target market can expand to a wider range of nonprofits and businesses. Large nonprofits have the capacity to spend time and money fundraising, so having a proven model will be beneficial to engage and onboard users from this group. Similarly, large businesses have resources to devote to philanthropy, and they also tend toward a more recognized public image, so they need to ensure that they align themselves with a reputable partner. Small businesses need a proven product because the subscription fee is a proportionally larger expense for them.

Our survey data also supports a focused donor strategy. Donor-side clustering revealed two clear segments based on pain points (low- vs. high-friction giving processes) and two segments based on feature preferences (high- vs. low-feature-value organizations). The most

¹⁹ Nonprofits by the numbers <https://www.nonprofitimpactmatters.org/data/downloadable-charts/>

²⁰ See Appendix on Businesses Segmentation - Gartner

²¹ See Appendix - Segmentation - Donor

attractive early adopters are the “high-pain, high-feature-value” donors: larger mid-market companies (100 – 1,000 employees / \$50M - \$1B revenue) and CSR teams that face substantial friction in discovery, verification, approvals, and reporting, and place the highest value on vetted nonprofit profiles, impact dashboards, and automated tax documentation. In contrast, smaller, low-friction, light-feature donors are better served through simpler, lower-touch tiers and can be targeted in later phases. Detailed clustering outputs and segment profiles are provided in the Appendix.²²

On the nonprofit side, segmentation identified three pain-level clusters and three feature-need clusters, ranging from low-friction, light-feature organizations to high-friction, enterprise-style development teams seeking advanced tools. The strongest near-term fit for PairWell is the middle group: small- to mid-sized nonprofits (\$500k to \$5M annual budget) with moderate operational pain but high interest in project-level funding pages, centralized impact reporting, and automation, organizations that feel real strain but lack the infrastructure of large national charities. High-pain, high-feature nonprofits represent a natural premium tier over time, while low-pain, light-feature nonprofits can be engaged through a basic or free tier to drive breadth of supply. Full nonprofit segmentation tables and the 2×2 positioning matrix are included in the Appendix.²³

Section V: The Competition

The Competition

At first glance, the social impact technology landscape appears crowded, with numerous platforms supporting CSR reporting, fundraising and donation efforts, and volunteering opportunities. However, most existing players operate in silos, meaning they address individual components of social giving rather than the full cycle of discovery, engagement, and impact tracking. PairWell differentiates itself by bridging these segments by offering a unified ecosystem that connects corporate donors and nonprofits.²⁴

We categorize competitors into three main groups based on their focus areas: CSR platforms, donation and fundraising platforms, and volunteer platforms. Below, we will analyze each category, including its gaps and weaknesses that we plan to address. Note that while volunteering opportunities is a feature we would like to incorporate in the future, we wanted to analyze the market now, based on interest in volunteering opportunities from our interviews.

Group One: CSR Platforms

The leading players in this space are Benevity, Bonterra (CyberGrants), YourCause (Blackbaud), Goodera, and Deed. CSR platforms allow businesses to plan, execute, and measure their social impact initiatives from donations and grants to volunteering. These platforms offer degrees of integration between employee engagement, nonprofit discovery, and donation management. However, this segment is heavily enterprise-oriented, often requiring high annual licensing costs and complex onboarding. This often excludes small to medium-sized businesses from accessing their platforms due to cost and complexity.²⁵ Additionally, many of these companies lack pricing transparency, with majority sources being third-parties reviewing each company’s features and pricing. Some have reported a minimum of \$5,000 annually²⁶ while interviews with customers have revealed that large providers like Benevity often charge upwards of \$100,000 per year.²⁷

²² See Appendix on Donor Clustering and Segmentation

²³ See Appendix on Nonprofit Clustering and Segmentation

²⁴ See appendix on Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis

²⁵ See appendix on Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis: CSR Platforms - Fees

²⁶ See appendix on Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis: CSR Platforms - Fees

²⁷ Maston McMahon, interview by Logan Wood, 11/2/25

While their value proposition centers around compliance, reporting, and employee engagement tools, there are still fragments in the landscape. Through our research, we have found that CSR platforms lack an internal rating system for nonprofits, a way to discover new projects that nonprofits are working on, and a tracking system to monitor project progress reporting. This creates a market gap where traditional players fail to make accessible solutions for small to medium-sized businesses, while also limiting the trust and transparency between the large corporations they work with and nonprofits. These platforms lack a robust system for nonprofits to feature specific projects or funding needs, communicate the progress of each project or fundraiser, and share their mission through storytelling.²⁸

Group Two: Donation and Fundraising Platforms

The leading players in this category are GoFundMe Pro (formerly Classy), GiveButter, GlobalGiving, Philanthropia, Charity Navigator, and GiveWell. These platforms provide ways for nonprofits and individuals to raise funds online, whether by providing infrastructure or a search engine. This is a mature and highly saturated market dominated by transactional giving through simplifying donation processing, campaign hosting, and donor engagement. Their focus varies widely, with some optimized for peer-to-peer fundraising and others for nonprofit verification and donor trust. Additionally, the pricing model varies between companies from \$0 to over \$1548 annually.²⁹ For example, GoFundMe Pro's Basic Plan starts at \$299 a month in addition to transaction fees for a variety of different features and services. While other companies, like Charity Navigator, are free, they operate primarily as a verification toll for specific aspects of a non-profit's operations.

While these platforms perform well in enabling fundraising efforts, they do fall short when it comes to ongoing partnership building and impact transparency. Tools built for transactional giving (e.g., GoFundMe, GiveButter) often lack depth in impact measurement and nonprofit discovery. Platforms that are focused on curation and ratings (e.g., Charity Navigator) lack the ability to progress track and maintain transparency between donors and nonprofits, as well as, community-building capabilities such as employee engagement and volunteering opportunities. Most solutions cater primarily to nonprofits or individual fundraisers, not corporate donors or CSR teams, creating a missed opportunity for cross-market collaboration.³⁰

Through our research, we have found that it is important for nonprofits to cultivate sustained donor relationships, which many of these platforms lack. We also learned that few platforms link donations to project progress or outcomes, hindering long-term impact assessment. This lack of transparency creates issues down the line, as we have seen with some platforms like GoFundMe, who are facing backlash from nonprofit organizations through their lack of verification and transparency.³¹ Lastly, because these platforms cater to different audiences and uses, the data gets siloed, making it more difficult to measure the full impact of initiatives.

Group Three: Volunteer Platforms

As mentioned earlier, volunteer management will not be part of the initial main features, however, we plan to incorporate it in the future. The market leaders are VolunteerMatch, GivePulse, Catchafire, Mobilize, and Golden Volunteer. Volunteer platforms connect individuals or corporations and nonprofits seeking volunteering support. They primarily focus on volunteer recruitment, event coordination, and engagement tracking. Each offers varying levels of functionality, and their approaches differ in scalability, audience focus, and integration depth. Some platforms focus more on nonprofits' end, helping nonprofits with setting up signups, logistics, and more. Other platforms operate more similarly to a job board, where organizations

²⁸ See appendix on Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis: CSR Platforms

²⁹ See appendix on Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis: Donation/Fundraising Platforms - Fees

³⁰ See appendix on Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis: Donation/Fundraising Platforms

³¹ <https://www.yahoo.com/news/articles/gofundme-faces-backlash-creating-donation-180016881.html>

can post their volunteer opportunities to the public, and individuals or other organizations can seek volunteer opportunities to sign up for.

While these platforms offer an array of capabilities depending on need, the market still remains fragmented and offers limited integrations into donation or CSR data streams. The platforms that focus on capabilities beyond simple volunteer opportunity postings cater toward larger nonprofits, often making it difficult for small and medium-sized nonprofits to access. Additionally, the major fragment in the market highlights that platforms either focus on enterprise volunteer programs or small-scale, individual opportunities, with few to none connecting both. Another weakness is regarding the data silos, where volunteering data rarely gets integrated with donation records or other social impact initiatives, making it difficult to fully access the total impact on both the nonprofit and corporate ends.³²

In summary, the current solutions for social impact initiatives remain vertically specialized, but horizontally disconnected across all three categories. CSR platforms manage internal reporting for large businesses but limit accessibility to small to medium-sized businesses due to cost and complexity. Donation and fundraising platforms simplify the donation process but do not support ongoing efforts in building and maintaining donor relationships. Volunteer platforms remain fragmented from the rest of the social impact funnel, making it difficult to access the full impact of initiatives. There is no existing solution that unifies these into one collaborative ecosystem.

Section VI: The Strategic Plan

Pricing

We plan to charge both sides of our platform a monthly subscription fee priced according to their respective willingness to pay, with three tiers corresponding to different feature sets: Core, Plus and Premium.

Both sides will receive a free subscription trial. Nonprofits will have a free trial of up to six months or upon the receipt of their first donation, whichever comes first. Donors will receive a free trial of one month or until they make their first donation, whichever comes first.

We plan to offer Nonprofit Core at \$49/month, Nonprofit Plus at \$94/month, and Nonprofit Premium at \$139/month. This represents a slightly conservative mapping to our Van Westendorp acceptable price range of \$60-\$140/month with an optimal price of \$94 for nonprofits³³.

The three nonprofit tiers offer the following services:

1. Core: Basic service, including presence and discoverability on PairWell search, feature in regular communications to donor users, facilitation of donation and progress tracking
2. Plus: Basic service plus enhanced visibility through features on PairWell home page, digest emails to relevant donors, and more
3. Premium: In addition to features of Plus service, PairWell will build a full profile, working individually with nonprofit representatives to ensure the profile is in best condition to enhance donor interest. Premium includes top industry-standard compliance features and a boost in the recommendation engine, ensuring maximum discoverability to a wide variety of potential donors. PairWell will also provide assistance with tax documentation.

We are also considering offering one-time services, including event support, volunteer management, employee crowdfunding, and enhanced visibility.

³² See appendix on Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis: Volunteer Platforms

³³ See appendix on Van Westendorp results

We plan to offer Donor Core at \$299/month, Donor Plus at \$449/month, and Donor Premium at \$680/month. This is a similarly conservative derivation of our analysis of donor willingness to pay which yielded an acceptable range of \$387-\$540/month with an optimal price of \$450³⁴ (the Premium pricing reflects an additional fee for enhanced compliance features which is why it exceeds the upper bound of our Van Westendorp analysis).

The three donor tiers offer the following services, segmented based on interviews with potential customers³⁵:

1. Core: Basic service, including discovery, verification, payment, and progress tracking
2. Plus: Features of Core service plus automatic tax documentation, and payment receipts, impact dashboard
3. Premium: Plus service plus employee engagement tools.

We are also considering offering higher-tier one-time services, including employee volunteer management, impact strategy consultation, and B Corp standards consultation.

The Product

PairWell is a dual-sided marketplace for nonprofits in need of funding and donors looking to support communities. Our target nonprofit users are small- to mid-sized nonprofits (\$500k to \$5M annual budget) who are consistently searching for new donors and may not have fundraising teams³⁶. This size of nonprofit is ideally large enough that they can absorb PairWell's fees but small enough that they may or may not have a dedicated development team and are looking for ways to connect with new donors. Our target donor users are mid-sized businesses who may not have dedicated CSR teams and have the revenue to support charitable giving.

Our initial MVP offering is a push-based recommendation engine which combines a two-tower model with additional similarity comparisons based on interests, missions statements, and geographic proximity (see Appendix for full technical discussion of our algorithm). The model updates continuously as new users, nonprofits, and engagement data are added, improving relevance over time. Most importantly, this enables discovery beyond the obvious. Unlike traditional content-based recommenders ("you liked X, here's more of X"), the two-tower model leverages collaborative similarity. It can identify nonprofits that a user might never have searched for but that people with *similar engagement patterns and value profiles* have found meaningful³⁷.

In our MVP phase, we are training the tower models primarily on synthetic interaction data (a dataset of 10,000 simulated users engaging with ~6,000 verified nonprofits). Because real-world interaction data is initially limited, we assign higher weights to the other similarity comparisons at first, emphasizing more objective and interpretable similarity factors in the early stages.

As authentic engagement data accumulates, we will gradually shift the weighting toward the two-tower output, allowing the more complex model to increasingly drive predictions. This transition reflects the evolution of PairWell's system from a hybrid model guided by explicit similarity to a fully data-driven recommendation engine that learns directly from real patterns of giving, discovery, and community behavior.

Over time, this continuous learning loop will enable PairWell to transform charitable discovery from a reactive process into an intelligent, proactive experience which goes beyond connecting users to causes they care about and reveals the ones they never knew they would.

³⁴ See appendix on Van Westendorp results

³⁵ Paul Popon, interview by Logan Wood, 07/29/2025

³⁶ See Appendix Segmentation - Nonprofit

³⁷ See Appendix Algorithm Overview

Once we are beyond our MVP phase and network effects have begun to take hold (see “Network Effects”), we plan to provide additional services like in-kind donations, impact-tracking dashboards and analytics, competitions, and employee engagement and volunteer coordination features which customers have repeatedly expressed would be valuable³⁸. We will also provide a robust rating system and assistance with documentation like 990’s that businesses can use to verify recipients, creating a self-reinforcing system based on trustworthiness and verification which helps increase user lock-in (see “Risks” section below). With increasing public and regulatory emphasis on measurable social impact, PairWell is positioned to grow alongside the broader \$44B corporate giving market while tapping into nonprofits’ consistent demand for effective fundraising tools.

Network Effects / Network Opportunities

PairWell’s platform model inherently benefits from positive cross-side network effects, where growth on one side of the marketplace increases value for the other. As more nonprofits join, the platform becomes more attractive to donors seeking diverse, verified giving opportunities³⁹. Conversely, as more donors participate, nonprofits are incentivized to join for increased visibility and access to funding⁴⁰.

Cross-Side Network Effects

- Nonprofits → Donors: Each new nonprofit adds more causes, projects, and impact stories, broadening the appeal to donor users who want variety and alignment with their giving goals. Pursuing a comprehensive supply differentiation strategy (offering the widest range of “supply” inventory possible) is a strong way to incentivize demand-side users into the platform⁴¹
- Donors → Nonprofits: Each new donor brings incremental funding opportunities and validation, attracting additional nonprofits seeking exposure⁴².
- This mutual reinforcement strengthens platform stickiness, creating a virtuous cycle of discovery, funding, and impact visibility.

Same-Side Network Effects

- Nonprofit Collaboration: As more nonprofits join, the platform fosters peer learning and shared best practices in impact reporting and donor communication. Our research has determined that the ability to find related nonprofits and their causes, projects, and teams would be valuable *for a nonprofit as well*, not just for a donor⁴³.
 - Note that there is also a slight risk of *negative* same-side network effects here, which is discussed in more detail under “Section VII: Risks”
- Donor Communities: Donors gain social validation and inspiration by observing others’ giving activity: features like leaderboards, impact badges, or “companies like yours support...” recommendations can further amplify engagement⁴⁴.

Data Flywheel and Personalization

³⁸ Maston McMahon, interview by Logan Wood, 11/2/25

³⁹ Gabriel Kurtzman, interview by Logan Wood, 9/5/25

⁴⁰ William Chertok, interview by Logan Wood, 9/3/25

⁴¹ <https://a16z.com/marketplace-supply-strategy-comprehensive-exclusive-or-curated/>

⁴² William Chertok, interview by Logan Wood, 9/3/25

⁴³ Michelle Woo, interview by Logan Wood, 9/12/25

⁴⁴ Maston McMahon, interview by Logan Wood, 11/2/25

- As platform activity grows, so does the dataset fueling PairWell's recommendation engine. Each donor-nonprofit interaction improves matching accuracy, leading to more successful connections and reinforcing both sides' incentives to stay active⁴⁵.
- Over time, this builds a data moat: PairWell will develop a competitive advantage as the model learns from unique behavioral and impact data that competitors lack⁴⁶.

Go-To-Market Strategy

Our go-to-market strategy involves four phases and focuses on overcoming the cold-start problem faced by all marketplace platforms⁴⁷ before moving into actual sales and marketing activities. Rather than trying to attract both donors and nonprofits simultaneously, we're pursuing a comprehensive supply strategy⁴⁸. Our approach begins with vertical integration before actual marketing and outreach, leveraging Candid's comprehensive nonprofit dataset to pre-populate the supply side of the platform (first confirming with each nonprofit that they are ok with being featured in our recommendations). This allows us to deliver immediate value to donors from day one through a robust recommendation engine while ensuring that we are not alienating our nonprofit users.

In our initial phase, we are building a data-rich foundation by integrating and enriching information from existing nonprofit database solutions (we are paying to use Candid's data initially). From this foundation, we're training our AI-driven recommendation system, which matches corporate donors to nonprofits based on shared values, mission alignment, and measurable impact goals.

Providing this value to donors allows us to move into our second phase⁴⁹ wherein we focus on the demand side of our market: launching a donor-facing platform that functions as an intelligent discovery engine. Corporate social responsibility (CSR) teams, foundations, and mission-driven brands will be able to explore curated nonprofit portfolios that align with their giving objectives and ESG themes. This is also when we begin actual sales and marketing.

Digital and In-Person Marketing

We will initiate a multi-faceted marketing approach that includes mass email marketing, ad spends on social media and SEO, and events. We will utilize email distribution software like Mailchimp to send mass emails to contacts who have shown interest as well as cold contacts who show good fit for our product. We have begun to send mass emails to for-profit and nonprofit professionals who align with our mission in order to gauge interest. We had a 0.06% conversion rate among recipients we had previously contacted.

We will primarily utilize LinkedIn as our social media platform, as our target customers on both sides are full-time professionals. We have begun to test ad spends through LinkedIn. In our first-ever ad spend, we had a \$3.95 cost per website and saw 0.1% of our target audience reached. Our click-through rate was 1.73%.

In order to overcome the cold-start problem by making in-person, substantive contacts, we will focus on having a presence at events that attract both nonprofit and for-profit professionals as a method to engage potential users on both sides. We will utilize events through attendance and sponsorships. Examples of events we will consider include the following:

- Center for Nonprofit Management Social Impact Summit

⁴⁵ See Appendix on "Recommendation Algorithm"

⁴⁶ Gallus, J (2025). Business Strategy [Lecture, attended by Logan Wood]. UCLA Anderson School of Business

⁴⁷ Chen, A. (2021). *The cold start problem: How to start and scale network effects*. HarperBusiness.

⁴⁸ <https://a16z.com/marketplace-supply-strategy-comprehensive-exclusive-or-curved/>

⁴⁹ Paul Popon, interview by Logan Wood, 8/1/25

- \$5,000 sponsorship level resulting in estimated 30 contacts (2 founders receive tickets through sponsorship, secure 15 meetings each)
- \$25,000 sponsorship level resulting in estimated 75 meetings (sponsorship includes marketplace booth; 400 attendees x 30% walk-by x 20% notice x 20% engage + 7 founders receive tickets through sponsorship secure 10 meetings each)
- Nonprofit Leadership Alliance Elevate Virtual Conference
 - \$2,500 sponsorship level resulting in estimated 425 contacts (50,000 delivered views x 0.85% conversion)
 - \$5,000 sponsorship level resulting in estimated 850 contacts (100,000 delivered views x 0.85% conversion)
- Consumer Electronics Show (Phase two or upon geographical expansion)
 - \$20,000 estimated total cost (\$51.50/sq ft. exhibit fee plus design/setup/swag) resulting in 250 estimated contacts (142,000 attendees x 5% walk-by x 10% notice x 20% engage x 60% qualified + 5 founders securing 30 meetings each)

Our blended CAC in year 1 is \$59.

Sales

Our initial goal is to establish pilot partnerships with 10–20 donor-side companies in the first six months that will serve as both proof points and feedback loops to refine our matching algorithms. To do so, we will follow an account-based marketing strategy: first we will conduct research identifying 100-200 target companies without active CSR or corporate philanthropy programs. We will then conduct personalized outreach, with a goal of each founder sending 500 contacts per month, explaining how PairWell simplifies giving and improves impact reporting. The key is to emphasize that we are launching an exclusive pilot program in which they are invited to participate. Initially, PairWell founders will walk users through the platform and help them build their profiles / search preferences so each user is able to gain the most benefit from the platform. Customer support is integral to PairWell in order to maintain a simple and easy user experience.

Account-based methods like this not only yield higher ROI⁵⁰ but will also allow us to keep costs lower and leverage more personal communications and networks rather than paying for leads and following a traditional B2B sales funnel. During this period, our recommendation engine will rely more heavily on objective similarity factors before gradually shifting toward learned behavioral patterns as real engagement data accumulates.

Once a base of engaged donors is established, we will begin Phase Three and use that activity to attract nonprofits organically, fleshing out the supply side of our platform. We will conduct traditional sales outreach as well as focusing on event-based marketing, having a presence at business conventions and sponsoring conferences. Through our research, when interviewing nonprofit leaders, we learned that it is important to develop and maintain relationships with donors, as many donors have expressed interest in and responded positively to personalized experiences. Personalized experiences can include holding special events, creating custom acknowledgment videos from the team, and sending handwritten and signed acknowledgment letters.⁵¹ These interviews also support the secondary research we found regarding how in-person networking can be effective for nonprofits.⁵² We also plan to approach foundations to hold grant competitions on our platform to increase awareness. While PairWell

⁵⁰ <https://www.only-b2b.com/blog/account-based-marketing-framework/>

⁵¹ See appendix for Interviews with Roger Castle, LA Regional Food Bank and Jessie Rojas, LA's BEST

⁵² <https://www.library.hbs.edu/working-knowledge/nonprofit-networking-the-new-way-to-grow>

itself is not a nonprofit, conducting activities like these will establish us strongly as an ally in the space and align well with our overall positioning as the intelligent infrastructure for philanthropy.

With donor demand visible on the platform, nonprofits will have a strong incentive to enhance their profiles, ensuring their projects are discoverable to potential funders⁵³. This creates a self-reinforcing cycle: as nonprofits contribute richer data and project updates, our model performance improves, producing better recommendations that drive more funding and further participation and evolving our tool beyond a simple recommendation engine.

As the ecosystem matures, monetization (our fourth phase) will follow naturally through paid subscriptions, and increasing variety of paid features as we continue to develop our platform. By starting with data and donor utility rather than liquidity we will be able to enter the market with immediate value, solve the cold start from day one, and set up a defensible growth flywheel.

Section VII: Risks

Cold Start Problem

A central hypothesis of our project is that we will be able to overcome the cold-start problem inherent in multi-sided platforms. The value that we offer to donors (a powerful, push-based recommendation engine) is reliant on obtaining large amounts of nonprofit data which we need in order to build and train a model. However, our value proposition to nonprofits (discoverability and increased donations) requires the presence of donors in the platform: if there are no donors, there's no reason for a nonprofit to pay to be in our system. And with donors being the higher-dollar and therefore more difficult-to-recruit side of the market, we find ourselves stuck in a loop: no donors means no nonprofits, and no nonprofits means no data with which to entice donors.

However, a key finding of our research is that we have been able to use paid API's to seed an initial dataset⁵⁴. From here we have been able to begin training a recommendation engine and building a tool which will actually provide value to donor users. Acquiring donor users then incentivizes nonprofits to join our platform which provides more data to train on, further increasing our value to donors and so forth. This tried-and-true method of partial vertical integration in order to stimulate demand on one side of a platform has been demonstrated across industries from game development to e-commerce⁵⁵, and we are confident that it will succeed in kickstarting our data flywheel and beginning a virtuous cycle of value creation.

Risk of Disintermediation

A central risk all platforms must manage is that of disintermediation: what if the two sides of our market use our platform to establish a donor-recipient relationship with each other and then decide to continue that relationship outside the platform, cutting out the middleman to avoid paying for our services? We will employ three central strategies to mitigate this risk. The first is reduction of "transaction" costs (on the donor side, referring to costs in terms of time/friction as opposed to just financial costs) through our push-based recommendation engine: the more seamless we can make the experience of finding and donating, the less likely a party is to disintermediate. The second is to implement exhaustive quality certifications (which increases the supply side of the market's commitment to on-platform transactions) and the third is simply to continue to expand our feature offerings in the platform. As Pairwell becomes a more comprehensive service provider beyond simply facilitating donations, users' switching costs of transitioning to a direct relationship will increase as they will leave behind capabilities not

⁵³ Michelle Woo, interview by Logan Wood, 9/12/25

⁵⁴ See Appendix on database documentation

⁵⁵ <https://sloanreview.mit.edu/article/strategic-decisions-for-multisided-platforms/>

provided by the nonprofits themselves. All three of these are established and successful methods for a platform business to reduce disintermediation, as proven by analysis of successful ventures like Airbnb⁵⁶.

Negative Same-Side Network Effects (SSNE's)

While our user interviews have expressed that there is some degree of positive same-side network effects present on the PairWell platform (where nonprofits benefit from the presence of other nonprofits⁵⁷), a fundamental problem of multi-sided platforms is negative same-side network effects⁵⁸. The presence of more suppliers means that the demand side has more options to choose from and vice versa, limiting the ability of any one participant to capture value. However, PairWell's push-based recommendation model is specifically designed to minimize the impact of this. Rather than just providing a mass dataset from which donors need to *pull* information (which would cause strong negative SSNE's as nonprofits compete for visibility with each other in an increasingly noisy sea of information), we specifically curate recommendations based on value alignment. Nonprofits don't have to worry much about other nonprofits eating into their market share, only about the presence of donors who align with their causes. This reduces the risk of negative SSNE's and actually reinforces the strength of cross-side network effects between donor and nonprofit.

Section VIII: Cap Table

Our initial capitalization table includes the Founders and an Option Pool for early hires using a projected valuation based on a discounted free cash flow model:

Holder	Shares	Ownership %	Implied Value @ Pre-Money
Founders	10,000,000	82.9%	\$2,900,000
Option Pool	2,000,000	16.6%	\$580,000

Section IX: Fundraising

PairWell will seek an initial seed round of funding of \$250,000. These proceeds will fund the initial development contract, early hires and marketing expenses, especially those for events and competitions as these are early awareness drivers.

Section X: Financial Projections

Financial Model

[This model simulates](#) the first 60 months of growth for PairWell's two-sided SaaS platform, projecting user acquisition, churn, conversions, revenue, expenses, capital investment, and cash flow. It is structured as a fully dynamic, month-over-month system in which all channel

⁵⁶ Lin, J., Nian, T., Foutz, N., Paul Merage School of Business, University of California, Irvine, & McIntire School of Commerce, University of Virginia. (2022). Disintermediation and Its Mitigation in Online Two-sided Platforms: Evidence from Airbnb. *Boston University: Questrom School of Business*. https://questromworld.bu.edu/platformstrategy/wp-content/uploads/sites/49/2022/07/PlatStrat2022_paper_37.pdf

⁵⁷ Michelle Woo, interview by Logan Wood, 9/12/25

⁵⁸ <https://www.nfx.com/post/network-effects-manual>

activity, phase behavior, pricing, and cohort outcomes propagate forward through time. The model outputs a complete set of exports used to generate visualizations and financial statements in the accompanying report.

User acquisition is driven by several distinct marketing channels. Email outreach scales with staffing levels, applying a controllable productivity multiplier to represent improvements in outbound capacity over time. Paid social and programmatic advertising are modeled explicitly using spend, CPM, CPA, and segment-specific conversion rates⁵⁹. The model includes both events and funding competitions as marketing drivers in Phase 1 and 2 with assumptions related conversion based on event attendance. These channels generate impressions and attributable conversions in each month. Referral marketing acts as the system's organic growth engine and grows proportional to the active user base. Each existing user produces a small number of referrals per month, filtered through a global referral conversion rate. Referral intensity is also phase-dependent: in each phase, a multiplier adjusts the strength of word-of-mouth growth, replacing the old organic-growth assumptions. Additional users may enter through occasional competition events or community events, which appear as exogenous acquisition shocks.

The model incorporates four development and growth phases—Experimentation (P1), Build (P2), Scale (P3), and Optimize (P4)—each defined by a set of override multipliers. These phase settings adjust email productivity, paid-media aggressiveness, channel efficiency (CPM/CPA), referral strength, and attach rates for value-added services such as the concierge product. Employee Engagement services can also be activated starting in a designated phase and month. Additionally, the model provides an estimate of Pairwell's 1% giving pledge on the road to becoming a certified benefit corporation.

Once acquired, users enter a structured lifecycle: they may begin in a free trial, convert to paid accounts, or churn from either the trial or paid state. The model tracks all cohorts separately to ensure accurate survival, conversion, and churn dynamics over multiple months. Pricing is fully parameterized for all three service tiers on both sides of the market—nonprofits, donors, and employee-engagement add-ons—along with per-project concierge pricing. Donation-processing fee revenue and associated payment-processing COGS are also included in the model.

The report includes multiple plots illustrating total users, paid vs. unpaid users, marketing-driven acquisitions, spend patterns, cash flow, SaaS metrics, and other KPIs. Together, these outputs provide a detailed, phase-aware, channel-level forecast of PairWell's growth trajectory and financial performance. Key assumptions are listed in the appendix.

Anticipated Financial Performance

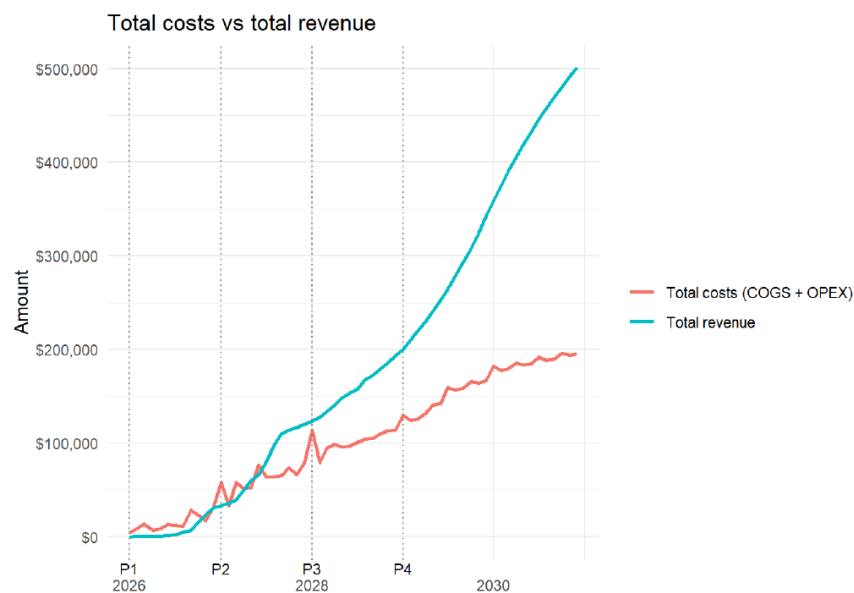
Under these assumptions, the model projects that PairWell becomes cash-flow positive in its second year of operations. Revenue grows from approximately \$87,000 in Year One to more than \$5.2 million in Year Five, driven primarily by subscription adoption among both nonprofits and donors, with concierge revenue contributing only a modest share. Enterprise employee-engagement features are currently modeled but switched off, as these offerings are now incorporated into our Enterprise Premium pricing structure and will be re-evaluated as customer needs become clearer.

The model's valuation outputs reflect two standard approaches. A discounted cash flow analysis using a 30 percent discount rate yields an estimated valuation of roughly \$3.4 million, while a Year-Five EBITDA exit multiple generates an implied valuation of about \$7.5 million. Subscription dynamics in the base case show early traction: the model forecasts approximately

⁵⁹ See Appendix - LinkedIn Ads Experiments

63 paid donor subscriptions by the end of Year One, with nonprofit adoption growing proportionally as the platform establishes trust and visibility in the sector. Detailed projections for both paid and unpaid users across all segments are included in the appendix. Actual early traction and revenue mix will vary with state of initial product.

As with any early-stage financial model, several assumptions will require validation and refinement as real customer data becomes available. These include acquisition efficiency across channels, actual CPM and CPA performance, trial conversion rates, paid retention and churn behavior, true attach rates for concierge services, and the long-term scalability of SOC-2-aligned authentication costs. Pricing sensitivity and willingness-to-pay will also need to be revisited through ongoing customer discovery. The model is intentionally structured to make these updates straightforward, allowing PairWell to move from research-informed assumptions to data-driven parameters as the company grows.



Appendix

Link to Prototype

<https://pairwell-search.streamlit.app/>

Welcome to PairWell! Tell us about yourself to find relevant nonprofits.

City
Los Angeles

State
CA

Income
150000

Interests (comma-separated)
Oceans, wildlife, environmental protection

Preferred Engagement Types
Volunteering x Advocacy x

Get Recommendations

Top Recommended Nonprofits:

	Nonprofit Name	Mission	City	State	Logo	Website	Recommendation Score	Relevance Prediction	Mission Similarity	Ge
0	CALIFORNIA FARMLAND TRUST	We are on a mission to help farmers protect the best farmland in the world. We envisi	Elk Grove	CA		http://www.cafarmtrust.org	0.7349	0.7349	0.6041	Ge
1	Biodiversity First Inc	TO PROTECT AND RECOVER, AND SECURE A FUTURE FOR, ALL SPECIES OF WILD ANIM	Shandon	CA	None	http://biodiversityfirst.net	0.7183	0.702	0.576	
2	Wildlife Learning Foundation	Provide sanctuary and life-time care to animals in need and to educate the public on	Rancho Cascades	CA	None	www.WildlifeLearningFoundation.org	0.7029	0.6453	0.5859	
9	POLLINATOR PARTNERSHIP	Pollinator Partnership's mission is to protect pollinators, critical to food and ecosyste	San Francisco	CA		http://www.pollinator.org	0.6716	0.7126	0.4354	

NTEE Category Colors

- Arts, Culture & Humanities
- Education
- Environment
- Animal Related
- Health Care
- Mental Health & Crisis
- Disease, Disorders & Medical
- Medical Research
- Crime & Legal Related
- Employment & Job Related
- Food, Agriculture & Nutrition
- Housing & Shelter
- Public Safety & Disaster Prep
- Recreation & Sports



Code Documentation

<https://github.com/loganwood47/pairwell-search>

Algorithm Overview

Utilizing a simple tech stack of Python and a PostgreSQL database, we have successfully created a minimum viable product of our recommendation engine. Our engine combines four factors into a final predicted “similarity score” which is used to recommend nonprofits which are

closely aligned with potential donors. The equation for our total similarity score S_{Total} , is as follows, where α , β , γ , δ are weights normalizing the final score to exist between 0 and 1:

$$S_{Total} = (\alpha \times S_{Mission}) + (\beta \times S_{Geo}) + (\gamma \times S_{PairWell}) + (\delta \times S_{Model})$$

$(\alpha \times S_{Mission})$: The first component that our model considers is the similarity between a user's interests and the mission statement of a given nonprofit. To determine this, we first ask the user a simple question about what causes they care about⁶⁰. We then take the results of this input and pass them to an LLM with a prompt asking the tool to create a nonprofit-style mission statement of several sentences representing the mission of the "ideal" nonprofit serving those stated causes.⁶¹ This expanded "user mission" is then embedded into a vector space using a Sentence Transformer model from HuggingFace⁶². We embed each nonprofit's actual mission statement into the same vector space and compute the cosine distance between the two vectors to obtain our "mission similarity" score $S_{Mission}$.

$(\beta \times S_{Geo})$: The second component we consider when evaluating similarity is geographic distance, as donors are typically more interested in nonprofit organizations who serve their local areas⁶³. We ask the user what city and state they are located in, geocode this into lat/lon coordinates⁶⁴, compute the Haversine distance between the user and a nonprofit's location⁶⁵, and scale this number by the max distance between two points in the US to obtain a normalized value from 0 to 1 representing the proximity of the user to the nonprofit organization.

$(\gamma \times S_{PairWell})$: This term is a simple scalar value that we can assign at our discretion. The purpose of this is to "put our thumb on the scale" and weight certain results more heavily in our final recommendation result. In our current implementation it is set to zero everywhere, but this leaves us an avenue to monetize by promoting "sponsored results" and more should we decide to.

$(\delta \times S_{Model})$: This is the real core of PairWell's recommendation engine. S_{Model} is the similarity between a user and a nonprofit as predicted by our primary machine learning model, which implements a two-tower recommendation engine pattern. It is designed to deeply understand both users and nonprofits, and to uncover meaningful matches that go beyond obvious connections. We begin by capturing every user interaction across the platform (views, clicks, shares, follows, volunteer sign-ups, and donations) and assign weighted values to each. High-value actions like donations carry strong positive weights, while low-engagement events (e.g., viewing without further action) carry lower or even negative weights. These interaction weights are then combined with multidimensional data on both users (interests, demographics, geography, giving history, behavioral patterns) and nonprofits (mission, focus areas, impact

⁶⁰ See Appendix for UI example

⁶¹ https://github.com/loganwood47/pairwell-search/blob/main/src/pairwell_search/services/interest_expansion.py#L15 (We use a simple text model, Nemo, from MistralAI)

⁶² https://github.com/loganwood47/pairwell-search/blob/main/src/pairwell_search/services/embedding_service.py#L12

⁶³ William Chertok, interview by Logan Wood, 9/3/25

⁶⁴ https://github.com/loganwood47/pairwell-search/blob/main/src/pairwell_search/services/geocode_city.py#L3

⁶⁵ https://github.com/loganwood47/pairwell-search/blob/main/src/pairwell_search/services/similarity.py#L154

metrics, storytelling quality, donor profiles, projects) to train two parallel neural networks (the “towers” in our ML architecture):

- **User Tower:** Learns an embedding that represents each user’s underlying values, interests, and behavioral signals.
- **Nonprofit Tower:** Learns an embedding that represents each nonprofit’s mission, approach, and appeal profile.

Each tower independently transforms complex data into a dense vector representation. The similarity between a user and a nonprofit is then computed using cosine similarity between their embeddings (similar to our mission score), revealing how strongly they align across multiple latent dimensions⁶⁶.

In our MVP phase, we are training the towers primarily on synthetic interaction data (a dataset of 10,000 simulated users engaging with ~6,000 verified nonprofits). Because real-world interaction data is initially limited, we assign higher weights to α , β , and γ , emphasizing more objective and interpretable similarity factors in the early stages.

As authentic engagement data accumulates, we will gradually shift the weighting toward δ , allowing the two-tower model to increasingly drive predictions. This transition reflects the evolution of PairWell’s system from a hybrid model guided by explicit similarity to a fully data-driven recommendation engine that learns directly from real patterns of giving, discovery, and community behavior.

Additional Algorithm Components - Board Members

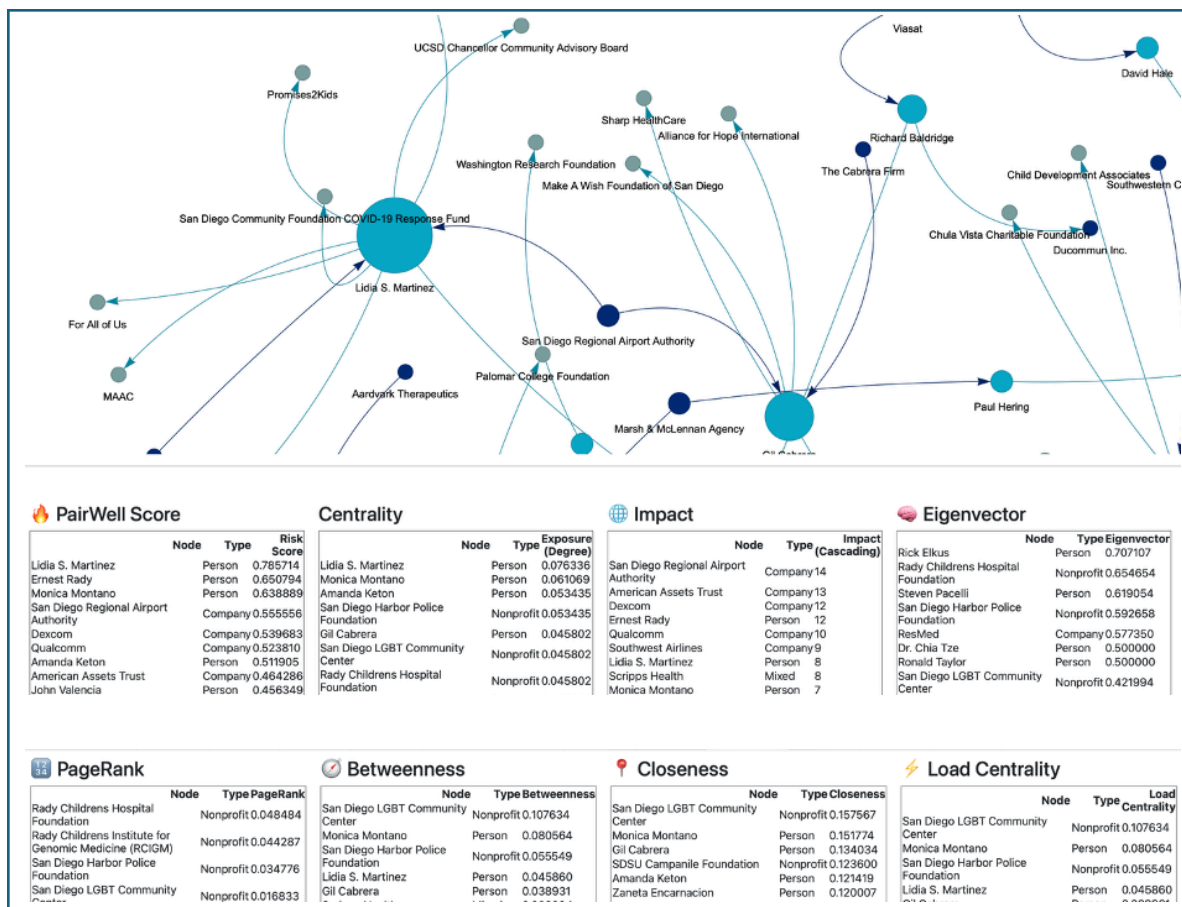
Although not included in the working prototype, we built a model using Python (NetworkX + PyVis) that maps board members of companies and nonprofits based on the mimicry theory and expert guidance: by quantifying influence and peer clusters, the PairWell algorithm can include a weighted component to recommend interconnected nonprofits and donors and it can spotlight bridges, and nudge peers toward action. The model imports edge lists (companies, nonprofits, board members) and computes:

- Exposure (Degree) – raw connectivity.
- Impact Reach – how far a node’s influence propagates.
- PageRank & Eigenvector Centrality – prestige and quality-of-ties, per Sorenson.
- Betweenness – bridges between communities.
- PairWell Score – blended exposure + impact metric.
- Community Detection – clusters by industry/mission/region, visualized by shape.
- Simulation – what-if node removals to test resilience.

The output is an interactive dashboard showing donor–nonprofit ties, sortable tables of centrality metrics, and scenario simulations.

A selected number of non-profits and major corporations were used to map an initial network and calculate metrics. Future connection to APIs or databases will help improve the definition of the network to be used as added features for premium subscriptions..

⁶⁶ https://github.com/loganwood47/pairwell-search/blob/main/src/pairwell_search/models/two_tower.py

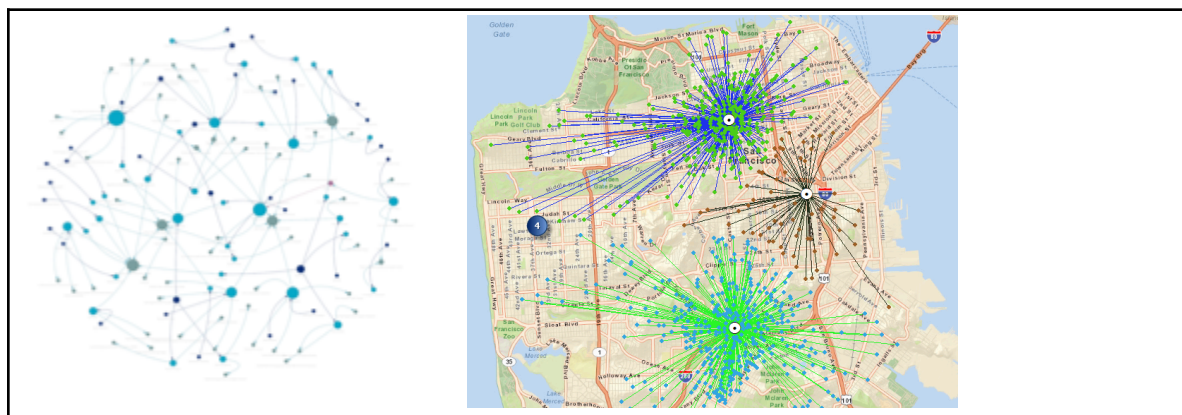


Network modeling and Metrics concept

Dashboard - Location Based Feature Sample

The concept is that a user (either a non-profit or donor) could go to PairWell site, enter a zip code, company name, or other search terms and the system will display the network of non-profits and donors within that area as well as the completed projects in order to visualize impact.

The network can also be overlap with GIS technology to a map of a region.



Network modeling and GIS overlap concept.

These location based insights can also be used to recommend non-profits to certain businesses based on their industry, location, size, and more importantly based on what their peers are doing. Similarly, the network and map can be used to identify key players in the business / donor environment as well as identify fundraising events, galas, and other public events that key board members and their peers attend. This will help non-profits to be very focus on their fundraising efforts.

Team Biographies

Jordan is a third-year FEMBA candidate at UCLA Anderson. Jordan has eight years of experience in partnership management (previously in digital media distribution) including five years in nonprofit fundraising. Jordan currently works at UCLA, where she continues to work in fundraising. Jordan conceptualized PairWell and has been an integral team member for its duration. She has contributed her expertise to the development of the business plan, focusing most on idea development, competitive analysis, sales and market, and a go-to-market strategy. She has also conducted valuable market research.

Guillermo is a third-year FEMBA candidate at UCLA Anderson. He brings over a decade of experience in risk management and corporate compliance, having worked with a variety of organizations across industries to identify, assess, and mitigate complex operational and reputational risks. Currently, Guillermo serves as Vice President of Strategic Risk Consulting at Marsh Advisory, where he advises Fortune 500 companies on enterprise risk management, business continuity planning, and regulatory compliance. In his role, Guillermo has developed a deep understanding of the tools, frameworks, and governance processes that corporations use to manage philanthropic donations, as well as the associated risks and challenges including regulatory scrutiny, reputational risk, and internal controls. His experience positions him well to evaluate corporate social responsibility initiatives through both a strategic and risk-conscious lens.

Logan is a third-year FEMBA candidate at UCLA Anderson. He has spent the last six years working in ad tech, bringing deep experience in programmatic advertising and AI-driven personalization engines. He's built large-scale DSP platforms, data pipelines, and more and has hands-on expertise across data engineering, cloud tooling, and full-stack prototyping. Outside of adtech, he's founded and built ML-powered outreach tools and workflow automation products. Logan brings a mix of strategic thinking and technical execution, with a long-term goal of building and scaling his own companies.

Jenny is a third-year FEMBA candidate at UCLA Anderson. She has spent over seven years working in product design, research, and development in-house and at an agency. Jenny also has experience working in digital marketing and social media for over five years. Jenny is currently working at AIDS Healthcare Foundation as their Web Experience Lead while working cross-functionally with other teams such as digital marketing, media buying, social media, copywriting, and more. Her experience in product design can help lead the direction of the product vision for PairWell and her experience in Marketing can help facilitate and contribute during the early stage of marketing efforts and carry forward into the long term. To date, Jenny has collaborated with the team on product definition, competitor research/analysis, market outreach/research, and social media (LinkedIn) advertising campaign management. Jenny

plans to continue to help with product and marketing strategies while working collaboratively with the team on various efforts.

Robert has a 15 year career in the nonprofit sector and is incredibly curious about fundraising and improving efficacy of philanthropic, grant, and other funding sources targeted at nonprofits. There are a lot of barriers to success. Robert has been on the programs and operations side of the business and is interested in pursuing work with foundations after graduating. Robert hopes to contribute his knowledge and experience from his nonprofit work, his analytics and strategy skills, and inclusive leadership styles.

Competitive Landscape and Pricing Analysis

CSR Platforms

The CSR platform market is dominated by enterprise-level solutions such as Benevity, Bonterra (CyberGrants), and YourCause (Blackbaud), which primarily cater to large corporations with extensive employee engagement and reporting needs. While these systems are robust, their high customization costs, opaque pricing, and complex implementation processes create barriers for small and mid-sized businesses.

Key Observations:

- Most leading CSR tools charge custom or tiered pricing for corporate clients and are free for nonprofits but with hidden transaction or distribution fees (e.g., Benevity's ~3% distribution fee).
- Solutions like Goodera, Deed, and Uncommon Giving are emerging small to mid size business-friendly entrants, offering more flexible engagement models and lower entry pricing.
- However, even these smaller competitors lack integrated discovery, impact reporting, and donor-nonprofit matching features, leaving a white space for affordable, data-driven CSR tools like PairWell.

CSR Platform Comparison:

	Benevity	Bonterra (CyberGrants)	YourCause (Blackbaud)	Goodera	Deed
Curated lists of nonprofits	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Nonprofit ratings	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Project discovery	✓	●	✗	✗	●
Project progress reporting	✓	●	✓	●	●
Internal payment processing	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Focused on corporate donors	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Volunteer ops	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Gamification	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Grant mgmt	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
In-kind donations	✓	✓	✓	✗	?
Data analytics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Tax documentation	✓	✓	✓	?	✓
Matching Donations	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Fees	~\$1000+ in addition to CC fees (annual only, complaints about “hidden fees”)	Custom/Not Listed	Minimum \$5K In addition to transaction fees (large companies)	~\$25-\$50 per employee per placement in addition to other costs and fees. Est several \$K/year (mid/large companies)	Custom/Not Listed (small companies)

Donation/Fundraising Platforms

Donation-focused platforms such as GoFundMe Pro, GiveButter, and GlobalGiving primarily serve nonprofits directly rather than connecting them with corporate donors. They excel in fundraising mechanics but do not provide integrated impact-tracking or discovery functions for businesses.

Key Observations:

- Donation tools typically monetize via service or processing fees (2–12%), with donors sometimes given the option to cover these costs.
- GlobalGiving and GiveButter have transparent pricing but limited personalization or CSR integrations.
- Philanthropia and Charity Navigator serve niche or evaluative roles (e.g., nonprofit vetting, ratings) but lack two-sided marketplace functionality.

Donation/Fundraising Platform Comparison:

	GoFundMe Pro (prev. Classy)	GiveButter	GlobalGiving	Philanthropia	Charity Navigator	GiveWell
Curated lists of nonprofits	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Nonprofit ratings	✗	✗	✓	✗	✓	✗
Project discovery	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Project progress reporting	●	✓	✓	?	✗	✗
Internal payment processing	✓	✓	✓	?	✗	✓
Focused on corporate donors	●	✗	✓	●	✗	✗
Volunteer ops	✗	✗	●	✗	✗	✗

Gamification	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Grant mgmt	✗	✗	●	✗	✗	✓
In-kind donations	✗	✗	?	✗	✗	✗
Data analytics	✓	✓	✓	?	✓	✓
Tax documentation	✓	✓	✓	?	●	✓
Events and ticketing	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Matching Donations	✓	✓	✓	?	✗	✗
Fees	Starting ~\$299/month (GFM - 2.9% + \$0.30 per donation)	Plus Plan - \$348, \$948, and \$1548+/ yr depending on # of contacts	\$0, but 5-12% fee on donations (~\$600 - \$250+) PLUS 3% transaction fee (\$750 - \$400+)	Not Listed (businesses pay fees; \$0 for donors/nonprofit)	\$0	Minimum transaction fees (0.8% for ACH, 2.6% + \$0.40 for CC, 3.5% + \$0.40 for AMEX, or 2.2% + \$0.30 for PayPal)

Volunteer Platforms

Platforms like VolunteerMatch, GivePulse, and Catchafire address the volunteer engagement segment. These tools enable nonprofits and individuals to connect for service opportunities but are transactional, not strategic, they don't support integrated funding or impact analytics.

Key Observations:

- Most platforms operate on tiered subscription models ranging from free basic access to enterprise plans exceeding \$1,000/year.
- None combine volunteer management with financial giving, discovery, and analytics, areas where PairWell bridges the gap by offering unified donor and nonprofit engagement under one ecosystem.

Volunteering Platform Comparison:

	VolunteerMatch	GivePulse	Catchafire	Mobilize	Golden Volunteer
Curated lists of nonprofits	●	●	✓	●	●
Nonprofit ratings	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Project discovery	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Project progress reporting	✗	✗	●	✗	✗
Internal payment processing	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Focused on corporate donors	✓*	✓*	✓*	✓*	✗
Volunteer ops	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗

Gamification	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Grant mgmt	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
In-kind donations	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Data analytics	?	●	●	●	✓
Tax documentation	?	●	●	●	?
Events and ticketing	●	✓	✗	✓	✓
Matching Donations	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗
Fees	\$0 - basic \$720+ - tiered pricing	\$0 - basic \$138 - platinum 3.9% fee + \$0.30	\$0 - volunteers \$0 - nonprofits** 4.95% fee	\$0 - starter \$500/mo - small \$2K/mo - large org	\$0 - basic \$1200/yr - Pro Enterprise option org

Pricing Analysis (Detailed analysis [here](#)):

		Pricing - Nonprofits	Pricing - Businesses	Fees
CSR Platforms:	Benevity	Free	Custom	Transaction fee: 2.9% + \$0.30 Distribution fee: ~3%
	Bonterra	Custom pricing*	Custom based on tiers	
	YourCause	Free	Custom pricing	
	Goodera	Free	~\$25-50 per employee	
	Deed	Not available	Not available	
	Uncommon Giving	Free	Starting at \$1999 annual	Service fee: 2%
	POINT	Free / \$90 / Custom	Not available	
	Percent Pledge	Not applicable	\$20-30 per employee	No fees
Donation / Fundraising Platforms:	GoFundMe Pro	Custom pricing (~\$3K-\$6K annual)	Not applicable	Service fee: 3% Stripe fee: 2.4% + \$0.30
	GiveButter	Free*	Not applicable	*Only if tips are enabled: Platform fee: 3% Processing fee: 1.9% or 2.9% + \$0.30 (typically covered by donors)

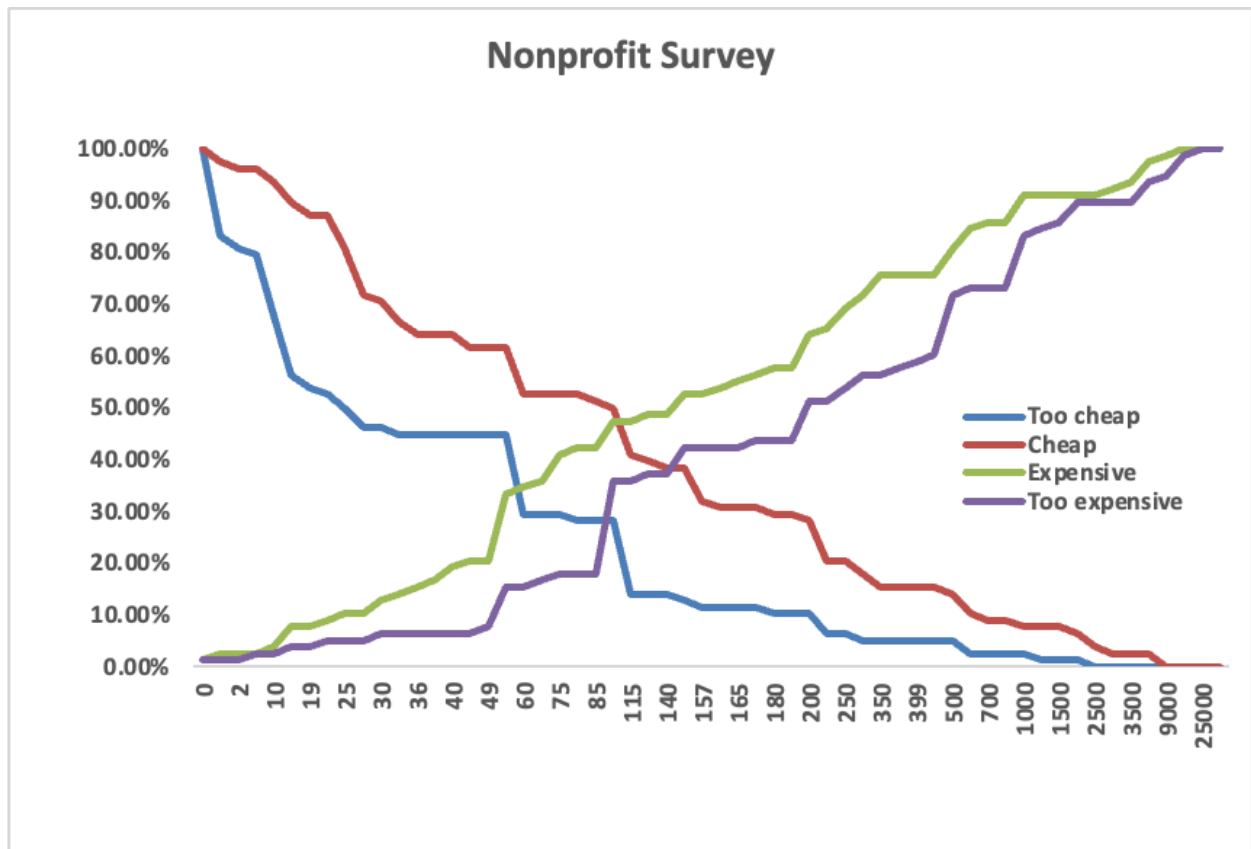
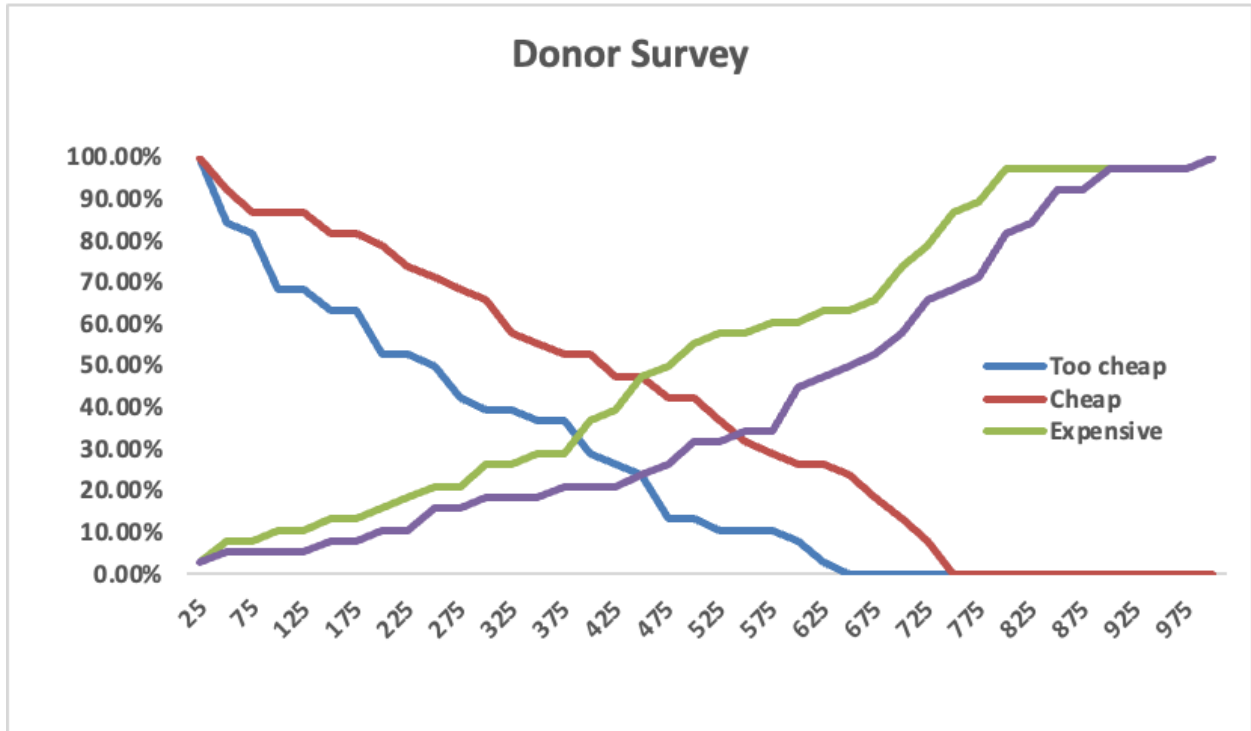
	GlobalGiving	Free	Not available	Support fee: 5% - 12% Processing fee: 3%
	Philathropia	Free	5% annual rev or custom	
	Charity Navigator	Free	Free	

Price Sensitivity Analysis

In order to determine an initial monthly subscription fee for both donor and nonprofit users, we conducted a Van Westendorp price sensitivity analysis using the survey results from SurveyMonkey with screened respondents who are directly involved in CSR, philanthropy, or fundraising decisions at their organizations.

In the survey, we asked four standard Van Westendorp questions at what price the subscription would feel *too cheap* (quality concerns), *too expensive*, *a bargain/cheap*, and *expensive but still acceptable* for both donor-facing and nonprofit-facing versions of PairWell. We then plotted these responses to identify the *optimal price point* (where “too cheap” and “too expensive” intersect) as well as the *acceptable price range* bounded by the points of marginal cheapness and marginal expensiveness. This analysis allowed us to anchor our recommended subscription tiers within a range that our target decision-makers perceive as fair value, while also highlighting how much pricing headroom we have for enhanced features. The resulting ranges inform our proposed starting prices for donor and nonprofit subscriptions, ensuring they are both revenue-supportive for PairWell and aligned with stakeholders’ willingness to pay.

	Nonprofit		Donor	
	Month	Annual	Month	Annual
Optimal price point: OPP : Too expensive=Too cheap	\$ 95	\$ 1,140	\$ 450	\$ 5,400
Lower range acceptable price: Too cheap=Expensive	\$ 60	\$ 720	\$ 387	\$ 4,644
Upper range acceptable prices: Cheap=Too Expensive	\$ 140	\$ 1,680	\$ 540	\$ 6,480



Segmentation - Donor

To analyze the survey results (N = 38), we conducted a structured segmentation process using Stata. We began by selecting pain-point variables (e.g., challenges finding nonprofits, verifying legitimacy, coordinating approvals, managing inbound requests) as the Bases for clustering since these reflect underlying needs and friction in the corporate giving workflow.. After standardizing the approach, we applied hierarchical clustering to explore natural groupings in the data, examined dendrogram patterns, and used stopping rules (Calinski–Harabasz and Duda–Hart indices) to identify plausible cluster counts. We then validated the solution using k-means clustering to confirm stability and ensure segments were not sensitive to initial conditions.

The table below shows two clusters, the first one (1) with lower than “moderately” pains across all categories and the second one (2) with higher than “very” across all categories.

Stata Output:

Donor_Pains Findin~d	Verify~y	Evalu~i	Coordi~o	Proces~e		
Tracki~a Managi~i						
-----+-----						

2.8	1 2.75	2.85	2.95	2.95	2.35	2.85
20	20	20	20	20	20	20
-----+-----						

4.111111	2 4.277778	4.222222	4.055556	4.388889	4.277778	
18	4.444444 18	18	18	18	18	18
-----+-----						

Average	3.526316	3.552632	3.473684	3.315789	3.526316	
3.421053	3.552632 38	38	38	38	38	38
38	38					
-----+-----						

Donor Pain (1= Not at All, 2 = Slightly, 3 = Moderately, 4 = Very, 5 = Extremely).

Findin~d	Finding local nonprofits aligned to our values
Verify~y	Verifying nonprofit legitimacy & impact
Evalu~i	Evaluating project fit and funding need
Coordi~o	Coordinating approvals & stakeholder buy-in
Proces~e	Processing payments & tax documentation

Tracki~a Tracking/reporting impact to leadership
 Managi~i Managing inbound requests efficiently

The analysis ultimately showed that a two-cluster solution was both statistically stable and managerially interpretable. After forming the clusters, we profiled each group using key descriptor variables, such as decision-maker status, company size, giving budget, nonprofit type supported, revenue band, CSR presence, and operational characteristics. This combination of quantitative clustering and qualitative interpretation provides a reliable foundation for identifying donor segments with distinct needs and product-adoption potential.

Stata Output:

Donor_Pains	FinalD~r	Compan~e	Giving~t	Decisi~s	Typeof~r
Corpor~y	Annual~v				
-----+-----					

1	.25	2.25	3.25	2.7	1.55
.2 2.45					
	20	20	20	20	20
20 20					
-----+-----					

2	.7777778	2.333333	3.666667	2.388889	1.888889
.2777778 3.722222					
	18	18	18	18	18
18 18					
-----+-----					

Total	.5	2.289474	3.447368	2.552632	1.710526
.2368421 3.052632					
	38	38	38	38	38
38 38					
-----+-----					

FinalD~r Final Decision Maker (1 = yes, 0 = no)
 Compan~e Company Size (employee band)
 Giving~t Corporate Giving Budget
 Decisi~s Decision Cadence for Donations/Sponsorships
 Typeof~r Type of Nonprofits Mostly Supported
 Corpor~y CSR Structure Present (1 = yes, 0 = no)
 Annual~v Annual Revenue Band

The two-cluster solution reveals a clear and actionable segmentation of corporate donors. Donor_Pains 1 represents leaner, lower-friction organizations, where only 25% of respondents

are final decision makers and giving budgets and revenues are modest. These companies tend to support more local nonprofits and operate with simpler, relationship-driven giving processes. Their pain levels are moderate, suggesting that inefficiencies exist but are not overwhelming. They behave like “steady but simple” givers, organizations that might adopt a platform like PairWell for convenience rather than necessity.

In contrast, Donor_Pains 2 contains the “high-friction” donors, companies where 78% of respondents are final decision makers, giving budgets are higher, and revenues are substantially larger. These teams are more likely to have formal CSR structures, a directional indicator that more processes, approvals, and documentation are involved. They also support a broader mix of nonprofits beyond local organizations, which adds complexity and increases operational burden. Overall, this segment experiences consistently higher pain across all giving-related tasks, making them the most receptive audience for a platform that simplifies discovery, verification, payments, and reporting.

After identifying pain-based segments, we repeated the same clustering process, hierarchical clustering, optimal stopping rules, and k-means stability checks, to segment respondents based on feature preferences. Using the seven feature-importance ratings (Local Discovery, Vetted Profiles, Itemized Projects, Impact Dashboard, Auto Tax Docs, Employee Engagement Tools, and One-Click Renewal) as Bases, we again found that a two-cluster solution was the most stable and managerially meaningful. We then profiled each cluster using the same descriptor variables (decision-maker status, revenue, CSR presence, nonprofit type supported) to understand which types of organizations value which features.

Stata Output:

Donor_Features		Locald~e	Vetted~d	Projec~i	Impact~r	Automa~a
Employ~n	Onecli~s					
-----+-----						

	1	3.961538	4.5	4.115385	3.961538	4.307692
4.153846	4.269231					
		26	26	26	26	26
26	26					
-----+-----						

	2	3	2.833333	2.666667	3.416667	2.833333
3.5	2.083333					
		12	12	12	12	12
12	12					
-----+-----						

	Total	3.657895	3.973684	3.657895	3.789474	3.842105
3.947368	3.578947					
		38	38	38	38	38
38	38					

Locald~e Local discovery filters

Vetted~d	Vetted nonprofit profiles with documents
Projec~i	Project-level funding with itemized needs
Impact~r	Impact reporting dashboard (shareable)
Automa~a	Automatic tax documentation & payment receipts
Employ~n	Employee engagement tools
Onecli~s	One-click re-fund / renewal reminders

The results show that Donor_Features 1 represents a “high-feature-value” segment, organizations that consistently rate nearly all features between 4.0 and 4.5 (“very useful”). These respondents are also more likely to be final decision makers (62%), have slightly higher revenues, and support a wider mix of nonprofit types. They appear to be more sophisticated, more digitally ready, and more eager for tooling that increases transparency, documentation, and engagement. Their strong emphasis on Vetted Profiles (4.5), Auto Tax Docs (4.31), and One-Click Renewal (4.27) suggests an appetite for solutions that reduce operational drag and build trust in nonprofit selection. This is the segment most primed for adoption of an integrated platform like PairWell.

In contrast, Donor_Features 2 represents a “light-feature-value” segment, organizations that rate most features between 2.5 and 3.5, indicating mild to moderate usefulness. This group includes fewer final decision makers (25%), has lower average revenue, and appears to operate with simpler giving workflows. Their lower valuation of vetted profiles, itemized projects, and automation features suggests that they may rely on informal relationships, local partners, or habitual giving rather than structured evaluation. This segment may adopt PairWell selectively but is less motivated by advanced features; instead, they may respond more to ease-of-use, cost, or a minimal “starter” tier.

Stata Output:

Donor_Features	FinalD~r	Compan~e	Giving~t	Decisi~s	Typeof~r
Corpor~y	Annual~v				
-----+-----					
-----+-----					
1	.6153846	2.307692	3.423077	2.346154	1.807692
.2692308	3.307692				
		26	26	26	26
26	26				
-----+-----					
-----+-----					
2	.25	2.25	3.5	3	1.5
.1666667	2.5				
		12	12	12	12
12	12				
-----+-----					
-----+-----					
Total	.5	2.289474	3.447368	2.552632	1.710526
.2368421	3.052632				
		38	38	38	38
38	38				

FinalD~r Final Decision Maker (1 = yes, 0 = no)
 Compan~e Company Size (employee band)
 Giving~t Corporate Giving Budget
 Decisi~s Decision Cadence for Donations/Sponsorships
 Typeof~r Type of Nonprofits Mostly Supported
 Corpor~y CSR Structure Present (1 = yes, 0 = no)
 Annual~v Annual Revenue Band

2x2 Donor Segmentation (Pain Level × Feature Value)

Pain Level ↓ / Feature Value →	High Feature Value	Low Feature Value
High Pain	Larger companies with CSR teams and more complex processes • Higher budgets and more approvals • Need verification, reporting, automation • Strongest fit for full PairWell platform	Large or growing organizations with complex processes but low digital adoption • Pain points are high but feature interest is limited • Need education, trust-building, and a simple entry point
Low Pain	Smaller organizations that value tools to streamline giving • Moderate budgets and fewer steps • Interested in visibility, convenience, and professionalism	Small, lean organizations with simple, relationship-based giving • Low operational pain and low feature interest • Least urgent need; may only adopt light/basic features

Segmentation - Nonprofit

The nonprofit pain-based segmentation reveals three distinct groups that differ meaningfully in operational friction and resource constraints.

Stata Output:

Nonprofit_Pains	Findin~r	Tailor~c	Tracki~e	Coordi~s	Follow~n
1	2.513514	2.486486	2.324324	1.837838	1.783784
	37	37	37	37	37
2	3.261905	3.404762	2.880952	3.095238	2.809524
	42	42	42	42	42
3	4.384615	4.461538	4.461538	4.769231	4.769231
	13	13	13	13	13
Total	3.119565	3.119565	2.880435	2.782609	2.673913
	92	92	92	92	92

Findin~r	Finding companies aligned to our mission & needs
Tailor~c criteria	Tailoring proposals to specific corporate giving
Tracki~e donor	Tracking and reporting impact/metrics required by the
Coordi~s	Coordinating internal approvals for partnerships
Follow~n	Following up on payment/donation receipt

Nonprofit_Pains 1 represents the “low-friction” group, where organizations report only slight to moderate pain across discovery, tailoring proposals, tracking metrics, coordinating approvals, and following up on payments (scores ~1.8–2.5). These nonprofits tend to have small development teams but manageable workloads, and their processes appear relatively stable. Nonprofit_Pains 2, the largest segment, reflects moderate friction (scores ~2.8–3.4), indicating nonprofits that struggle more with customizing proposals, managing partnership reporting requirements, and navigating internal approvals. They operate with modest development resources but experience noticeable strain that a platform like PairWell could alleviate. At the high end, Nonprofit_Pains 3 represents the “high-friction” organizations, reporting very high pain across every category (scores ~4.0–4.8). These nonprofits often deal with significantly larger or more complex development operations (Dev Team Size ~134), suggesting heavier corporate fundraising activity, grant obligations, and compliance documentation burdens.

Stata Output:

Nonprofit_Pains	Iamthe~r	Annual~t	DevTeam	Number~s	Whatis~a
DevTea~e					
1	1.783784	1.882353	.6756757	3.081081	2.114286
17.68182					

22		37	17	37	37	35
-----+-----						
8.210526	2	1.785714	2.416667	.5	3	2.04878
19		42	12	42	42	41
-----+-----						
133.875	3	1.769231	2.166667	.7692308	3.461538	2.230769
8		13	6	13	13	13
-----+-----						
32.97959	Total	1.782609	2.114286	.6086957	3.097826	2.101124
49		92	35	92	92	89
-----+-----						

Iamthe~r I am the final decision maker

Annual~t Annual Budget

DevTeam Does your organization have a development team? (1 = yes, 0 = no)

Number~s Number of full-time employees

Whatis~a What is your service area? (Local, State, Regional, National, Intl)

DevTea~e Development team size (numeric)

Feature-based segmentation reinforces and extends the pain clusters. Nonprofit_Features 2 (the high-feature-need segment) rates every product feature, project-level funding pages, dashboards, compliance support, donor vetting, volunteer tools, and automation, between 4.5 and 5.0. These nonprofits represent the “enterprise users,” those managing complex reporting cycles, larger donor portfolios, and higher administrative load. Nonprofit_Features 1, the mainstream middle, shows steady interest in all features (mid-3s to low-4s), suggesting they value technology but are not operating under acute pressure. Finally, Nonprofit_Features 3 consistently rates features around 2.5–3.0, indicating a “light-touch” group that relies more on personal relationships, local funders, or simpler operational models and would likely adopt only basic functionality.

Stata Output:

Nonprofit_Features | Creati~p Donorv~o Assist~p Centra~t
Toolst~r Automa~p Abilit~s

-----+-----						
	1		3.391304	3.847826	3.586957	3.717391
3.673913	3.869565		3.608696			
			46	46	46	46
46	46		46			
-----+-----						
	2		4.833333	4.583333	5	4.916667
4.666667	4.583333		4.5			
			12	12	12	12
12	12		12			
-----+-----						
	3		3.060606	2.969697	2.636364	3.060606
2.69697	2.484848		2.787879			
			33	33	33	33
33	33		33			
-----+-----						
	Total		3.461538	3.626374	3.428571	3.637363
3.450549	3.461538		3.428571			
			91	91	91	91
91	91		91			
-----+-----						

Together, the two analyses create a coherent picture: nonprofits experiencing high operational pain are the same ones demanding more advanced features, while low-pain organizations gravitate toward simpler, lighter solutions. Segment 2 in both models, moderate pains but moderate-to-high feature interest, signals the strongest near-term opportunity for PairWell, as these nonprofits face real operational friction yet lack the extensive infrastructure of the high-friction group. This segmentation supports a tiered product strategy: basic tools for low-pain/low-feature nonprofits, core workflow tools for mid-pain nonprofits, and a premium automation & compliance suite for high-pain, high-feature organizations.

Operational Pain ↓ / Feature Need →	High Feature Need	Low Feature Need
High Pain	Heavy workload, complex reporting, large dev teams. • High friction (4–4.8) • Need dashboards, automation, compliance • Best fit for premium tier	Overwhelmed but low-tech nonprofits. • Pain is high but digital readiness is low • Need hands-on onboarding + simplified tools
Low/Moderate Pain	Growing nonprofits seeking tools to scale. • Moderate pain, high interest in features • Strongest near-term adoption segment	Small, relationship-driven nonprofits. • Simple workflows • Fit for basic/free tier with light features

Nonprofit and Donor Surveys Summary

Among nonprofit respondents, decision power is concentrated in fundraising and leadership roles: roughly 58% of nonprofit professionals identify as final decision makers or influencers on funding from businesses, and nearly three-quarters of surveyed organizations operate with annual budgets above \$500,000. Over half (55%) already have a dedicated development team, yet their capacity is stretched, most spend at least 6–10 hours per week on corporate outreach, proposals, and reporting. This confirms that PairWell is targeting organizations that are already investing meaningful time and dollars into corporate fundraising, but are still capacity constrained.

When we look at how nonprofits currently raise corporate support, the process is fragmented and relationship-heavy. Monetary donations are the top pursuit (76%), followed by event sponsorships, employee volunteering, and in-kind support. To find corporate partners, nonprofits lean heavily on existing relationships, board/volunteer/staff networks (69%), existing donor lists (72%), chambers and business groups, and in-person events, supplemented by online search and databases. The biggest pain point in this process is “top of funnel”: 46% selected “finding companies aligned to our mission & needs” as their single highest-priority challenge, and about 70% rated core steps (finding aligned companies, tailoring proposals, tracking/reporting impact) as at least moderately challenging. Nonprofits see clear value in the proposed product: across features like donor vetting, impact dashboards, volunteer tracking, and automated receipts, a majority rated them “very” or “extremely” useful. However, adoption will hinge on risk reduction, most nonprofits say they want case studies, data-security assurances, and a live demo or free pilot before trying PairWell, and on keeping transaction fees and onboarding complexity low, which both show up as top potential deal-breakers.

On the donor side, the survey confirms that PairWell is focusing on real decision-makers rather than casual observers. Roughly 60% of corporate participants are either final decision makers, influencers, or directly involved in administering donations. Two-thirds report that their company made charitable contributions in the last 12 months, and a similar share plan to give again in the next year. The sample covers the full company-size spectrum, but is skewed toward the mid-market band that PairWell is targeting (20–499 employees and 500–5,000 employees together account for over two-thirds of respondents). Giving is diversified across monetary donations, in-kind support, employee volunteering, event sponsorships, matching gifts, and pro-bono work, and typical per-project funding often sits in the \$5,000–\$25,000 range, which is large enough to matter for small and mid-sized nonprofits.

Corporate donors face a mirror image of the nonprofits’ pain points. For the subset of respondents directly involved in giving decisions, multiple steps in the process are widely seen as difficult: more than half rate “verifying nonprofit legitimacy & impact,” “evaluating project fit and funding need,” and “tracking/reporting impact to leadership” as very or extremely challenging, and these same three steps are most often chosen as top-priority problems to solve. Discovery is already multi-channel, employee suggestions, executive and board networks, events, nonprofit outreach, and existing partners all play big roles, yet donors still struggle to find local organizations that clearly match their values and to manage inbound sponsorship requests efficiently. This maps directly onto PairWell’s core value proposition of curated, vetted nonprofit profiles tied to specific projects with clear budgets, documentation, and impact reporting.

The concept test results suggest strong product-market fit if execution is credible. Over 95% of donor respondents found the concept at least somewhat clear, and features like project-level

funding with itemized needs, vetted nonprofit profiles, impact dashboards, automatic tax documentation, and employee engagement tools were overwhelmingly rated as moderately to extremely useful. The features most likely to drive trial are also aligned with our roadmap: impact reporting, vetted profiles, and project-level transparency. However, donors, like nonprofits, are cautious about switching tools. Data privacy and security concerns, leadership resistance, onboarding complexity, lack of local projects, and cost all register as potential barriers. In line with this, donors show the strongest preference for lower-friction entry models (pay-as-you-go or a free basic tier with paid advanced features), with flat subscriptions still acceptable but slightly less favored. Combined with the Van Westendorp analysis, this supports our strategy of: (1) anchoring core pricing around nonprofit budgets and their tighter price sensitivity, (2) offering flexible entry paths (free pilot, pay-as-you-go, and tiered plans), and (3) using proof points, case studies, security documentation, and live demos, to reduce perceived risk on both sides.

Landing Page (link & screenshot)

<https://pairwell.wpenginepowered.com/interest-form/>

At PairWell, we're committed to helping you explore and connect, whether you're a donor or a nonprofit. As we're still developing and refining our platform, some aspects may be changing and improving. We appreciate your support and patience as we aim to make it easier than ever to drive meaningful impact together!

Interested? Sign up! Have a question?

A photograph of three women sitting around a table in a cafe, smiling and engaged in conversation. The woman in the center has curly hair and wears a yellow shirt and a headband. The woman on the left has long dark hair and wears a blue denim shirt. The woman on the right has blonde hair and wears a grey sweater. There are white mugs and a pen on the table. The background shows a brick wall and indoor plants.

Get early access to industry benchmarks and pilot cutting-edge features designed to maximize your corporate giving impact.

See How It Works



Showcase your mission and projects to a wider audience of engaged donors eager to support causes like yours.

Get Discovered



Discover vetted nonprofits and make informed giving decisions that ensure your support truly makes a difference.

Make an Impact Today

Please note: PairWell is a work in progress! We're still actively building, shaping, and improving this platform. Some features and content may change as we continue to develop and refine our offering. We appreciate your patience and feedback as we grow—thank you for being part of our journey!

Please fill out our form below to let us know you're interested, and we'll keep you up to date with our progress!

PairWell Interest Form

huang008@pg.arkis.edu [Switch account](#)
👤 Not shared

* Indicates required question

What's your name? *

Your answer

What's your email address? *

Your answer

What best describes you?

☐ CSR Professional
☐ Nongrofit professional
☐ Business owner
☐ Other:

Next
Clear form

Never submit passwords through Google Forms.

This form was created inside of Google Apps for UGA. [Contact form owner](#)

Does this form look suspicious? Report

Google Forms

PairWell Copyright 2025. [Privacy Policy](#)

Button Name	Location	GA4 Event Name	Total Clicks	Avg Scroll Depth	Notes
Interested? Sign up!	Top	header_signup	13	100%	Main CTA - all users see it and can help conversion intent most
Have a	Top	header_q	6	100%	Useful support link - could be used as

question?		uestion			a secondary CTA
See How It Works	Middle	csr_intere st	4	65.70%	Adjusted from 10, as some clicks are from testing
Get Discovered	Middle	nonprofit_ interest	9	65.70%	Adjusted from 11, as some clicks are from testing
Make an Impact Today	Middle	individual_ interest	3	65.70%	Adjusted from 5, as some clicks are from testing
Form	End	N/A	N/A	65.7% - 23.9%	Huge drop in scroll depth on form

LinkedIn Ads Metrics/Results (ranked by best performing)

Ad #	Spent	Key results	Cost per result	Impressions	Clicks	Average CTR	Average CPM	Average CPC
#5 – “Empower Change Through Giving”	\$95.51	35 Website Visits	\$2.73	1,238	35	2.83%	\$77.15	\$2.73
#4 – “Support Causes Seamlessly Today”	\$89.77	21 Website Visits	\$4.27	1,860	21	1.13%	\$48.26	\$4.27
#1 – “PairWell: Drive Impact Together!”	\$58.76	17 Website Visits	\$3.46	807	17	2.11%	\$72.81	\$3.46
#2 – “Discover Nonprofits That Matter”	\$70.98	13 Website Visits	\$5.46	753	13	1.73%	\$94.26	\$5.46
#3 – “Empower Impactful Connections Today”	\$61.10	13 Website Visits	\$4.70	965	13	1.35%	\$63.32	\$4.70

Linked In Ads

This first LinkedIn experiment tested five ad creatives, each with a different tone and emphasis, to see how well they drove traffic to the PairWell website across a mix of nonprofit, education, health, and for-profit business audiences. Over the short campaign window, the ads generated 5,623 impressions, 99 website visits, and \$376.12 in spend, giving us an overall click-through rate (CTR) of ~1.8% and an average CPC of about \$3.80.

Across the entire campaign, we observed a blended CPM of roughly \$66.90. At the creative level, CPMs varied from about \$48–\$94 per 1,000 impressions, reflecting different combinations of bid dynamics and click performance. The strongest-performing individual ad was “Empower Change Through Giving,” which delivered the highest number of website visits (35) at an estimated CPM of about \$77 and a CTR of ~2.8%. Other creatives were less efficient, confirming that tone and framing matter meaningfully for driving engagement.

When we look at audience type, the data suggest that CPM is roughly similar across segments, and that differences in performance show up mostly in CTR rather than media cost. Based on this test, a reasonable working estimate is a CPM of about \$65–\$70 for both mission-oriented organizations (nonprofits, education, health) and for-profit business audiences, with mission audiences converting impressions to clicks at around 2.0% CTR and for-profit audiences slightly higher at around 2.2%. These estimates provide a practical baseline for modeling future paid social acquisition costs by audience type.

Linked-In Social Media Posts

In this experiment, each team member made a post to their Linked-In Accounts about Pairwell with a message tailored to their likely audience profile (donor on non-profit). The post linked to the project website with UTM campaigns turned on. The action on the website was to complete a brief user survey. Then, using Google Analytics coupled with Linked-In Impressions on a set timeline and click through, conversion rates are estimated and used in the financial model.

From this test, social media conversions were estimated at 0.25% for non-profits and 0.06% for donors. These figures are similar to those of the advertising experiment.

Churn Secondary Research

Totango – SaaS Trial Conversion & Metrics

Link:

<https://www.totango.com/blog/how-to-best-measure-conversion-rates-of-trial-usage-part-1-defining-an-active-user-and-setting-a-baseline-over-the-next-few-weeks-totango-will-be-posting-a-blog-series-on-best-practices>

Summary: Totango's trial conversion best-practices series emphasizes that trial conversion is one of the single most important SaaS metrics. They show that many companies see relatively low trial-to-paid conversion rates and that most of the leverage comes from improving trial activation and defining what an 'active' trial user is, rather than chasing an abstract average conversion number.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, this supports modeling high trial churn (most signups never activate), and using product-led activation tactics (guided project creation, clear 'active' definitions) as the main driver of better trial-to-paid conversion over time.

OpenView Partners – SaaS & Product Benchmarks

Link: <https://www.openviewpartners.com/2022-product-benchmarks/>

Summary: OpenView's product benchmarks report shows that only about 5% of freemium signups convert to paid, and that free-trial products typically convert at roughly twice the rate of freemium. It highlights that companies must define an 'activation' moment where the product delivers its promised value, and that freemium conversion typically sits in the 2–5% range with top performers modestly higher.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, nonprofit or donor freemium-style tiers should be modeled with very low free-to-paid conversion (2–5%), and free-trial flows should target 10–25% conversion in optimistic cases. This justifies assuming that most free users never pay unless activation is deliberately engineered.

Monetizely – Guide to Free Trial Conversion (citing OpenView)

Link:

<https://www.getmonetizely.com/articles/the-complete-guide-to-measuring-free-trial-signup-and-activation-rates-for-saas-success>

Summary: This guide summarizes SaaS trial benchmarks and explicitly cites OpenView's SaaS metrics: trial signup rates around 3–5% of website visitors, trial activation rates around 40–60% for well-optimized products, and trial-to-paid conversion typically in the 15–25% range for self-serve B2B SaaS, higher when sales assist is involved.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, a realistic base-case trial-to-paid conversion band is 15–25% for engaged users, which translates into 75–85% total trial churn. The current model's trial churn parameters should be moved toward this reality unless you're deliberately modeling a very optimistic scenario.

Userpilot – SaaS Free Trial Conversion Rate Benchmarks

Link: <https://userpilot.com/blog/saas-average-conversion-rate/>

Summary: Userpilot aggregates recent SaaS benchmarks and notes that there is no single 'average' conversion rate. They report opt-in trials (credit card required) averaging around the high-teens, opt-out trials much higher, and B2B free-trial conversion commonly in the 15–30% range, depending on ICP and price point.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell's opt-out, low-ACV B2B motion with nonprofits and SMB donors, using a 15–25% base-case trial conversion rate is consistent with these benchmarks and supports the assumption that most churn happens during the free period rather than after payment.

OpenView – Freemium vs Free Trial

Link: <https://openviewpartners.com/blog/freemium-vs-free-trial/>

Summary: OpenView's analysis shows that median free-to-paid conversion for free trials is roughly twice that of freemium (about 14% vs. 7%). Free trials create urgency and better align with revenue-focused motions, while freemium is better for broad top-of-funnel growth when monetization can be delayed.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, this supports a hybrid strategy: time-boxed trials for donor and higher-tier nonprofit plans (where monetization matters), and possibly a small

forever-free tier with low upgrade expectation. The model should reflect higher conversion on time-bound trials than on freemium-style tiers.

Wall Street Journal – "When Freemium Fails" (Needleman & Loten)

Link: <https://www.wsj.com/articles/SB10000872396390443713704577603782317318996>

Summary: This WSJ article discusses cases where freemium models attract large volumes of free users but struggle to convert them into paying customers. Many businesses discover that free users derive enough value without upgrading, and that the cost to support free usage can outweigh the revenue from a small paying minority.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, this reinforces the need for clear differentiation between free and paid offerings. Paid tiers (for nonprofits and donors) must offer distinct, ongoing benefits (e.g., visibility, analytics, integrations, or concierge matching) beyond what is available on the free tier; otherwise churn from upgraded tiers back to free will be high.

KeyBanc Capital Markets & Sapphire Ventures – SaaS Survey

Link:

https://www.cfodesk.co.il/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/2024_kbcm_sapphire_saas_survey.pdf

Summary: The long-running KBCM private SaaS survey tracks growth, profitability, and efficiency metrics. It consistently shows that lower-ACV and SMB-focused SaaS companies experience higher logo churn than enterprise-focused peers, with many SMB-oriented companies in the 30–40% annual churn band or higher.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, which targets nonprofits and SMB donors (effectively lower-ACV segments), paid churn assumptions in the 30–40% annual range (about 3–4% per month) are more realistic than assuming either very low enterprise-style churn or extremely high, unsustainable churn.

Mixpanel – Retention Benchmarks & Retention Basics

Link: <https://mixpanel.com/benchmarks>

Summary: Mixpanel's benchmarks and documentation on retention show that many digital products have relatively low multi-week or multi-month retention (e.g., 6–20% eight-week retention for typical apps) and that retention is best understood via cohort curves over time. Their Retention report conceptually aligns with modeling churn as an ongoing hazard applied to each cohort.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, this supports the current cohort-based churn engine. Monthly churn applied to each cohort over time is a realistic way to represent the exponential decay seen in real product usage and aligns with tools you're likely to use later for analytics.

Amplitude – Product Benchmarks & Product Report

Link: <https://amplitude.com/benchmarks>

Summary: Amplitude's benchmarks and Product Report highlight activation, engagement, and retention as the key drivers of sustainable growth. They show that companies with clearly defined activation events and short 'time to value' achieve significantly better retention and long-term product performance.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, it is reasonable to explicitly connect activation (e.g., posting a project, favoriting nonprofits, or completing a first match) to lower churn in future iterations of the model. Over time, you may want churn rates to decrease as activation and usage deepen.

Reforge / Brian Balfour – Retention as the Growth Engine

Link: <https://www.reforge.com/guides/improve-user-engagement>

Summary: Balfour and Reforge frame retention as the central driver of sustainable growth, arguing that activation, engagement, and resurrection are the primary inputs into a strong retention curve. They emphasize that retention improvements increase LTV and often make acquisition more efficient (e.g., via referrals and word-of-mouth).

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, retention (low churn) will be crucial for referrals and network effects: satisfied donors and nonprofits are more likely to invite peers. Modeling a modest reduction in churn over time as the product improves is well supported by this framework.

Fader & Hardie – Probability Models for Customer-Base Analysis

Link: https://faculty.wharton.upenn.edu/wp-content/uploads/2012/04/Fader_hardie_jim_09.pdf

Summary: Fader and Hardie present probability models for customer-base analysis, showing how retention and churn can be modeled as stochastic processes with exponential-style survival functions. They demonstrate that small improvements in retention can have outsized impacts on firm value compared with similar changes in discount rates or acquisition costs.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, this provides academic support for focusing on churn as a key lever in the financial model. Reducing paid churn a few percentage points over time can materially lift customer lifetime value and justify higher acquisition spending once the product is proven.

Mixpanel – "What's a Good Retention Rate?"

Link: <https://mixpanel.com/blog/whats-a-good-retention-rate/>

Summary: Mixpanel's article shows that many apps and software products have 6–20% eight-week retention, and that teams should study where drop-offs occur and work backward to improve early retention. It reinforces the idea that early user behavior is a strong predictor of whether a customer will stick around.

Implication for PairWell: For PairWell, this suggests that most churn decisions are made early. Your model's assumption that trial churn is much higher than paid churn is directionally correct, and future product work should focus on the first few weeks of a nonprofit or donor's journey.

Recommended Churn Assumptions for PairWell (Base Case)

Category	Monthly Churn Assumption	Notes / Rationale
Free Trial – Nonprofits	40–60% per month	High drop-off during trial; implies ~10–25% trial-to-paid conversion over a 2–3 month free period.
Free Trial – Donors	30–50% per month	Donors may have slightly higher intent than nonprofits but still experience substantial trial churn.
Paid – Nonprofit Tiers (early stage)	4–6% per month	Aligns with SMB SaaS benchmarks; annual churn roughly 40–55% while product and fit are still maturing.
Paid – Donor Tiers (early stage)	3–5% per month	Somewhat more stable if donors see recurring value in discovering nonprofits and tracking impact.
Paid – All Tiers (mature product scenario)	1–3% per month	Represents improved retention driven by better activation, integrations, and network effects over time.

Business (Donor) Segmentation by Size and Revenue

Segment	Definition (headcount / revenue)	Participate (est. %)	# of firms (est.) / (estimated # of donors)
Small	1–99 employees (typical)	66%	6.1 ~ 6.2 M (4 M)
Mid	100–999 employees (typical) \$50M–\$1B revenue	~70%	150k (105k)
Large	1,000+ employees (typical) \$1B+ revenue (varies)	92%+	12 ~ 20 k

Notes (for definition): Gartner defines mid size businesses as 100- 999 employees \$50M to \$1B revenue.

Sources: Notes (for sizing): total employer firms ≈ 6.295M (SBA FAQ, Jul 2024). Size split by firms: 1–99 (97.5%), 100–499 (2.1%), 500–999 (0.3%), 1,000+ (0.2%) — BLS BED (2019, CRR). Participation: Small 66% (U.S. Chamber, 2022); Mid ~70% (multiple mid-market CSR surveys); Large ≥92% (CECP). Cause/format patterns summarized from CECP & America's Charities.

Operational Costs for Development

Overview

Pairwell's technology stack and development pipeline follow a phased approach designed to balance rapid early development with long-term scalability and enterprise compliance. The process begins with contracted engineering work to establish the foundational platform, then transitions to a growing in-house engineering team as we begin to scale feature development, integrations, analytics, and AI-powered user experiences.

Development Timeline and Staffing

Role	Start Month	Purpose	Notes on Cost
Contract Developer (Initial Build)	Month 0	Establish core infrastructure, deployment, and initial matching/profile features.	\$50,000 (one-time).

Senior Developer (Lead Engineer)	Month 3	Own architecture, ensure code quality, and guide transition from contractor to internal team.	Full-time salaried.
Developer 2	Month 6	Support core feature expansion and backend systems.	Full-time salaried.
Developer 3	Month 10	Extend integrations, analytics, reporting, and scalability features.	Full-time salaried.
UX Designer	Month 10	Improve usability, accessibility, and overall experience.	Full-time salaried or contract.

Each team member receives:

- A standard development laptop
- Access to **Linear** (project management, \$16/user/month)
- A **Cursor Ultra** subscription (\$200/user/month) to enable accelerated AI-assisted development

Core Technology Stack

Layer / Service	Technology or Vendor	Purpose	Notes / Source
Hosting & Deployment	Fly.io	Primary hosting, app deployment, server runtime environments.	Costs scale with compute/storage; based on Fly.io pricing calculator (link in final plan).
Primary Database	PostgreSQL on Fly.io	Reliable structured storage for nonprofit, donor, and project data.	Scales with storage and IOPS tiers.

Enterprise Authentication & Compliance Layer	WorkOS	Provides SSO, directory sync, audit logs, security features supporting enterprise requirements.	\$150 per enterprise user ; pricing scales with modules and usage.
Payments	Classy (preferred) or comparable	Donation processing and nonprofit payout workflows.	Transaction fees passed through to customers ; typical range 2–10%.
Nonprofit Data	Candid Database	EIN validation, enriched nonprofit profiles, categorization.	\$9,995/year subscription.
Project Management	Linear	Sprint planning, tasks, documentation.	\$16 per user per month.
AI-Assisted Development	Cursor Ultra	Code generation, code review, automated refactoring.	\$200 per user per month.

This stack ensures a cloud-native, compliance-ready platform with elasticity in both compute and authentication capacity.

Cost Structure and Scaling

Initial Capital Expenditure (Months 0–6)

- **\$50,000** contract for MVP and infrastructure setup
- ~\$5,000 in initial environment/tooling setup
- Early Fly.io and Postgres compute costs relatively low due to small user load

Ongoing Operating Costs (Post-MVP)

- **Fly.io + PostgreSQL**: ~\$300–\$500/mo to start, scaling with usage
- **WorkOS**: \$150 per enterprise user, increases as enterprise accounts onboard
- **Candid**: \$9,995/year
- **Linear**: \$16/user/month
- **Cursor Ultra**: \$200/user/month
- Additional cloud/storage costs scale with user volume and AI utilization

Scalability

- Fly.io scales linearly with traffic and compute demand

- WorkOS scales predictably with enterprise user count
- AI workloads introduce additional variable compute cost (noted in COGS section below)

Cost of Goods Sold (COGS) Considerations

Pairwell's COGS model includes two primary variable components:

① AI Compute Usage Integrated Into the User Experience

The platform includes **AI-assisted features** (e.g., matching insights, content generation, recommendations), which require additional compute usage. These costs scale based on:

- Volume of queries generated by nonprofit and donor users
- Size of user base
- Model selection and prompt complexity

In the financial model, COGS reflects a baseline compute assumption per active user per month to account for these AI-driven interactions.

WorkOS Enterprise Authentication Fees (\$145 per Enterprise User)

Each enterprise (corporate or institutional) customer that requires:

- SSO
- Directory sync
- Audit trails
- Enhanced access controls

Is billed at **\$150 per month per active enterprise user seat**.

These WorkOS fees appear directly in COGS because they scale with customer usage and are essential to delivering enterprise-grade security and compliance.

Why This Matters for SOC-2

WorkOS provides foundational infrastructure — logs, IAM components, authentication security — that reduces the complexity of achieving SOC-2 Type II compliance. Because SOC-2 is a milestone, WorkOS is a critical dependency that allows Pairwell to:

- Implement compliant authentication from the start
- Avoid building high-risk security infrastructure in-house
- Maintain predictable per-user enterprise COGS as the platform scales

Summary Statement

The Pairwell technology stack is designed to deliver rapid early development, strong security posture, and long-term scalability. Early reliance on contracted engineering enables a fast MVP, while Fly.io, PostgreSQL, WorkOS, Candid, and AI-assisted tooling provide a modern, flexible foundation. The cost structure is predictable and usage-based, aligning expenditure with actual growth.

This infrastructure positions Pairwell for efficient development, enterprise readiness, SOC-2 alignment, and a scalable cost model as adoption increases.

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Financial Model

PairWell Financial Model Report

SaaS platform connecting nonprofits and donors

PairWell

November 20, 2025

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1 Executive Summary

PairWell is a SaaS platform connecting **nonprofits** and **donors**.

This draft report reflects the **Base Pricing Scenario** and outlines expected financial performance based on several assumptions relating marketing activities with user acquisition, a draft pricing model, operational and cost assumptions. **This scenario describes actual planned pricing, user acquisition and operational expenses..**

2 Introduction

This report presents the 60-month financial and operational projection for PairWell, a SaaS platform connecting nonprofits and corporate donors. The model integrates user acquisition dynamics, pricing, operating costs, and financing assumptions into a single forward-looking simulation. It shows how growth strategy, staffing, and marketing investments translate into recurring revenue, cash flow, and valuation over time.

2.1 Model Overview

The model simulates monthly user acquisition across multiple channels—email outreach, social (CPM-based), programmatic (CPA-based), organic referrals, time-bound events with free trials, and competitions. New nonprofit and donor users are tracked through conversion and churn cycles, with the ability to phase in marketing intensity, staffing capacity, and productivity multipliers.

Revenue combines tiered subscription income, Employee Engagement and Concierge add-ons, and donation-fee revenue (if applicable). Cost of Goods Sold (COGS) includes per-user platform costs, concierge delivery, and processing fees. Operating expenses include staff salaries by department, benefits and raises, general and administrative schedules, depreciation from laptop CapEx, and inflation adjustments. The financing section models equity rounds, debt, and interest flows to produce monthly cash projections and free cash flow for valuation.

2.2 Adjustable Parameters

All major drivers can be modified directly in the assumptions tables:

Timeline & policy: start date, horizon, tax rate, working capital, and inflation.

Acquisition levers: spend schedules and conversion rates for email, social, programmatic, organic, referral, event, and competition channels.

Phasing: per-phase multipliers to turn channels on or off or scale productivity.

Pricing & mix: subscription tiers, concierge pricing, employee-engagement add-ons, and donation fees.

Churn and conversion: monthly churn vectors and trial-to-paid conversion rates.

Staffing: hires, salaries, raises, and departmental allocations.

Financing: equity rounds, loans, and valuation discount rates.

2.3 Report Contents

The report compiles all key outputs from the model, including:

Assumptions summary: a compact table of core financial, operational, and phase inputs.

User acquisition dashboard: stacked channel view of total nonprofit and donor users over time.

Revenue and cost waterfall: monthly recurring revenue (MRR) and COGS by product line.

Operating expenses by category: salaries, general & administrative, sales/marketing, and depreciation.

Profit & loss and cash flow summary: gross margin, EBITDA, operating income, ending cash, and burn rate.

Financing and valuation: equity and debt schedules, discounted cash flows, NPV and IRR outputs.

KPI highlights: year-end metrics such as ARR, cash position, and cumulative user base.

Together, the model and report provide a transparent, scenario-driven view of how PairWell’s strategy scales—from early acquisition and staffing to sustainable revenue growth and investor-grade financial performance.

The figures and analysis in this report are financial projections based on a variety of assumptions. These figures are not a guarantee of future financial performance and all investors should conduct their own due diligence.

3 Scenario Overview and Assumptions

3.1 Model Overview

Key assumptions used in the model are listed with explanatory notes.

Key	Value
Model Start Date	2026-01-01
Horizon (months)	60
Starting Cash	\$0
Tax Rate	28.84%
Working Capital % of Revenue	10.00%

3.2 Pricing (tiers & customer shares)

The pricing model and shares of each customer assumed in each pricing model for this projection. Shares and pricing are derived from customer surveys.

Segment	Tier_ID	Price	Share
Nonprofit	core	\$49	37.00%
Nonprofit	plus	\$94	35.00%
Nonprofit	premium	\$139	28.00%
Donor	core	\$299	37.00%
Donor	plus	\$449	35.00%
Donor	premium	\$680	28.00%

3.3 Customer acquisition & lifecycle assumptions

Key	Value	Unit	Notes
Founders (count)	1	count	Founders conduct activities until marketing hire
Contacts per Staff per Month	500	contacts	NA
Base Contact conversion rate	0.85%	percent	Based on initial email response/open rates in tests
Split to Donor	30.00%	percent	Donor share of contacts, strategic target
Split to Nonprofit	70.00%	percent	NP share of contacts, strategic target.
Referrals/user/month	33.33%	ratio	Average referrals generated per active user per month, assumed as model of organic acquisition.
Referral conversion rate	2.80%	percent	Percent referrals who become trial customers, assumed based on qualitative interviews.
CPM (Donor)	\$85	\$	Estimated based on Linked-In Advertising experiment
CPM (Nonprofit)	\$65	\$	Estimated based on Linked-In Advertising experiment
Social CVR (Donor)	0.06%	percent	Estimated from Linked-In Post funnel experiment
Social CVR (Nonprofit)	0.25%	percent	Estimated from Linked-In Post funnel experiment
CPA (Donor)	\$85	\$	Inferred from industry standards and Linked-In Ads.
CPA (Nonprofit)	\$65	\$	Inferred from industry standards and Linked-In Ads.
EE take-rate on donors	15.00%	percent	Completely assumed. | Target share of active donor customers that add EE.
EE official start month	24	month	Baseline; per-phase override applied.
EE uptake (Plus donors)	6.00%	percent	Share of Plus-tier donors expected to purchase EE add-on. Completely assumed.
EE uptake (Premium donors)	7.00%	percent	Share of Premium-tier donors expected to purchase EE add-on. Completely assumed.
EE price multiplier	40.00%	ratio	Multiplier on base donor subscription price for EE add-on. Completely assumed.
Concierge rate of total users	2.00%	percent	Applied to total active users. | Share of active users expected to launch concierge projects.
Projects per user per year	1	projects/user/year	Average # of concierge projects per active user per year.
Price per NP project	\$450	\$	NA
Price per donor project	\$1,000	\$	NA
Spend per marketer cap	\$2,000,000	\$/month/staffer	Caps total paid channel spend managed per FTE.
Average annual donation per donor	\$10,000	\$	Assumed mean annual donation volume per active donor.
Average monthly donation per donor	\$833	\$	Derived as annual / 12. | Assumed monthly donation volume per active donor.
Social spend (Donor)	varies, see expenses	\$/month	Y1 EOY = \$600; Y3 EOY = \$2,580; Y5 EOY = \$5,350; n = 60 months
Social spend (Nonprofit)	varies, see expenses	\$/month	Y1 EOY = \$600; Y3 EOY = \$2,580; Y5 EOY = \$5,350; n = 60 months
Programmatic spend (Donor)	varies, see expenses	\$/month	Y1 EOY = \$360; Y3 EOY = \$1,548; Y5 EOY = \$3,210; n = 60 months

Key	Value	Unit	Notes
Programmatic spend (Nonprofit)	varies, see expenses	\$/month	Y1 EOY = \$360; Y3 EOY = \$1,548; Y5 EOY = \$3,210; n = 60 months
NP trial churn	40.00%	percent	Monthly churn rate for nonprofits during free/trial period. Estimated from industry comparables. | Constant 40.00% per month over 60 months.
NP paid churn	6.50%	percent	Monthly churn rate for nonprofits once paying. Estimated from industry comparables. | Constant 6.50% per month over 60 months.
Donor trial churn	40.00%	percent	Monthly churn rate for donors during free/trial period. Estimated from industry comparables. | Constant 40.00% per month over 60 months.
Donor paid churn	5.00%	percent	Monthly churn rate for donors once paying. Estimated from industry comparables. | Constant 5.00% per month over 60 months.
NP free subscription length	3	months	Number of free months nonprofits receive before subscription MRR starts.
Donor free subscription length	1	months	Number of free months donors receive before subscription MRR starts.

3.3.1 Marketing/Development Phase Timelines

Phase	Start (M)	End (M)	Start Date	End Date
P1	1	12	Jan 2026	Dec 2026
P2	13	24	Jan 2027	Dec 2027
P3	25	36	Jan 2028	Dec 2028
P4	37	60	Jan 2029	Dec 2030

3.3.2 Phase Efficiency Adjustments

This section shows how baseline assumptions are turned up or down based on the development/marketing phase. Generally, from the researched assumptions we assume lower effectiveness of marketing strategies earlier and increased effectiveness later.

Adjustment	P1	P2	P3	P4
Email productivity (x)	×1.00	×1.10	×1.00	×1.00
Paid-channel spend (x)	×1.00	×1.00	×1.00	×1.00
Social CPM efficiency (x)	×1.10	×1.00	×0.90	×0.85
Programmatic CPA efficiency (x)	×1.10	×1.00	×0.90	×0.85
NP organic adds (x)	×0.40	×1.05	×1.20	×1.12
Donor organic adds (x)	×0.40	×1.05	×1.20	×1.12
Concierge take-rate (x)	×0.60	×0.70	×1.10	×1.00
Employee Engagement enabled	Off	Off	Off	Off
EE start month (effective)	24	24	24	24

3.4 COGS assumptions

Key	Value	Unit	Notes
Platform fixed monthly	\$1,325	\$/month	Hosting + SOC2 stack + Candid subscription.
COGS per NP user	\$2	\$/user/month	Additional costs per user, estimated from anticipated compute.
COGS per Donor user	\$4	\$/user/month	Additional costs per user, estimated from anticipated compute.
SOC 2 COGS per Donor premium user	\$145	\$/premium user/month	Incremental Work OS / SOC 2 stack; applies only to paid donor premium (enterprise) users. | Incremental per-user cost for donor Premium-tier enterprise customers.
COGS per EE user	\$0	\$/user/month	Estimated per user cost for employee add-on
Donation processing fee	0.00%	percent	Applied to gross donation volume.
Concierge COGS % of concierge	40.00%	percent	Estimated non-staff costs.

3.5 Operating and other expense assumptions

Key	Value	Unit	Notes
Global non-salary inflation (annual)	3.00%	percent	COGS & OPEX inflation factor, estimated.
Inflation start month	1	month	NA
Annual step raise rate	3.50%	percent	Applies on anniversaries after wait period.
Step raise wait (months)	12	months	NA
Fringe rate on salaries	21.00%	percent	NA
Laptop cost per new hire	\$2,000	\$	Straight-line depreciation.
Depreciation months (laptops)	36	months	NA
R&D contractor (total)	\$50,000	\$	Contract development scope, months 1-6.
R&D contractor months	6	months	NA

3.6 Software Capitalization Policy

Software development capitalization are calculated by percentages of overall development spend as an estimate of eligible expenses for capitalization.

Phase	Cap rate	Life (months)
Phase 1 - R&D	70.00%	36
Phase 2 - Build	55.00%	36
Phase 3 - Scale	0.00%	24
Phase 4 - Optimize	0.00%	18

3.7 Financing, tax, giving & other assumptions

Key	Value	Unit	Notes
Starting Cash	\$0	\$	NA
Combined Tax Rate	28.84%	percent	NA
NWC % of Revenue	10.00%	percent	Target net working capital as a share of Total_MRR. Used to determine FCF.
Donation fee rate	0.00%	percent	Applied to Monthly Donation Amount.
PairWell Giving rate	1.00%	percent	Share of Total_MRR allocated to PairWell Giving.
SOC 2 coverage rule	Paid donor premium only	text	Applies only to paid donor Premium-tier (enterprise) users. | Defines which users incur incremental SOC 2 / Work OS stack COGS.
ARR definition	12 x Total_MRR in Dec of Year 5	text	Year 5 December MRR is annualized; donations and non-recurring revenue excluded. | Defines how ARR (Year 5) is derived from subscription MRR.

3.8 Financing Assumptions

Potential Investments are modeled for purposes of analysis only and do not represent actual planned investments or valuations.

3.8.1 Equity Rounds (Inputs)

MonthNum	Round	Amount	Share Price	Pre-Money	Post-Money (Implied)
1	Seed	\$250,000	\$0.29	\$3,400,000	\$3,650,000

3.8.2 Cap Table (Starting)

Owner	Shares	Percent
Founders	10,000,000	83.3%
Option Pool	2,000,000	16.7%

3.8.3 Loan Schedules (Inputs)

Loan Name	Draw Month	Amount	APR	Term (Months)	Amort Start Mo.
Seed Note	1	\$0	10.00%	24	13
Venture Debt	20	\$0	12.00%	36	26

4 Summary of Projected Performance

Key performance indicators and projected valuations are estimates and not guarantees of performance. Investor should conduct their own due diligence.

4.1 Annual Key Performance Indicators

Annual KPIs (metrics transposed; single source = df_y)

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Total Revenue	\$87,155	\$921,509	\$1,852,996	\$3,111,677	\$5,141,624
COGS	\$38,074	\$158,883	\$208,236	\$346,600	\$569,780
Gross Profit	\$49,081	\$762,626	\$1,644,759	\$2,765,077	\$4,571,844
Gross Margin %	56.3%	82.8%	88.8%	88.9%	88.9%
OPEX	\$140,040	\$582,229	\$1,015,666	\$1,416,957	\$1,678,381
Operating Income	-\$101,973	\$162,064	\$607,260	\$1,334,634	\$2,886,186
Interest	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Taxes	\$1,367	\$64,381	\$175,134	\$384,908	\$832,376
Ending Cash	\$239,890	\$200,873	\$639,627	\$1,582,223	\$3,625,666
Depreciation	\$11,014	\$18,333	\$21,833	\$13,486	\$7,278
EBITDA	-\$90,959	\$180,397	\$629,093	\$1,348,120	\$2,893,464
EBITDA Margin %	-104.4%	19.6%	34.0%	43.3%	56.3%
Avg ARPA	\$80	\$148	\$167	\$174	\$188
Avg CAC (Blended)	\$131	\$115	\$94	\$73	\$65
Users (End)	161	747	1,058	1,931	2,513

4.2 Valuation Estimates

KPI	Value
Project IRR (annualized)	167.18%
Nominal Discount Rate	30.00%
NPV (Nominal, Unlevered FCF)	\$1,151,360
Real Discount Rate (derived)	26.21%
NPV (Real, Unlevered FCF)	\$1,151,360
ARR (Year 5)	\$5,913,932
EBITDA (Year 5)	\$2,893,464

4.2.1 Valuation

Valuation Comparison — DCF vs. EBITDA Exit Multiple (based on projected free cash flows and KPI summary inputs).

Method	Description	Discount Rate	Terminal Growth	Estimated Valuation
DCF with Perpetual Growth (FCF)	PV of 5-year projected free cash flows plus a perpetual-growth terminal value based on FCF.	30.0%	4.5%	\$3,307,700
EBITDA Exit Multiple (Year 5 EBITDA × 8)	PV of 5-year projected free cash flows plus a terminal exit value based on Year 5 EBITDA times an exit multiple.	30.0%	4.5%	\$7,286,660

4.3 Initial Capitalization Table

Initial Cap Table — before Seed investment (Base scenario, implied values at pre-money).

Holder	Shares_Pre_Round	Ownership % (Pre-Round)	Invested (\$)	Implied Value @ Pre-Money
Founders	10,000,000	85.3%	\$0	\$2,900,000
Option Pool	2,000,000	17.1%	\$0	\$580,000

4.4 Post Round Funding Capitalization Table

Cap Table — after Seed investment (Base scenario, with implied value at post-money).

Holder	Shares_Post_Round	Ownership % (Post-Round)	Invested (\$)	Implied Value @ Post-Money
Founders	10,000,000	77.6%	\$0	\$2,833,333
Option Pool	2,000,000	15.5%	\$0	\$566,667
Seed Investor	882,353	6.8%	\$255,882	\$250,000

5 Customers and donations

Customers & donations — Monthly (first 24 months)

Year	Month	Nonprofit subscriptions (total)	Nonprofit subscriptions (paid)	Nonprofit subscriptions (unpaid)	Donor subscriptions (total)	Donor subscriptions (paid)	Donor subscriptions (unpaid)	Employee add-on customers	Donations (amount)	Concierge projects
2026	Jan	3	0	3	1	0	1	0	\$833	0
2026	Feb	5	0	5	2	1	1	0	\$1,667	0
2026	Mar	6	0	6	2	1	1	0	\$1,667	0
2026	Apr	7	1	6	3	2	1	0	\$2,500	0
2026	May	7	1	6	3	2	1	0	\$2,500	0
2026	Jun	11	2	9	6	3	3	0	\$5,000	0
2026	Jul	34	2	32	13	4	9	0	\$10,833	0
2026	Aug	52	3	49	19	10	9	0	\$15,833	0
2026	Sep	62	4	58	43	14	29	0	\$35,833	0
2026	Oct	71	10	61	61	31	30	0	\$50,833	0
2026	Nov	78	16	62	78	48	30	0	\$65,000	0
2026	Dec	87	21	66	74	63	11	0	\$61,667	0
2027	Jan	104	27	77	82	67	15	0	\$68,333	0
2027	Feb	116	32	84	87	72	15	0	\$72,500	0
2027	Mar	268	37	231	120	78	42	0	\$100,000	1
2027	Apr	373	45	328	143	99	44	0	\$119,167	1
2027	May	435	51	384	139	120	19	0	\$115,833	1
2027	Jun	444	89	355	175	126	49	0	\$145,833	1
2027	Jul	481	126	355	215	149	66	0	\$179,167	1
2027	Aug	398	160	238	233	181	52	0	\$194,167	1
2027	Sep	358	185	173	225	203	22	0	\$187,500	1
2027	Oct	353	213	140	231	206	25	0	\$192,500	1
2027	Nov	358	214	144	236	211	25	0	\$196,667	1
2027	Dec	506	214	292	241	215	26	0	\$200,833	1

Customers & donations — Quarterly (entire horizon)

Year	Quarter	Nonprofit subscriptions (end, total)	Nonprofit subscriptions (end, paid)	Nonprofit subscriptions (end, unpaid)	Donor subscriptions (end, total)	Donor subscriptions (end, paid)	Donor subscriptions (end, unpaid)	Employee add-on customers (end)	Donations (amount)	Concierge projects
2026	1	6	0	6	2	1	1	0	\$4,167	0
2026	2	11	2	9	6	3	3	0	\$10,000	0
2026	3	62	4	58	43	14	29	0	\$62,500	0
2026	4	87	21	66	78	63	30	0	\$177,500	0
2027	1	268	37	231	120	78	42	0	\$240,833	1
2027	2	444	89	384	175	126	49	0	\$380,833	3
2027	3	481	185	355	233	203	66	0	\$560,833	3
2027	4	506	214	292	241	215	26	0	\$590,000	3
2028	1	683	252	464	268	236	32	0	\$650,000	7
2028	2	555	322	268	300	263	37	0	\$726,667	6
2028	3	602	334	268	346	303	56	0	\$840,833	7
2028	4	666	357	309	392	342	50	0	\$945,000	9
2029	1	771	387	384	454	392	62	0	\$1,087,500	9
2029	2	890	435	455	526	454	72	0	\$1,259,167	10
2029	3	1035	496	539	614	528	86	0	\$1,466,667	12
2029	4	1213	572	641	718	617	101	0	\$1,714,167	14
2030	1	1309	666	643	805	703	102	0	\$1,942,500	15
2030	2	1388	743	645	881	778	103	0	\$2,140,833	17
2030	3	1454	807	647	947	843	104	0	\$2,313,333	18
2030	4	1508	860	648	1005	901	104	0	\$2,465,833	18

Customers & donations — Annual (transposed)

Metric	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Concierge projects	0	10	29	45	68
Donations (amount)	\$254,167	\$1,772,500	\$3,162,500	\$5,527,500	\$8,862,500
Donor subscriptions (end, paid)	63	215	342	617	901
Donor subscriptions (end, total)	78	241	392	718	1005
Donor subscriptions (end, unpaid)	30	66	56	101	104
Employee add-on customers (end)	0	0	0	0	0
Nonprofit subscriptions (end, paid)	21	214	357	572	860
Nonprofit subscriptions (end, total)	87	506	683	1213	1508
Nonprofit subscriptions (end, unpaid)	66	384	464	641	648

6 Revenue

Revenue by Type — Monthly (Months 1–24)

Year	Month	NP Subscriptions	Donor Subscriptions	Employee Engagement	Donation Fee	Concierge	Total
1	Jan	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
1	Feb	\$0	\$299	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$299
1	Mar	\$0	\$299	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$299
1	Apr	\$49	\$748	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$797
1	May	\$49	\$748	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$797
1	Jun	\$143	\$1,428	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$1,571

Year	Month	NP Subscriptions	Donor Subscriptions	Employee Engagement	Donation Fee	Concierge	Total
1	Jul	\$143	\$1,727	\$0	\$0	\$38	\$1,908
1	Aug	\$282	\$4,583	\$0	\$0	\$38	\$4,902
1	Sep	\$331	\$6,460	\$0	\$0	\$38	\$6,828
1	Oct	\$895	\$14,348	\$0	\$0	\$121	\$15,364
1	Nov	\$1,414	\$21,855	\$0	\$0	\$121	\$23,390
1	Dec	\$1,884	\$28,995	\$0	\$0	\$121	\$31,000
2	Jan	\$2,448	\$30,722	\$0	\$0	\$158	\$33,328
2	Feb	\$2,873	\$32,898	\$0	\$0	\$158	\$35,929
2	Mar	\$3,298	\$35,754	\$0	\$0	\$279	\$39,331
2	Apr	\$4,005	\$45,519	\$0	\$0	\$354	\$49,878
2	May	\$4,569	\$55,134	\$0	\$0	\$392	\$60,095
2	Jun	\$8,006	\$57,609	\$0	\$0	\$475	\$66,090
2	Jul	\$11,304	\$68,353	\$0	\$0	\$512	\$80,170
2	Aug	\$14,410	\$83,000	\$0	\$0	\$475	\$97,885
2	Sep	\$16,670	\$93,064	\$0	\$0	\$438	\$110,172
2	Oct	\$19,167	\$94,492	\$0	\$0	\$438	\$114,096
2	Nov	\$19,261	\$96,668	\$0	\$0	\$438	\$116,366
2	Dec	\$19,261	\$98,395	\$0	\$0	\$512	\$118,168

Revenue by Type — Quarterly (All 5 Years)

Year	Quarter	NP Subscriptions	Donor Subscriptions	Employee Engagement	Donation Fee	Concierge	Total
1	Q1	\$0	\$598	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$598
1	Q2	\$241	\$2,924	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$3,165
1	Q3	\$756	\$12,770	\$0	\$0	\$112	\$13,638
1	Q4	\$4,193	\$65,198	\$0	\$0	\$362	\$69,754
2	Q1	\$8,619	\$99,374	\$0	\$0	\$596	\$108,589
2	Q2	\$16,580	\$158,262	\$0	\$0	\$1,221	\$176,063
2	Q3	\$42,384	\$244,417	\$0	\$0	\$1,425	\$288,226
2	Q4	\$57,689	\$289,555	\$0	\$0	\$1,388	\$348,632
3	Q1	\$61,927	\$313,668	\$0	\$0	\$3,038	\$378,632
3	Q2	\$83,640	\$348,742	\$0	\$0	\$2,933	\$435,315
3	Q3	\$89,243	\$397,266	\$0	\$0	\$3,296	\$489,805
3	Q4	\$94,425	\$451,122	\$0	\$0	\$3,696	\$549,243
4	Q1	\$101,912	\$513,994	\$0	\$0	\$3,854	\$619,760
4	Q2	\$113,261	\$593,458	\$0	\$0	\$4,412	\$711,132
4	Q3	\$128,705	\$688,698	\$0	\$0	\$5,167	\$822,570
4	Q4	\$147,831	\$804,297	\$0	\$0	\$6,088	\$958,216
5	Q1	\$171,751	\$927,852	\$0	\$0	\$6,721	\$1,106,324
5	Q2	\$193,889	\$1,035,862	\$0	\$0	\$7,242	\$1,236,993

Year	Quarter	NP Subscriptions	Donor Subscriptions	Employee Engagement	Donation Fee	Concierge	Total
5	Q3	\$212,300	\$1,129,674	\$0	\$0	\$7,808	\$1,349,782
5	Q4	\$227,560	\$1,212,674	\$0	\$0	\$8,292	\$1,448,526

Revenue by Type — Annual (Transposed, 5 Years)

Revenue Type	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
NP Subscriptions	\$5,190	\$125,272	\$329,235	\$491,709	\$805,500
Donor Subscriptions	\$81,490	\$791,608	\$1,510,798	\$2,600,447	\$4,306,062
Employee Engagement	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Donation Fee	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Concierge	\$475	\$4,629	\$12,962	\$19,521	\$30,062
Total	\$87,155	\$921,509	\$1,852,996	\$3,111,677	\$5,141,624

7 Financial Statements

7.1 Income Statements

Income Statement — Monthly (first 24 months)

Year	Month	Revenue	COGS	Gross Profit	Sales & Mktg (Other)	PairWell Giving	OPEX (Total)	Operating Income	Depreciation	Amortization of Intangibles	Interest Expense	Pre-Tax Income	Taxes	CAPEX	Change in WC	NOPI
1	Jan	\$0	\$1,337	-\$1,337	\$0	\$0	\$2,940	-\$4,439	\$162	\$0	\$0	-\$4,439	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$4,4
1	Feb	\$299	\$1,382	-\$1,083	\$2,757	\$3	\$7,772	-\$9,180	\$324	\$0	\$0	-\$9,180	\$0	\$0	\$30	-\$9,1
1	Mar	\$299	\$1,419	-\$1,120	\$9,044	\$3	\$12,283	-\$13,945	\$542	\$0	\$0	-\$13,945	\$0	\$2,000	\$0	-\$13,
1	Apr	\$797	\$1,430	-\$633	\$0	\$8	\$5,292	-\$6,629	\$704	\$0	\$0	-\$6,629	\$0	\$0	\$50	-\$6,6
1	May	\$797	\$1,434	-\$637	\$0	\$8	\$6,795	-\$8,297	\$866	\$0	\$0	-\$8,297	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$8,2
1	Jun	\$1,571	\$1,608	-\$37	\$506	\$16	\$11,265	-\$12,440	\$1,139	\$0	\$0	-\$12,440	\$0	\$4,000	\$77	-\$12,
1	Jul	\$1,908	\$1,717	\$190	\$507	\$19	\$10,796	-\$11,744	\$1,139	\$0	\$0	-\$11,744	\$0	\$0	\$34	-\$11,
1	Aug	\$4,902	\$2,057	\$2,846	\$509	\$49	\$8,774	-\$7,067	\$1,139	\$0	\$0	-\$7,067	\$0	\$0	\$300	-\$7,0
1	Sep	\$6,828	\$3,589	\$3,240	\$16,012	\$68	\$24,299	-\$22,198	\$1,139	\$0	\$0	-\$22,198	\$0	\$0	\$193	-\$22,
1	Oct	\$15,364	\$5,787	\$9,577	\$6,492	\$154	\$17,387	-\$9,060	\$1,250	\$0	\$0	-\$9,060	\$0	\$4,000	\$854	-\$9,0
1	Nov	\$23,390	\$7,773	\$15,617	\$717	\$234	\$9,626	\$4,741	\$1,250	\$0	\$0	\$4,741	\$1,367	\$0	\$803	\$3,37
1	Dec	\$31,000	\$8,542	\$22,458	\$514	\$310	\$22,812	-\$1,715	\$1,361	\$0	\$0	-\$1,715	\$0	\$4,000	\$761	-\$1,7
2	Jan	\$33,328	\$9,173	\$24,155	\$23,948	\$333	\$48,770	-\$25,976	\$1,361	\$0	\$0	-\$25,976	\$0	\$0	\$233	-\$25,
2	Feb	\$35,929	\$9,400	\$26,530	\$516	\$359	\$23,283	\$1,885	\$1,361	\$0	\$0	\$1,885	\$544	\$0	\$260	\$1,34
2	Mar	\$39,331	\$10,579	\$28,752	\$11,386	\$393	\$47,502	-\$20,222	\$1,472	\$0	\$0	-\$20,222	\$0	\$4,000	\$340	-\$20,
2	Apr	\$49,878	\$12,147	\$37,731	\$1,038	\$499	\$39,365	-\$3,106	\$1,472	\$0	\$0	-\$3,106	\$0	\$0	\$1,055	-\$3,1
2	May	\$60,095	\$11,940	\$48,155	\$520	\$601	\$40,747	\$5,935	\$1,472	\$0	\$0	\$5,935	\$1,712	\$0	\$1,022	\$4,22
2	Jun	\$66,090	\$12,087	\$54,003	\$16,371	\$661	\$64,286	-\$11,867	\$1,583	\$0	\$0	-\$11,867	\$0	\$4,000	\$600	-\$11,
2	Jul	\$80,170	\$12,847	\$67,322	\$732	\$802	\$50,922	\$14,817	\$1,583	\$0	\$0	\$14,817	\$4,273	\$0	\$1,408	\$10,5
2	Aug	\$97,885	\$15,408	\$82,477	\$734	\$979	\$49,001	\$31,892	\$1,583	\$0	\$0	\$31,892	\$9,198	\$0	\$1,772	\$22,6
2	Sep	\$110,172	\$16,201	\$93,970	\$525	\$1,102	\$48,933	\$43,453	\$1,583	\$0	\$0	\$43,453	\$12,532	\$0	\$1,229	\$30,9
2	Oct	\$114,096	\$16,440	\$97,656	\$6,476	\$1,141	\$57,074	\$38,999	\$1,583	\$0	\$0	\$38,999	\$11,247	\$0	\$392	\$27,7
2	Nov	\$116,366	\$16,671	\$99,696	\$528	\$1,164	\$49,499	\$48,613	\$1,583	\$0	\$0	\$48,613	\$14,020	\$0	\$227	\$34,5
2	Dec	\$118,168	\$15,990	\$102,179	\$529	\$1,182	\$62,846	\$37,638	\$1,694	\$0	\$0	\$37,638	\$10,855	\$4,000	\$180	\$26,7

Income Statement — Quarterly (sum of quarter)

Year	Quarter	Revenue	COGS	Gross Profit	Sales & Mktg (Other)	PairWell Giving	OPEX (Total)	Operating Income	Depreciation	Amortization of Intangibles	Interest Expense	Pre-Tax Income	Taxes	CAPEX	Change in WC
1	1	\$598	\$4,139	-\$3,541	\$11,801	\$6	\$22,995	-\$27,564	\$1,028	\$0	\$0	-\$27,564	\$0	\$2,000	\$30
1	2	\$3,165	\$4,471	-\$1,306	\$506	\$32	\$23,351	-\$27,366	\$2,708	\$0	\$0	-\$27,366	\$0	\$4,000	\$127
1	3	\$13,638	\$7,362	\$6,276	\$17,029	\$136	\$43,869	-\$41,010	\$3,417	\$0	\$0	-\$41,010	\$0	\$0	\$526
1	4	\$69,754	\$22,101	\$47,652	\$7,724	\$698	\$49,825	-\$6,034	\$3,861	\$0	\$0	-\$6,034	\$1,367	\$8,000	\$2,411
2	1	\$108,589	\$29,151	\$79,438	\$35,850	\$1,086	\$119,555	-\$44,312	\$4,194	\$0	\$0	-\$44,312	\$544	\$4,000	\$833
2	2	\$176,063	\$36,175	\$139,888	\$17,929	\$1,761	\$144,398	-\$9,038	\$4,528	\$0	\$0	-\$9,038	\$1,712	\$4,000	\$2,671
2	3	\$288,226	\$44,456	\$243,770	\$1,991	\$2,882	\$148,857	\$90,163	\$4,750	\$0	\$0	\$90,163	\$26,003	\$0	\$4,401
2	4	\$348,632	\$49,101	\$299,531	\$7,533	\$3,486	\$169,419	\$125,251	\$4,861	\$0	\$0	\$125,251	\$36,122	\$4,000	\$800
3	1	\$378,632	\$46,275	\$332,357	\$22,813	\$3,786	\$240,873	\$86,290	\$5,194	\$0	\$0	\$86,290	\$24,886	\$4,000	\$1,361
3	2	\$435,315	\$48,231	\$387,084	\$1,607	\$4,353	\$242,413	\$139,255	\$5,417	\$0	\$0	\$139,255	\$40,161	\$0	\$1,871
3	3	\$489,805	\$53,433	\$436,371	\$1,619	\$4,898	\$255,757	\$175,087	\$5,528	\$0	\$0	\$175,087	\$50,495	\$2,000	\$1,941
3	4	\$549,243	\$60,297	\$488,946	\$1,631	\$5,492	\$276,623	\$206,628	\$5,694	\$0	\$0	\$206,628	\$59,592	\$2,000	\$2,011
4	1	\$619,760	\$68,627	\$551,133	\$1,643	\$6,198	\$310,663	\$235,637	\$4,833	\$0	\$0	\$235,637	\$67,958	\$2,000	\$2,551
4	2	\$711,132	\$79,030	\$632,101	\$1,655	\$7,111	\$335,312	\$293,358	\$3,431	\$0	\$0	\$293,358	\$84,605	\$4,000	\$3,281
4	3	\$822,570	\$91,699	\$730,870	\$1,668	\$8,226	\$383,261	\$344,776	\$2,833	\$0	\$0	\$344,776	\$99,433	\$0	\$3,981
4	4	\$958,216	\$107,243	\$850,972	\$1,680	\$9,582	\$387,720	\$460,863	\$2,389	\$0	\$0	\$460,863	\$132,913	\$0	\$4,791
5	1	\$1,106,324	\$122,941	\$983,383	\$1,692	\$11,063	\$415,496	\$565,720	\$2,167	\$0	\$0	\$565,720	\$163,154	\$2,000	\$4,801
5	2	\$1,236,993	\$136,905	\$1,100,087	\$1,705	\$12,370	\$417,682	\$680,517	\$1,889	\$0	\$0	\$680,517	\$196,261	\$0	\$4,131
5	3	\$1,349,782	\$149,314	\$1,200,468	\$1,718	\$13,498	\$420,500	\$778,302	\$1,667	\$0	\$0	\$778,302	\$224,462	\$0	\$3,561
5	4	\$1,448,526	\$160,620	\$1,287,905	\$1,730	\$14,485	\$424,703	\$861,646	\$1,556	\$0	\$0	\$861,646	\$248,499	\$0	\$3,131

Income Statement — Annual (transposed)

Line	1	2	3	4	5
Revenue	\$87,155	\$921,509	\$1,852,996	\$3,111,677	\$5,141,624
COGS	\$38,074	\$158,883	\$208,236	\$346,600	\$569,780
Gross Profit	\$49,081	\$762,626	\$1,644,759	\$2,765,077	\$4,571,844
Sales & Mktg (Other)	\$37,060	\$63,303	\$27,670	\$6,646	\$6,845
PairWell Giving	\$872	\$9,215	\$18,530	\$31,117	\$51,416
OPEX (Total)	\$140,040	\$582,229	\$1,015,666	\$1,416,957	\$1,678,381
Operating Income	-\$101,973	\$162,064	\$607,260	\$1,334,634	\$2,886,186
Depreciation	\$11,014	\$18,333	\$21,833	\$13,486	\$7,278
Amortization of Intangibles	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Interest Expense	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Pre-Tax Income	-\$101,973	\$162,064	\$607,260	\$1,334,634	\$2,886,186
Taxes	\$1,367	\$64,381	\$175,134	\$384,908	\$832,376
CAPEX	\$14,000	\$12,000	\$8,000	\$6,000	\$2,000
Change in WC	\$3,100	\$8,717	\$7,206	\$14,615	\$15,645
NOPAT	-\$103,340	\$97,683	\$432,126	\$949,725	\$2,053,810
Free Cash Flow	-\$109,426	\$95,299	\$438,754	\$942,597	\$2,043,442

7.2 Cash Flow Statements

Cash Flow Statement — Monthly (first 24 months)

Year	Month	Operating Cash Flow	Equity Raised	Debt Draws	Debt Principal Repaid	Financing Cash Flow	Total Cash Flow
1	Jan	-\$4,277	\$250,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$245,723

Year	Month	Operating Cash Flow	Equity Raised	Debt Draws	Debt Principal Repaid	Financing Cash Flow	Total Cash Flow
1	Feb	-\$8,856	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$8,856
1	Mar	-\$13,404	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$13,404
1	Apr	-\$5,925	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$5,925
1	May	-\$7,431	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$7,431
1	Jun	-\$11,301	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$11,301
1	Jul	-\$10,605	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$10,605
1	Aug	-\$5,928	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$5,928
1	Sep	-\$21,059	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$21,059
1	Oct	-\$7,810	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$7,810
1	Nov	\$5,991	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$5,991
1	Dec	-\$353	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$353
2	Jan	-\$24,615	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$24,615
2	Feb	\$3,246	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$3,246
2	Mar	-\$18,749	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$18,749
2	Apr	-\$1,634	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$1,634
2	May	\$7,407	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$7,407
2	Jun	-\$10,284	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$10,284
2	Jul	\$16,401	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$16,401
2	Aug	\$33,476	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$33,476
2	Sep	\$45,037	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$45,037
2	Oct	\$40,582	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$40,582
2	Nov	\$50,197	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$50,197
2	Dec	\$39,333	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$39,333

Cash Flow Statement — Quarterly (sum of quarter)

Year	Quarter	Operating Cash Flow	Equity Raised	Debt Draws	Debt Principal Repaid	Financing Cash Flow	Total Cash Flow
1	1	-\$26,536	\$250,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$223,464
1	2	-\$24,657	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$24,657
1	3	-\$37,593	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$37,593
1	4	-\$2,173	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$2,173
2	1	-\$40,118	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$40,118
2	2	-\$4,510	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	-\$4,510
2	3	\$94,913	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$94,913
2	4	\$130,112	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$130,112
3	1	\$91,484	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$91,484
3	2	\$144,671	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$144,671
3	3	\$180,615	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$180,615
3	4	\$212,323	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$212,323
4	1	\$240,470	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$240,470
4	2	\$296,789	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$296,789
4	3	\$347,609	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$347,609
4	4	\$463,252	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$463,252
5	1	\$567,887	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$567,887
5	2	\$682,406	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$682,406
5	3	\$779,969	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$779,969
5	4	\$863,202	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$863,202

Cash Flow Statement — Annual (transposed)

Line	1	2	3	4	5
Operating Cash Flow	-\$90,959	\$180,397	\$629,093	\$1,348,120	\$2,893,464
Equity Raised	\$250,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Debt Draws	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Debt Principal Repaid	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Financing Cash Flow	\$250,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Total Cash Flow	\$159,041	\$180,397	\$629,093	\$1,348,120	\$2,893,464

7.3 Balance Sheets

Balance Sheet — Monthly (first 24 months)

Year	Month	Cash	Net Working Capital	PP&E - Gross	Accum. Depreciation	PP&E - Net	Intangibles - Gross	Accum. Amortization (Intangibles)	Intangibles - Net	Debt	Paid-in Capital	Retained Earnings	Total Assets	Total Liabilities	Total Equity
1	Jan	\$239,890	\$0	\$0	-\$162	\$0	\$5,833	-\$162	\$5,671	\$0	\$250,000	-\$4,439	\$245,561	\$0	\$245,561
1	Feb	\$225,171	\$30	\$0	-\$486	\$0	\$11,667	-\$486	\$11,181	\$0	\$250,000	-\$13,619	\$236,381	\$0	\$236,381
1	Mar	\$203,934	\$30	\$2,000	-\$1,028	\$972	\$17,500	-\$972	\$16,528	\$0	\$250,000	-\$28,536	\$221,464	\$0	\$221,464
1	Apr	\$192,126	\$80	\$2,000	-\$1,731	\$269	\$23,333	-\$1,620	\$21,713	\$0	\$250,000	-\$35,813	\$214,187	\$0	\$214,187
1	May	\$178,861	\$80	\$2,000	-\$2,597	\$0	\$29,167	-\$2,431	\$26,736	\$0	\$250,000	-\$44,323	\$205,677	\$0	\$205,677
1	Jun	\$157,649	\$157	\$6,000	-\$3,736	\$2,264	\$35,000	-\$3,403	\$31,597	\$0	\$250,000	-\$58,332	\$191,668	\$0	\$191,668
1	Jul	\$147,010	\$191	\$6,000	-\$4,875	\$1,125	\$35,000	-\$4,375	\$30,625	\$0	\$250,000	-\$71,049	\$178,951	\$0	\$178,951
1	Aug	\$140,783	\$490	\$6,000	-\$6,014	\$0	\$35,000	-\$5,347	\$29,653	\$0	\$250,000	-\$79,074	\$170,926	\$0	\$170,926
1	Sep	\$119,531	\$683	\$6,000	-\$7,153	\$0	\$35,000	-\$6,319	\$28,681	\$0	\$250,000	-\$101,106	\$148,894	\$0	\$148,894
1	Oct	\$106,867	\$1,536	\$10,000	-\$8,403	\$1,597	\$35,000	-\$7,292	\$27,708	\$0	\$250,000	-\$112,291	\$137,709	\$0	\$137,709
1	Nov	\$110,688	\$2,339	\$10,000	-\$9,653	\$347	\$35,000	-\$8,264	\$26,736	\$0	\$250,000	-\$109,890	\$140,110	\$0	\$140,110
1	Dec	\$105,574	\$3,100	\$14,000	-\$11,014	\$2,986	\$35,000	-\$9,236	\$25,764	\$0	\$250,000	-\$112,576	\$137,424	\$0	\$137,424
2	Jan	\$80,726	\$3,333	\$14,000	-\$12,375	\$1,625	\$35,000	-\$10,208	\$24,792	\$0	\$250,000	-\$139,524	\$110,476	\$0	\$110,476
2	Feb	\$83,169	\$3,593	\$14,000	-\$13,736	\$264	\$35,000	-\$11,181	\$23,819	\$0	\$250,000	-\$139,155	\$110,845	\$0	\$110,845
2	Mar	\$60,079	\$3,933	\$18,000	-\$15,208	\$2,792	\$35,000	-\$12,153	\$22,847	\$0	\$250,000	-\$160,349	\$89,651	\$0	\$89,651
2	Apr	\$57,391	\$4,988	\$18,000	-\$16,681	\$1,319	\$35,000	-\$13,125	\$21,875	\$0	\$250,000	-\$164,427	\$85,573	\$0	\$85,573
2	May	\$62,065	\$6,009	\$18,000	-\$18,153	\$0	\$35,000	-\$14,097	\$20,903	\$0	\$250,000	-\$161,023	\$88,977	\$0	\$88,977
2	Jun	\$47,181	\$6,609	\$22,000	-\$19,736	\$2,264	\$35,000	-\$15,069	\$19,931	\$0	\$250,000	-\$174,015	\$75,985	\$0	\$75,985
2	Jul	\$57,901	\$8,017	\$22,000	-\$21,319	\$681	\$35,000	-\$16,042	\$18,958	\$0	\$250,000	-\$164,443	\$85,557	\$0	\$85,557
2	Aug	\$80,407	\$9,788	\$22,000	-\$22,903	\$0	\$35,000	-\$17,014	\$17,986	\$0	\$250,000	-\$141,818	\$108,182	\$0	\$108,182
2	Sep	\$111,683	\$11,017	\$22,000	-\$24,486	\$0	\$35,000	-\$17,986	\$17,014	\$0	\$250,000	-\$110,286	\$139,714	\$0	\$139,714
2	Oct	\$140,626	\$11,410	\$22,000	-\$26,069	\$0	\$35,000	-\$18,958	\$16,042	\$0	\$250,000	-\$81,923	\$168,077	\$0	\$168,077
2	Nov	\$176,575	\$11,637	\$22,000	-\$27,653	\$0	\$35,000	-\$19,931	\$15,069	\$0	\$250,000	-\$46,719	\$203,281	\$0	\$203,281
2	Dec	\$200,873	\$11,817	\$26,000	-\$29,347	\$0	\$35,000	-\$20,903	\$14,097	\$0	\$250,000	-\$23,213	\$226,787	\$0	\$226,787

Balance Sheet — Quarterly (end of quarter)

Year	Quarter	Cash	Net Working Capital	PP&E - Gross	Accum. Depreciation	PP&E - Net	Intangibles - Gross	Accum. Amortization (Intangibles)	Intangibles - Net	Debt	Paid-in Capital	Retained Earnings	Total Assets	Total Liabilities	Total Equity
1	1	\$203,934	\$30	\$2,000	-\$1,028	\$972	\$17,500	-\$972	\$16,528	\$0	\$250,000	-\$28,536	\$221,464	\$0	\$2
1	2	\$157,649	\$157	\$6,000	-\$3,736	\$2,264	\$35,000	-\$3,403	\$31,597	\$0	\$250,000	-\$58,332	\$191,668	\$0	\$1
1	3	\$119,531	\$683	\$6,000	-\$7,153	\$0	\$35,000	-\$6,319	\$28,681	\$0	\$250,000	-\$101,106	\$148,894	\$0	\$1
1	4	\$105,574	\$3,100	\$14,000	-\$11,014	\$2,986	\$35,000	-\$9,236	\$25,764	\$0	\$250,000	-\$112,576	\$137,424	\$0	\$1
2	1	\$60,079	\$3,933	\$18,000	-\$15,208	\$2,792	\$35,000	-\$12,153	\$22,847	\$0	\$250,000	-\$160,349	\$89,651	\$0	\$8

Year	Quarter	Cash	Net Working Capital	PP&E - Gross	Accum. Depreciation	PP&E - Net	Intangibles - Gross	Accum. Amortization (Intangibles)	Intangibles - Net	Debt	Paid-in Capital	Retained Earnings	Total Assets	Total Liabilities	To Eq
2	2	\$47,181	\$6,609	\$22,000	-\$19,736	\$2,264	\$35,000	-\$15,069	\$19,931	\$0	\$250,000	-\$174,015	\$75,985	\$0	\$7
2	3	\$111,683	\$11,017	\$22,000	-\$24,486	\$0	\$35,000	-\$17,986	\$17,014	\$0	\$250,000	-\$110,286	\$139,714	\$0	\$1
2	4	\$200,873	\$11,817	\$26,000	-\$29,347	\$0	\$35,000	-\$20,903	\$14,097	\$0	\$250,000	-\$23,213	\$226,787	\$0	\$2
3	1	\$262,104	\$13,185	\$30,000	-\$34,542	\$0	\$35,000	-\$23,819	\$11,181	\$0	\$250,000	\$36,469	\$286,469	\$0	\$2
3	2	\$364,736	\$15,063	\$30,000	-\$39,958	\$0	\$35,000	-\$26,736	\$8,264	\$0	\$250,000	\$138,062	\$388,062	\$0	\$3
3	3	\$490,914	\$17,004	\$32,000	-\$45,486	\$0	\$35,000	-\$29,653	\$5,347	\$0	\$250,000	\$263,265	\$513,265	\$0	\$5
3	4	\$639,627	\$19,023	\$34,000	-\$51,181	\$0	\$35,000	-\$32,569	\$2,431	\$0	\$250,000	\$411,080	\$661,080	\$0	\$6
4	1	\$807,583	\$21,578	\$36,000	-\$56,014	\$0	\$35,000	-\$34,514	\$486	\$0	\$250,000	\$579,648	\$829,648	\$0	\$8
4	2	\$1,012,483	\$24,863	\$40,000	-\$59,444	\$0	\$35,000	-\$35,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$787,346	\$1,037,346	\$0	\$1
4	3	\$1,256,678	\$28,844	\$40,000	-\$62,278	\$0	\$35,000	-\$35,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$1,035,522	\$1,285,522	\$0	\$1
4	4	\$1,582,223	\$33,637	\$40,000	-\$64,667	\$0	\$35,000	-\$35,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$1,365,861	\$1,615,861	\$0	\$1
5	1	\$1,980,153	\$38,441	\$42,000	-\$66,833	\$0	\$35,000	-\$35,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$1,768,594	\$2,018,594	\$0	\$2
5	2	\$2,462,162	\$42,577	\$42,000	-\$68,722	\$0	\$35,000	-\$35,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$2,254,739	\$2,504,739	\$0	\$2
5	3	\$3,014,099	\$46,147	\$42,000	-\$70,389	\$0	\$35,000	-\$35,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$2,810,245	\$3,060,245	\$0	\$3
5	4	\$3,625,666	\$49,283	\$42,000	-\$71,944	\$0	\$35,000	-\$35,000	\$0	\$0	\$250,000	\$3,424,948	\$3,674,948	\$0	\$3

Balance Sheet — Annual

Line	1	2	3	4	5
Cash	\$105,574	\$200,873	\$639,627	\$1,582,223	\$3,625,666
Net Working Capital	\$3,100	\$11,817	\$19,023	\$33,637	\$49,283
PP&E - Gross	\$14,000	\$26,000	\$34,000	\$40,000	\$42,000
Accum. Depreciation	-\$11,014	-\$29,347	-\$51,181	-\$64,667	-\$71,944
PP&E - Net	\$2,986	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Intangibles - Gross	\$35,000	\$35,000	\$35,000	\$35,000	\$35,000
Accum. Amortization (Intangibles)	-\$9,236	-\$20,903	-\$32,569	-\$35,000	-\$35,000
Intangibles - Net	\$25,764	\$14,097	\$2,431	\$0	\$0
Debt	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Paid-in Capital	\$250,000	\$250,000	\$250,000	\$250,000	\$250,000
Retained Earnings	-\$112,576	-\$23,213	\$411,080	\$1,365,861	\$3,424,948
Total Assets	\$137,424	\$226,787	\$661,080	\$1,615,861	\$3,674,948
Total Liabilities	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Total Equity	\$137,424	\$226,787	\$661,080	\$1,615,861	\$3,674,948
Assets - (L+E)	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0

8 Operations

8.1 Hiring

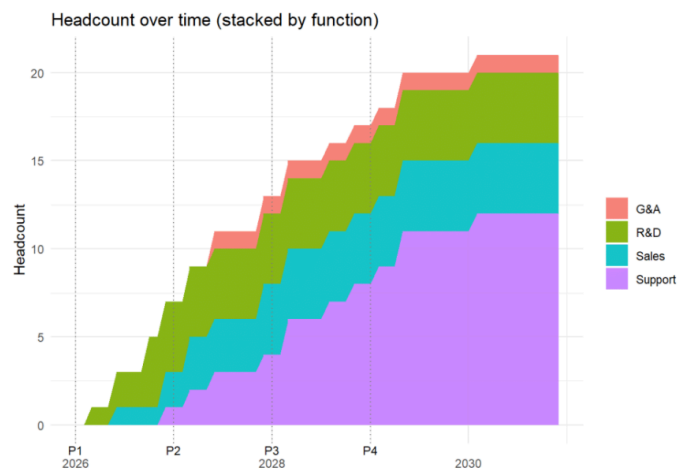
[[1]] [1] "### Hiring schedule (chronological)" attr(,"class") [1] "knit_asis" attr(,"knit_cacheable") [1] NA

[[2]]

Date	Month #	Dept	Role	Monthly Salary
2026-03-01	3	R&D	Developer 1	\$11,000
2026-06-01	6	R&D	Developer 2	\$10,000
2026-06-01	6	Sales	Growth Marketer 1	\$6,000
2026-10-01	10	R&D	Developer 3	\$10,000
2026-10-01	10	R&D	UX Design	\$7,000

Date	Month #	Dept	Role	Monthly Salary
2026-12-01	12	Sales	Growth Marketer 2	\$6,000
2026-12-01	12	Support	Customer Success 1	\$5,000
2027-03-01	15	Sales	Growth Marketer 3	\$6,000
2027-03-01	15	Support	Customer Success 2	\$5,000
2027-06-01	18	G&A	Founders	\$35,000
2027-06-01	18	Support	Customer Success 3	\$5,000
2027-12-01	24	Sales	Growth Marketer 4	\$6,000
2027-12-01	24	Support	Customer Success 4	\$5,000
2028-03-01	27	Support	Customer Succ. Mgr	\$7,000
2028-03-01	27	Support	Customer Success 5	\$5,000
2028-08-01	32	Support	Customer Success 6	\$5,000
2028-11-01	35	Support	Customer Success 7	\$5,000
2029-02-01	38	Support	Customer Success 8	\$5,000
2029-05-01	41	Support	Customer Success 10	\$5,000
2029-05-01	41	Support	Customer Success 9	\$5,000
2030-02-01	50	Support	Customer Success 11	\$5,000

8.1.1 Stacked Headcount - Functional



8.2 Marketing Expense

Selling & Marketing Costs — Annual (Collapsed Competitions & Events)

Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
% of Revenue	163.2%	45.4%	26.5%	17.5%	11.8%
Total Selling & Marketing	\$142,200	\$418,047	\$491,120	\$545,314	\$604,461
Competitions (All-in)	\$15,600	\$26,600	\$0	\$0	\$0
Events (All-in)	\$17,400	\$28,400	\$20,000	\$0	\$0
GA Other (Sales)	\$3,500	\$6,000	\$6,000	\$6,000	\$6,000
Paid: Programmatic (Donor)	\$1,980	\$6,957	\$14,426	\$29,914	\$38,518
Paid: Programmatic (NP)	\$1,980	\$6,957	\$14,426	\$29,914	\$38,518

Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Paid: Social (Donor)	\$3,300	\$11,595	\$24,043	\$49,856	\$64,196
Paid: Social (NP)	\$3,300	\$11,595	\$24,043	\$49,856	\$64,196
Sales & Mktg: Other	\$37,060	\$63,303	\$27,670	\$6,646	\$6,845
Sales & Mktg: Salaries	\$58,080	\$256,641	\$360,512	\$373,130	\$386,189

8.3 Marketing Performance

8.3.1 Marketing Channel Scorecard — Overall (60 months)

Channel	Spend (Media)	New Users	CAC (Paid)	CAC (Blended)	Est. LTV	LTV:CAC (Paid)	ROI (Paid)
Email	\$0	1,065	\$0	\$45	\$9,084	—	—
Social	\$305,980	7,983	\$38	\$83	\$9,084	237×	23,601%
Programmatic	\$183,588	2,817	\$65	\$110	\$9,084	139.4×	13,839%
Events	\$65,800	58	\$1,134	\$1,180	\$9,084	8×	701%
Competitions	\$42,200	1,256	\$34	\$79	\$9,084	270.4×	26,938%
Organic	\$0	0	—	—	\$9,084	—	—
Referrals	\$0	634	\$0	\$0	\$9,084	—	—

8.4 Events and Competition

Marketing Summary — Events & Competitions (Totals, CAC included)

Month	Event Name	Type	Total Cost	Prize (if Competition)	Acquisition Assumption	NP Acquired	Donor Acquired	CAC
2	Elevate NPM	Event	\$2,750		attendance × conv% (trial 6 mo)	13	0	\$211.54
3	Awareness Mixer	Event	\$3,000		attendance × conv% (trial 6 mo)	2	1	\$1,000.00
3	Launch Mixer	Event	\$6,000		attendance × conv% (trial 6 mo)	5	2	\$857.14
9	Launch Competition	Competition	\$21,600	\$15,000	NP: count; Donor: count (trial 6 mo)	1500	60	\$13.85
10	CPM Conference	Event	\$5,650		attendance × conv% (trial 6 mo)	10	1	\$513.64
13	CES Tradeshow	Event	\$20,000		attendance × conv% (trial 6 mo)	21	57	\$256.41
13	Elevate NPM	Event	\$2,750		attendance × conv% (trial 6 mo)	18	0	\$152.78
15	Spring Booster	Competition	\$11,000	\$10,000	NP: count; Donor: count (trial 3 mo)	1200	50	\$8.80
18	EOY Sprint	Competition	\$21,600	\$15,000	NP: count; Donor: count (trial 6 mo)	1500	90	\$13.58
22	CPM Conference	Event	\$5,650		attendance × conv% (trial 6 mo)	10	1	\$513.64
25	CES Tradeshow	Event	\$20,000		attendance × conv% (trial 6 mo)	21	57	\$256.41
NA	TOTAL		\$120,000	\$40,000		4300	319	\$25.98

8.5 G&A Other — Summary

GA Other detail by Category & Label — Annual (typifier removed)

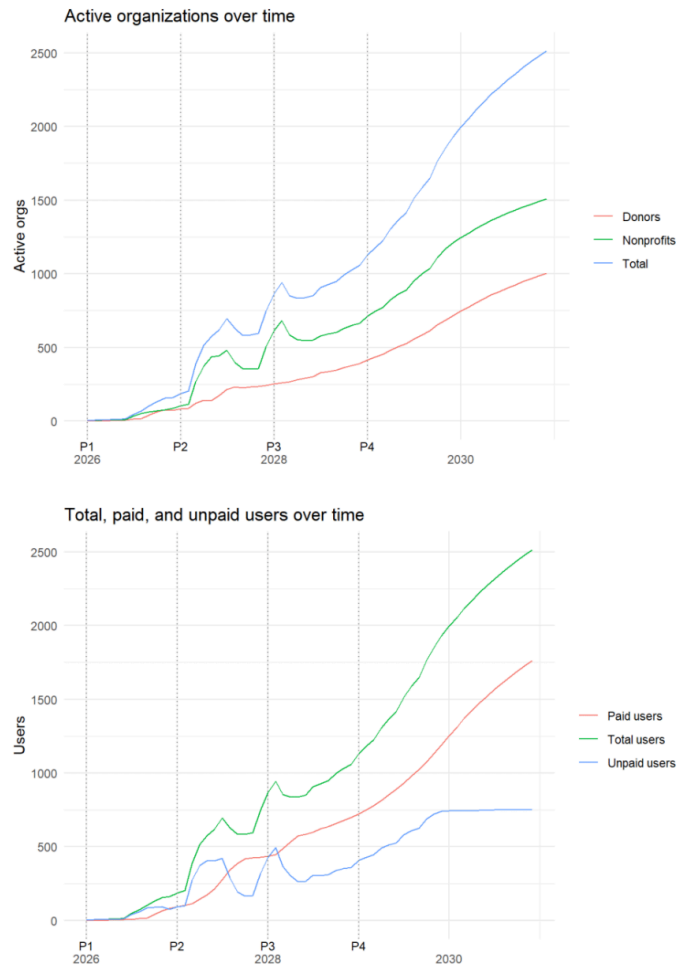
Label	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Developer Tools	\$5,060	\$10,560	\$10,560	\$10,560	\$10,560
Filing fees	\$140	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Insurance	\$3,500	\$3,500	\$8,000	\$8,000	\$8,000
Legal Fees	\$8,000	\$8,000	\$16,000	\$16,000	\$16,000
Office Rent	\$0	\$35,000	\$60,000	\$120,000	\$180,000

Label	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Saas Subsc.	\$3,600	\$8,400	\$18,000	\$30,000	\$33,600
Statement Filing	\$75	\$100	\$100	\$100	\$100
Supplies	\$2,200	\$2,400	\$2,400	\$2,400	\$2,400
Marketing Email	\$3,500	\$6,000	\$6,000	\$6,000	\$6,000

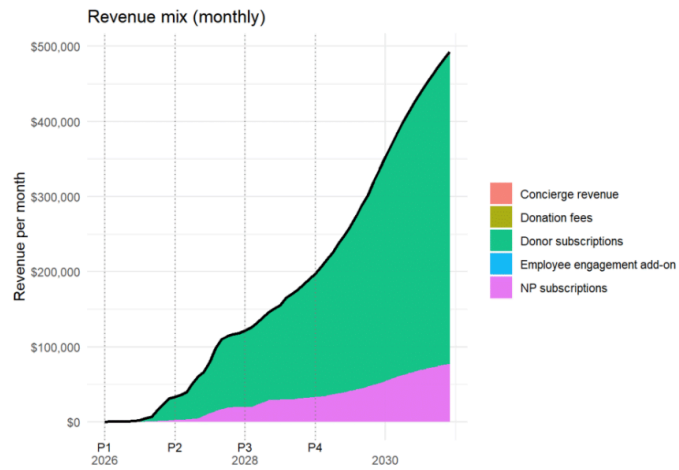
9 KPI Charts

These charts are for the **Base Pricing Scenario**.

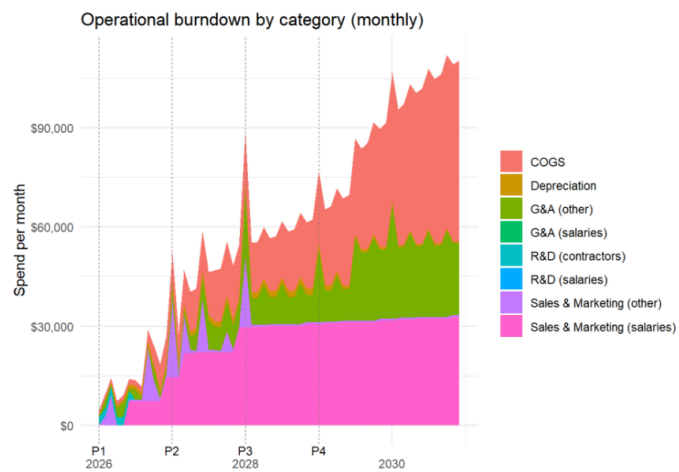
9.1 Users



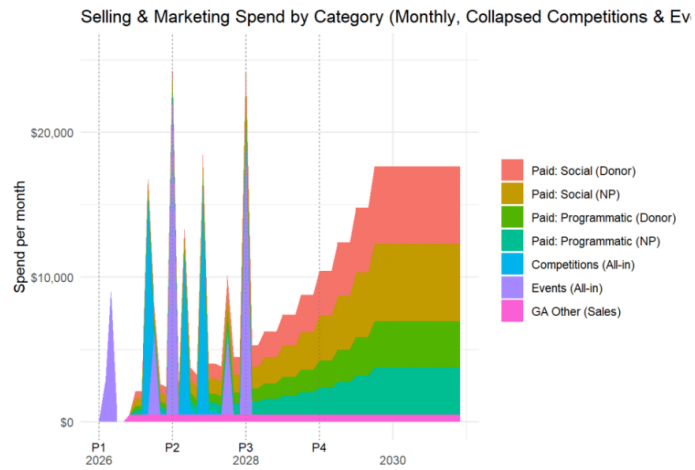
9.2 Revenue Mix



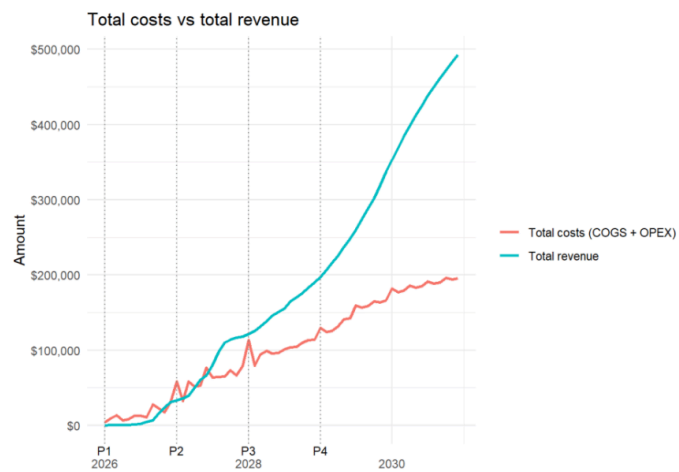
9.3 Operations Burndown



9.4 Marketing Expense Plot



9.5 Cost v Revenue



Interviews

Roger Castle, LA Regional Food Bank

Insights/Analysis:

- They have a pretty robust donor acquisition process through their private funding model
 - Primarily acquired through online channels
- Large donors like the stewardship and respond well
 - Highlighted several times the importance of timely acknowledgements to their high donors
 - While they can automate it, they prefer to add personal touches to each letter cause they found that they respond well

Warm-Up Questions

1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?
 - Roger Castle, Chief Development Officer of LA Food Bank
 - LA Regional Food Bank was founded in 1973 and filed to be a nonprofit in 1977
2. What are the main goals and missions of your organization?
 - The mission is to help individuals and families access nutritious food.
 - A key driver is combating food waste, there's a significant amount of excess food that can be redistributed.
 - The Food Bank supports not only unhoused individuals but also working families who struggle with food access due to high living costs.
 - The focus is on nutrition security, not just food, but healthy food.
3. How do you currently attract and retain donors? What donations do you currently accept?
 - They used to do direct mail, but now they mainly focus on online acquisitions: email, digital ads, Google Ads, social media, etc.
 - They accept individual and corporate donations, planned giving, stocks, and crypto giving (less popular). They also accept donations at third-party events and peer-to-peer events,
 - The organization is 90–95% funded by private sources, unlike many nonprofits that rely on government funding. Funding comes from:
 - Individual donors
 - Private foundations (~15% of their donations come from here and the rest from corporations)
 - Corporate partners (1% of pre-tax income contributions)

Core Questions

4. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising? How much time do you spend fundraising? Do you have a dedicated team for fundraising?
 - Tools:
 - Digital ads (Facebook, Google)
 - Email marketing
 - Direct mail (legacy method, still used)
 - CRM: Blackbaud (used to store donor data, track analytics, and run campaigns)
 - Tactics:
 - Campaigns to build awareness on a lean budget
 - Personalized donor cultivation by officers based on CRM insights (they can see how likely and how much each donor can give/continue giving)
 - They try to get them to do annual or monthly recurring donations
 - Strategy (not sure if helpful, but still interesting):
 - 80% of donors come in through online channels, rest via mail

- They spent ~\$600K to acquire online donors with a 2.3% ROI
 - They consider the lifetime value of an online donor
 - 2.3% on the first gift, but they can continue to get them to donate more
 - Online acquisition is cheaper and more scalable
 - If a donor doesn't donate regularly, they may still go with planned giving (ex. 1/6th of their estate = ~\$600K)
 - Yes, there is a dedicated team.
5. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?
- Highly competitive landscape with many nonprofits competing for attention and funding
 - Limited marketing budget forces them to be creative in visibility efforts
 - Visibility spikes during disasters or crises (e.g., fires)
 - Partnerships (e.g., with Children's Hospital or Project Hope) help boost credibility and reach
 - Before Roger joined, they were feeding 250K/month; now feed 1.1M/month
 - Added 12 staff in marketing
 - Spent more money on marketing
 - Increased funding has translated into measurable impact
6. How do you manage donor relationships and communications?
- Blackbaud stores all its donor information.
 - They have a dedicated team that manages donor relationships.
 - And their stewardship initiatives help maintain that communication.
7. How do you share impact? Do you send impact or progress reports to all donors? To certain donors?
- Stewardship strategy:
 - Large donors receive printed impact reports
 - Emails sent more broadly to donors
 - Personal thank-you calls
 - Hand-signed acknowledgment letters from the CEO and CDO (Roger)
 - Storytelling: Shared via website and social media (captured professionally and via mobile)
 - Roger did a custom tour and recorded it for a high-value donor who couldn't come in for a tour
 - Monthly webinars with the CEO
8. What features would be most valuable to you in such a platform?
- The database is important since all the donor information is there; all they have to do is work on those donor relationships and nurture them.
9. How do you handle tax documentation and reporting for your donations?
- A database team handles donation processing and tax acknowledgment
 - Receipts:
 - E-receipts for online donations
 - Physical acknowledgment letters sent weekly, signed by the CEO (often includes a PS note)
 - Additional steps:
 - Donors are added to welcome email workflows
 - Encouraged to sign up for volunteering or future donations
 - Donations processed through a bank lockbox for secure handling (?)

Closing Questions

10. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?
- Planned giving is underutilized by many nonprofits, huge opportunity
 - Stock donations are valuable and help avoid capital gains
 - Crypto donations have been minimal so far

11. Would you be interested in participating in future testing or providing feedback on our platform? (We're currently trying to develop a platform that can help address sustainable funding for nonprofits. Would you be open to testing new features and providing feedback as we continue developing the platform?)

- Can follow up - "if there's a paper at the end, would love to take a read!"

Jessie Rojas, LA's BEST

Insights/Analysis:

- Potential new competitors given their capabilities:
 - Givebutter - raise money, engage supporters, and manage donor relationships
 - Salesforce - fundraising, program management, constituent relationships, and marketing
 - Mailchimp - free email marketing for smaller organizations, segmentation and personalization options, automation capabilities, and integration with other platforms
- Validates a few ideas:
 - Importance of storytelling, sharing real stories, and demonstrating impact
 - Sustainable funding is an ongoing issue, given how competitive it is to compete with nonprofit funding

Warm-Up Questions

1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?
 - Jessie Rojas - Marketing and Comms Manager
2. What are the main goals and missions of your organization?
 - LA's BEST is a nonprofit organization that provides safe, engaging, and enriching expanded learning opportunities for elementary school students across Los Angeles.
 - Their mission is to inspire and support children's learning and development beyond the school day, before school, after school, and during summer, so they can thrive academically, socially, and emotionally.
3. How do you currently attract and retain donors? What donations do you currently accept?
 - They build donor relationships through storytelling, special events, social media, and direct appeals.
 - They prioritize sharing real stories from students, staff, and families to demonstrate impact.
 - They accept one-time and recurring donations online, via check, and through workplace giving and donor-advised funds.
 - They also receive in-kind donations, especially for special events.

Core Questions

4. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising? How much time do you spend fundraising? Do you have a dedicated team for fundraising?
 - They use platforms like Givebutter for digital fundraising, Salesforce for donor tracking, and Mailchimp for outreach.
 - Fundraising is a consistent, year-round effort, and they do have a dedicated Development team focused on cultivating individual donors, managing grants, and executing campaigns.
5. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?
 - One challenge is ensuring the broader public understands the impact of expanded learning programs like theirs, which are often mistaken for just childcare.
 - Another challenge is securing sustainable funding in a competitive nonprofit landscape.
 - Outside of funding, staffing, and maintaining morale across a large frontline workforce also requires ongoing effort and innovation.
6. How do you manage donor relationships and communications?

- They prioritize transparency and consistency in their communications.
- Donors receive quarterly newsletters, personalized thank-you notes, and invitations to events and site visits.
- They aim to connect donors directly to the impact of their gifts, and they're always looking to improve their stewardship process.

7. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not?

- No, they use different tools to manage and monitor different aspects of each.

8. What features would be most valuable to you in such a platform?

9. How do you handle tax documentation and reporting for your donations?

- They issue donation receipts automatically through their online giving platforms, and their finance team tracks and reports all gifts to ensure they stay compliant with IRS requirements.
- For larger or custom donations, they also provide personalized acknowledgment letters when needed.

Closing Questions

10. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?

11. Would you be interested in participating in future testing or providing feedback on our platform?

- At the moment, no. They are not exploring new systems, but they really appreciate us for thinking of them.

Dennis Ortega, LHTP/YUCA/JYC

Warm-Up Questions

1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?

- Dennis Ortega, LHTP/YUCA/JYC (Various youth programs): Leads outreach and fundraising efforts for after-school programs and community initiatives.

2. What are the main goals and missions of your organization?

- Provides after-school programs and community support to youth. Focuses on educational, recreational, and enrichment opportunities for children in local communities.

3. How do you currently attract and retain donors? What donations do you currently accept?

- Direct outreach to corporations.
- Donations via website (PayPal, credit card, direct in-person), United Way payroll withdrawal, matching grants, stock transfers, GoFundMe.
- Individual outreach to gauge interest in funding specific programs or projects.

Core Questions

4. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising? How much time do you spend fundraising? Do you have a dedicated team for fundraising?

- No specific tools, mainly relies heavily on direct outreach and web-based donations.
- Fundraising involves schools, community events, and corporate contacts.
- Most of the fundraising is done internally among other staff (integrated across general staff responsibilities)

5. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?

- Funding is increasingly unpredictable due to the political climate and post-COVID shifts.
- Families have less availability and disposable income post-pandemic.
- Rising program costs (2-3x higher than pre-pandemic) create unexpected funding gaps.
- Individual and corporate donations have decreased post-pandemic.
- Competes with neighboring schools and nonprofits for grants and foundation funding, which reduces funds available per organization.

6. How do you manage donor relationships and communications?

- Primarily through direct outreach and engagement at schools and community events.

7. How do you share impact? Do you send impact or progress reports to all donors? To certain donors?

- Through newsletters and social media (Facebook)

8. What features would be most valuable to you in such a platform?

- A free platform that helps nonprofits find funding, especially when the political climate makes it harder for small nonprofits to find funding
- Tools that help nonprofits connect with potential donors

9. How do you handle tax documentation and reporting for your donations?

- Donors will have a receipt for their tax purposes.

Closing Questions

10. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?

- Post-pandemic challenges have made fundraising more complex and less predictable.
- Competition for funding and rising program costs are ongoing concerns.

11. Would you be interested in participating in future testing or providing feedback on our platform? (We're currently trying to develop a platform that can help address sustainable funding for nonprofits. Would you be open to testing new features and providing feedback as we continue developing the platform?)

- Yes!

Bill Crowe, Pet Care Foundation

Biggest Insights

- Costs is a big thing for nonprofits - many small nonprofits will try to cut costs and may be reluctant to spending more for a service
- Non-human charities and nonprofits oftentimes struggle more (ex. Animal-centric causes) cause people prioritize people more
 - Could be a good opportunity to add to the value prop that we could pair them with companies/donors who want to specifically donate to animal-centric organizations

Warm-Up Questions

1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?

- Bill Crowe, Executive Director.
- Oversees programs for animal care and adoptions, and has been with the organization since the beginning.
- Previously worked in special projects management at AIDS Healthcare Foundation.

2. What are the main goals and missions of your organization?

- Focuses on creating programs for animals and promoting pet adoptions across multiple shelters in LA.

3. How do you currently attract and retain donors? What donations do you currently accept?

- Primarily through grant writing and funding.
- Used to host fundraising events and direct mail campaigns, but stopped because they were costly and time-consuming.
- Active on social media to promote adoptions.

Core Questions

4. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising? How much time do you spend fundraising? Do you have a dedicated team for fundraising?

- Not project-based; all funding comes from grants.
- No dedicated fundraising team.
- Social media is the main tool for promotion.

5. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?

- Funding is the biggest challenge; it's generally harder to get donations for animal-centric causes compared to people-centric causes.

- Employee turnover due to low pay and limited benefits.
6. How do you manage donor relationships and communications?
 - Primarily through grant applications and general outreach, social media helps with visibility.
 7. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not?
 - No. The organization is making things work through grants and does not rely on a centralized platform.
 8. What features would be most valuable to you in such a platform?
 - While not needed for their organization, a platform could be valuable for other nonprofits if it's free. Features might include matching donors to projects or programs and simplifying discovery for small organizations.
 9. How do you handle tax documentation and reporting for your donations?
 - Handled internally by a dedicated team.
- Closing Questions
10. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?
 - Strongly suggests that if a tool is not free, there's a huge chance nonprofits won't be interested in it from his experience.
 11. Would you be interested in participating in future testing or providing feedback on our platform?
 - Can reach back out when the time comes.

Cathy Harrington Wilkinson, Armanino Foundation

Insights/Analysis:

- Giving started with employees, recipients were chosen by employees
 - Volunteering is a priority
 - They have preset areas of focus where they give donations
 - Donations are made in areas where employees live and work (both in-office and remote), only applies to US, not international
 - Challenges come from reporting aligning with donations
1. Can you tell me a bit about your role and your organization?
 - CPA and consulting firm, in Bay Area
 - Been with company for 47 years, employee number nine, 25 offices across US, plus 3 offices in India
 - Even before foundation, had employee challenges where partners would break employees into teams and they had to find some kind of community giving, had to come up with ways to raise money, team that raised most money got to take all of the money and donate it to their favorite charity, chose a school and donated money and in-kind donations
 - Continued from that the "Great Give" where every year close all offices and send all employees out to do community service on the same day
 - Community service committee organizes whole thing
 - Served over 140 different organizations on the same day
 - Foundation has been around since 2016, has four committees
 - Community service - also does quarterly days, has a different theme each quarter, campaign right now is back to school, anytime during Q3 each office coordinates an event with the community service committee to do a back to school event
 - Financial literacy committee - gives back with time and knowledge, has 5 1-hour zoom courses that they present to colleges/universities, which are resume

- writing, budgeting basics, credit cards and credit scores, linkedin build brand, and protecting identity
- Volunteer vacations committee - have 8-10 a year, employees can sign up to travel and do community service, next one is DC, will travel there to work with veterans helping them at monuments and do community service while there, usually sustainability (work with TreePeople), always have an international one too
 - Accept any kind of fundraising coming in, encourage all employees to sign up for payroll donations to the foundation
 - All employee donations are matched by partners
 - Don't accept outside grant requests but all employees can nominate favorite organization for a grant and can request up to \$3,000 for a grant
 - Grant committee does research, verifies nonprofit, puts together a packet to present to foundation board, 90% get approved, turn around and reach out to org and give them grant
 - Only gives to 501c3's
 - Most funding comes from employees and partners
 - "Dollars for Doers" employees do volunteer work on their own time, if they volunteer more than 25 hours, nonprofit gets awarded a grant
2. How do you currently find and select nonprofits to support? Does your organization select nonprofits to support based on the recommendation of your employees?
 - Most are nominated by an employee
 3. What types of causes or projects does your organization typically support? Do you support communities in areas where you are expanding?
 - 5 areas - animal welfare, education and arts, health and social services, racial justice, sustainability
 - Grant to organization where employees live and work because there are so many office locations
 - Have 500-600 remote employees, and they can nominate nonprofits in their area
 - For great give they are encouraged to find opportunities in their own communities, even though they aren't in an office
 - Employees can nominate anywhere in US, if it's not near an office it's still considered
 - Only restriction is no international organizations, solution is that they might instead donate to International Red Cross, who they trust to manage the money well
 - With India office, they can't give directly to international organizations, so workaround is organizations in US that directly support nonprofits in India
 - So they know eventually the funds will get there
 4. How does your organization approach volunteer management? Do you use a platform/tool?
 - Used to do everything in Excel when they were smaller, now use Salesforce
 - Monthly report from payroll that they import to Salesforce of employee donations
 - Four years ago they got all information uploaded into Salesforce using nonprofit pack
 - Also use Square for donation tracking, not great
 5. Does your organization match employee donations?
 - Yes
 6. What challenges do you face in managing your portfolio of nonprofits?
 - Sometimes reporting doesn't match up when it comes to tracking donors, mostly with Square reporting

- Issue donor letters at end of each year to employees
- 7. How important is transparency and progress tracking in your giving decisions?
 - Don't expect reporting
 - Grants are unrestricted, makes it easier because if grant is restricted, have to confirm that donations are used the way they say they are
- 8. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes nonprofit discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not? Roughly, how much time do you spend researching? (weekly / monthly)
 - Charity Navigator and Candid

Kelly Jensen, Compass Group

Insights/Analysis:

- Likes working with smaller firms to elevate them
- Donors are attracted through networks
- Nonprofits need to think about how they match with potential corporate donors
- Be careful with naming opportunities, should be temporary and there should be a de-naming process in case of bad press or misalignment
 - PairWell should have an approval process built in for naming opportunities
- Nonprofits should send impact reports often enough that donors don't forget about them
- 1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?
 - VP of the Compass Group, role is to provide services for nonprofits, sometimes planning a campaign but sometimes just meeting to analyze fundraising functions and program to help identify gaps and opportunities where they can enhance support through building relationships with donors, building staff, reimagining communications, rethinking how engagement and connections happen
 - Compass group is about 35 years old, has close to doubled in size in past seven years
 - Work with a wide range of types of nonprofits
 - One of the things that makes them unique is they love to work with "blue ocean" clients, smaller, less sophisticated in fundraising experience because the bigger firms are most focused on large organizations and Compass brings experience that can elevate smaller organizations
- 2. How do you advise clients to attract donors?
 - Audit and analyze current program
 - Have program called capacity building where they can figure out what they're missing in programs and policies and build giving program and find donors
 - Find the network of their existing network
 - Think of everyone who might be connected to the people who are connected to them
 - Board members are trained to understand their value by opening up their own connections
 - Sometimes it's about how nonprofit messages to the group, why there's value in becoming involved
 - Encourage them to think about what awareness building events they can do to network with donors
 - Might encourage them to examine the LinkedIn networks of their board or strongest, longest-term donors to see if those people will connect with their own networks
 - Encourage using donor research products like Wealth Engine or Donor Search
 - This is mostly for individual donors
 - For corporate giving, little more business focused than personal interest focused
 - Encourage nonprofit to think about current corporate donors and makeup of those donors

- What organizational type of business do they fit in, what is appealing to the donors about org, where does the mission match where this org might attract a similar type of donor
 - Corporate giving is smallest percent of giving out there
 - Always encouraging people to think of individual giving over corporate
 - Networks matter
 - Need to be aware and decide who they are willing to receive gifts from and who they're willing to go out to (ex environmental org with oil and gas company)
 - Most states have online data about who in the state is giving
 - Most states have some office that's the state's version of data analysis and what's helpful for communities as they're doing economic development
3. What size businesses are working with you on average?
- Size of nonprofit probably does influence what size of company
 - Doesn't matter as much if it's the employees giving
 - Corporations will set aside a certain number of dollars, will have someone at a more executive level who will be making those decisions, making that relationship is more important at a larger company
 - Smaller organizations it's worth trying to find same thing at a smaller level, build relationship beyond person who processes the check to find relationship with the person who decides where the check goes
 - Think bigger than the check print
4. How do you get in touch with corporate partners?
- Can be tough, recommend trying not to do everything all at once
 - Smaller nonprofits in smaller communities might try to send letters to all businesses at once because it's quick and easy to send same letter to everyone
 - Identify 10-20 where there's a reason why the nonprofit thought of them and do research to find who it makes sense to go to
 - Make it personalized and clear why they thought of them
 - There's a network in corporate giving, they have an idea of who is giving to what kinds of causes
 - Always worth asking the business if they have any other businesses in their network who might be interested
 - Can take time, corporate giving is different than individual giving
 - Let them know that putting their dollars in this nonprofit is more than just feel-good
5. Do they want naming rights or recognition?
- Varies by each org
 - Businesses like some kind of recognition, more than individuals
 - Enter with a well-thought out plan, know what they are comfortable doing as the org before they approach a business and they suggest something and the wrong person gives the wrong answer from the org
 - Like naming but don't give naming opp for something big without getting enough financial support to make it worthwhile
 - That level is different for each org
 - Naming policies should never be forever, especially for corporations, should be time limited
 - Can give first right of refusal to renew
 - Policy should include de-naming, reasons why company's name might be removed without being returned
 - Orgs should be careful that naming is not always a great thing and to enter it wisely and thoughtfully

- Even naming in a booklet like for a program, making sure what benefits they get for IRS purposes, like event sponsorship can't include tickets and still recognize full value of the donation
6. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising? How much time do you spend fundraising? Do you have a dedicated team for fundraising? Do you currently use a platform that centralizes discovery? Why or why not?
- LinkedIn is important, good for nonprofits to be front and center on
 - Social media is valuable too, not as much for fundraising but for awareness
 - Guidestar and Charity Navigator for ranking
 - Might look at 990s, know where 990 is and be able to point someone to it
7. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?
- Often don't think widely enough about boards of directors
 - Especially with smaller nonprofits, tend to choose people they know as board members, but that doesn't build network broad enough, don't get linked into associations, not getting their name out in front of broader groups, not spending time with local or statewide chambers of commerce where people are doing networking, don't get their name and work out there
 - African Wildlife Foundation has a really good presence on LinkedIn, shows their impact every day, lessons to take from them
 - Grow the network, be constantly out there trying to grow
 - Current donors are best donors
 - New donors take more time
 - Important to steward current donors
6. How important is transparency and progress tracking in your giving decisions?
- Encourage nonprofits to create strong stewardship plan
 - Can include some of the comms from normal plan that might be about exciting things where they're trying to get someone to be a donor
 - Think about what the donor's interest is
 - Do impact reports on frequent enough basis that donor doesn't forget who org is
 - Includes unrestricted gifts, everything that goes toward supporting mission
 - Plan out calendar by month
 - Some orgs have capacity to do monthly comms, some not as frequent
 - Might be email blast with event invites, impact statement, annual reports
 - Builds in things they were already going to do but are individualized as well where donor understands they're receiving it because they made a donation
 - Solid stewardship plan is why people keep giving
9. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?
- Giving USA report - comes out every year, take a look there's a long report behind a paywall but there's a general analysis that's free, constantly tracks each prior year's giving analysis in the US, who made the gifts, who received what percent of dollars, great way to look at philanthropy year over year
 - CCS puts out another report, do philanthropic landscape, pull from Giving USA and other sources, filled with beneficial information that small or large nonprofits would find value in
 - Were changes to corporate philanthropy in recent budget bill
 - Established min threshold to be able to deduct, higher than majority of corporate support, could have negative impact or may inspire corporations to give more to meet threshold
 - With economy and political climate, and not knowing how tariffs are affecting profits, making it difficult in corporate giving right now

- Most companies are doing well, and individuals who have stock in companies and are leaving corporations are gaining more money than they had, looking at corporate execs their capacity has increased a lot
- Encourage nonprofits not to panic around things like the economy and administrative state of affairs, looking at Giving USA, giving is making its way back up after post-COVID economic downturn
- Don't let national narrative let you believe something that isn't happening

Tricia Rumola, Delta Airlines

Insights/Analysis:

- Give to partners through agreements that revolve around partner's fiscal year
 - Support programs where they can volunteer
 - Support communities where employees are based
 - As a public facing company their community service helps their image, also helps recruit employees
1. Can you tell me a bit about your role and your organization?
 - a. Delta Airlines, celebrating 100th anniversary this year, first US airline to reach that, works in Community Engagement which is in marketing department, been with company 15 years, manages charitable giving, partners, employee volunteerism, matching gifts to education and any kind of contribution from Delta to any 501c3 falls under community engagement
 2. How does your organization currently approach corporate social responsibility (CSR)?
 - a. Four pillars of support, work with various nonprofits globally that address issues, education, environment, equity, and entire wellness, the four Es, work with orgs that support one of those four areas
 - b. Philosophy is to give funds but also give their time, volunteering as a group, volunteering on a board, provide guidance to partners pro bono
 - c. Partner with orgs that have those opportunities as much as they can
 - d. Provide ways for Delta people to support missions they connect with
 3. What does volunteering and community engagement look like at your organization?
 - a. Work with partners on agreements starting with fiscal year of their partners, look at holistic view of campaigns, opps, programs that nonprofit is looking for support in that fall in the four Es, support programmatic work where they can volunteer for the program, example children's hospitals, support childlife programs, one of only programs that isn't covered by insurance so hospitals fundraise for them, volunteer for holiday events, write cards for kids, give to program but also support program
 - b. Ex if it's a food bank, team will go volunteer at site
 4. How does your organization approach volunteer management? Do you use a platform / tool?
 - a. CyberGrants
 - b. Matching gifts to education, all the way preschool to education, only match gifts to education
 - c. Use it to manage volunteering
 - d. Support close to 600 partners, portfolios are well developed
 - e. Don't really take employee suggestions because they support so many already
 - f. Support local community, don't give PTO but don't discourage it
 - g. Encouraged to give back but there are parameters
 - h. 24/7 operation so there's no sweet spot for volunteering
 - i. Switch up the days / times to make sure it fits for everyone sometime
 - j. 10 or more people can create their own volunteer project

5. What types of causes or projects does your organization typically support?
 - a. Don't look at budget, making sure they're financially sound
 - b. Lean more into STEM in education, want to create inspiration for future aviators, building a pipeline in education
 - c. Benefitting the company/brand
 - d. Sometimes it's not as direct, just junior achievement, creating leaders, not always just a straight line like aviation, but always have in mind the idea of future employees or customers
 - e. Not a requirement
6. How do you currently find and select nonprofits to support?
 - a. Depends on profitability, 1% of profits go back to communities where they work
 - b. Might add one and one goes away
 - c. Only twice since she's been there, if their pillars change that might change their focus
 - d. At their max, but might do one-offs on
7. Does your organization select nonprofits to support based on the recommendation of your employees? Roughly, how much time do you spend searching and selecting? (weekly / monthly)
 - a. Might be research, might be employees/leadership
 - b. Might be external agencies
 - c. Couple weeks, depends on what they're looking for, who needs to review, sometimes in conjunction with sustainability team so
 - d. Depends on what stakeholders are involved internally
8. Does your organization match employee donations?
 - a. Yes, only education
9. What challenges do you face in managing your CSR portfolio?
 - a. External factors like changes in budget, economy, conflict around world, they fly everywhere so that factors in, if there's an incident that happens, like COVID
 - b. Things that aren't part of their control but affects profitability which results in them not being able to do as much
 - c. If there is something major that they didn't foresee
 - d. Try to plan but can't always, try to have a cushion to give to unforeseen disasters
 - e. LA fires gave substantial amount to that recovery
10. How important is transparency and progress tracking in your giving decisions?
 - a. Fairly important, orgs that rate the financials of nonprofits
 - b. If there's an org that they're interested in, they'll do due diligence and vet
11. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes nonprofit discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not?
 - a. No
12. How close is the relationship
 - a. Varies, talk during time of renewal but depends on partnership
 - b. Other people work on activation of partnerships, like events, volunteer projects
 - c. If there are other opps outside of agreement that come up like if they want to add org as beneficiary to showcase, could be more
 - d. Some more than others, in hubs more than other areas of focus
 - e. Depends, but good amount of touchpoints throughout year
13. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with corporate giving?
 - a. Good opportunity to learn about what nonprofit world is doing
 - b. Good perspective

- c. For culture, community engagement is good opp for employees to give back to communities where they live, good recruitment tool for employees, like it to network with people from other departments, been good in that sense
- d. Work with business resource groups, they have nonprofits specific to their focus
- e. Corporate philanthropy has a lot of relationship building, collaboration, and internal collaboration
- f. As much as they're giving to the community and supporting causes, also provides company with a lot of good things
- g. Public facing company so also has good view for customers, they can see what Delta does in community
- h. Marketing department so outward facing
- i. Equally beneficial to Delta, supports community

Michael Lima-Sabatini, Food Forward

Insights/Analysis:

- Bulk of corporate partnerships are high touch and low dollar
 - Value in cobranding is proportional to size of giving
 - Administrative burden to find all platforms and create profiles is high
 - Best offering would be some sort of standardization, simplified, easy to use product on both user ends, increase integration so data and answers don't have to be uploaded a bunch of times
 - Lot of corporate partners reach out not knowing their company uses a particular tool, so formal scopes of work go through platform but then separate conversations are happening
 - Very upset about the GoFundMe Pro debacle, nonprofit pros are upset and think it was unethical
1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?
 - a. Associate Manager of institutional giving, food recovery and distribution, primarily focused on writing grant proposals and reports, foundations and corporate foundations, lot of work on the development team
 2. How do you currently attract and retain donors?
 - a. Word of mouth, volunteers, Fresh Juice mailing list (mostly email)
 - b. Looks different depending on the income stream, lower level donors get email blasts, separate newsletters just for volunteers or produce donors, pretty segmented
 - c. New donors get welcome package
 - d. Major gift officer has portfolio and high touch relationships
 - e. Quarterly impact report to major donors and foundations
 - f. Send thermometer of how close they are to their food distro goal
 - g. Foundation and corporate side is much more tailored, relationship dependent
 - h. Custom messaging around giving
 3. How do you get in touch with corporate partners? What size businesses are working with you on average?
 - a. Corporate funding still is through grants with formal update requirements
 - b. Has corporate partnerships manager on the team
 - c. Reaching out through staff, board of directors, most happens on an individual basis
 - d. 8 dev staff
 4. Do you work with partners who just give and don't want to have a larger relationship?
 - a. Bulk of corporate partnerships are high touch and low dollar

- b. Local restaurants interested in food waste
 - c. Mid-level, five figure type partnerships, annual partnerships
 - d. Name goes on materials
 - e. Handful of six figure partners, formalized, grant making rules
 - f. Biannual report
5. Do corporate partners want naming rights or recognition?
- a. Value in cobranding is proportional to size of giving, he's found
 - b. Smaller things are more personal, less structured
 - c. Six figure gifts come with expectation for posting, branding guidelines
6. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising? How much time do you spend fundraising?
- a. Social media - facebook, instagram, linkedin, twitter
 - b. Salesforce for CRM
 - c. Guidestar, Charity Navigator, Great Nonprofits, every.org, Benevity, ourchange foundation, pledge, LA2050 (publish proposal)
7. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?
- a. Often by the time they are talking about sponsorship opportunities, those offices have already built their budgets
 - b. Need to be cultivating relationships earlier than ask is made because budgets often aren't there
 - c. Lot of corporate funders, relationships are interpersonal, so turnover disrupts flow
 - d. Sometimes mismatch of understanding of how relationship works
 - e. Figure out how to engage partners in a meaningful way without detracting from relationship but not setting unrealistic expectations
 - f. A lot of volunteer opportunities are seasonal, at whims of where they can find produce, have a lot of food donors, backyards, farmers markets in Ventura County, if they have a corporate partner based in LA who wants to do something on a certain day
8. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not? What features would be most valuable to you in such a platform?
- a. Evolving piece
 - b. Added 2-3 people to do operations in last year
 - c. Trying to track where donations are coming from
 - d. Still building that out
 - e. Need just one platform
 - f. Administrative burden to find all platforms and create profiles is high
 - g. Some sort of standardization, simplify, increase integration so data and answers don't have to be uploaded a bunch of times
 - h. Big piece is tool that is easy to use on both ends
 - i. Lot of corporate partners reach out not knowing their company uses a particular tool
 - j. Formal scopes of work go through platform but then separate conversations are happening
 - k. Not a lot of centralization
 - l. Make it as easy as it can be
9. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?
- a. Never enough money
 - b. GoFundMe Pro debacle - unethical, people are very upset

- B Corporation
 - Nonprofits are chosen by employee relationship
 - Much of the giving they do is centered around events, including attendance and in-kind donations
1. Can you tell me a bit about your role and your organization?
 - a. Co-founder, creative director
 - b. Team of 7, Marin county, going since 2013, became b-corp in 2017
 2. How does your organization currently approach corporate giving?
 - a. Volunteer and give money
 - b. Minimum requirement is 1% of profits, often give up to 7%
 - c. For small business that's big, bigger agencies can afford to give more, proportionally for size of business they give a lot
 - d. Aimee is a member of Marin Humane Advocacy Committee, were a client and Aimee had opportunity to give to the committee, meets once a month. Lobbies in Sacramento once a year
 - e. Employees have ability to volunteer monthly, also do pro bono and low bono work, last year did fentanyl awareness campaign for county of Marin for free, worth about \$100,000 in donated time
 - f. Also support local nonprofits by attending galas, providing items to auctions/silent auctions, fund the need during galas, give money, variety of nonprofits they wo
 - g. Some they support consistently and over time they'll see some nonprofits are being affected by politics or something else and will give money directly
 - h. Ex, fire last month where 50 low income community people were displaced and they gave money to the nonprofit supporting those people
 - i. Physically volunteering or through
 3. What does volunteering and community engagement look like at your organization?
 - a. Additionally, during wildfires there is a volunteer opportunity to help with large animals (horses) that are being evacuated during fires, Aimee on the list of people who can be called out during wildfires
 4. How does your organization approach volunteer management? Do you use a platform / tool?
 - a. Don't use any platforms, mainly Aimee that does it, organized with whoever she is volunteering with, not much to track on their end
 - b. Through b corp re-accreditation need to track volunteering and monetary donations
 5. What types of causes or projects does your organization typically support?
 - a. Also founding board member of When Pigs Fly Ranch, pig rescue, volunteered for three years, designed newsletter, media assets, advised on media appearances
 6. How do you currently find and select nonprofits to support? Does your organization select nonprofits to support based on the recommendation of your employees? Roughly, how much time do you spend searching and selecting? (weekly / monthly)
 - a. Mainly driven by founders, typically selected based on need
 - b. Example, based on what's going on with immigrants lately, donating to nonprofit who is supporting displaced immigrants
 7. What goes into the relationships with the nonprofits?
 - a. Some are long-term clients, relationship is continually building through work or volunteer work they do, sometimes donations create deeper relationships
 - b. Some, like fentanyl campaign, was every 2 weeks for 1.5 years
 - c. Marin Humane Advocacy Committee, meet once a month
 - d. Other communications are event triggered

- e. All clients have yearly fundraising galas, try to attend a different one each year and some are attended every year
- f. One way to support client is by buying tables at events
- 8. What challenges do you face in managing your CSR portfolio?
 - a. Not really
 - b. Done through Quickbooks, categorizing charitable contributions, goes into b corp accreditation
 - c. If they want to share on social media they share
- 9. Do they have trouble meeting standards or figuring out what they are?
 - a. No
 - b. Score went up a few months
- 10. How important is transparency and progress tracking in your giving decisions?
 - a. Because they know their clients so well, may have even designed impact report, already very aware of effectiveness, already in the know
 - b. Unlikely they support a nonprofit they don't know
 - c. Sometimes are a partner of a clients
- 11. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes nonprofit discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not?
 - a. No
- 12. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with corporate giving?
 - a. Wish more people would do it
 - b. If everyone gave the proportion of profits they did, society would be much better
 - c. Would like to stay up to date with our presentation

Meghan Steed Garvey, GrowGood

Insights/Analysis

- A lot of donors are brought in through volunteer opportunities
- Do outreach via 1% For The Planet
- Larger firms tend to be more transactional in terms of corporate giving partnerships
- Much of their fundraising is done by board
- Using a discovery platform would require an entire culture shift in how discovery is done
- Something that's been top of mind is opening lines of communication between funders and nonprofits, grantmaking is currently done in silos with little say from nonprofits
- 1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?
 - Executive director, 2 full-time employees, Meghan handles all administrative work, wears all the hats, valuation metrics, director of development, etc.
- 2. How do you currently attract and retain donors?
 - Board members, look to them to tap into their networks and connect with donors, individual and corporate, also engage people through volunteering, convert volunteers into donors
 - For corporations, have done limited sponsorships, look more for corporate partnerships than transactions, do that through connections with programs
 - Benevity, 1% for planet recipient, make sure they're part of those platforms
- 3. How do you get in touch with corporate partners? What size businesses are working with you on average?
 - A lot reach out to volunteer, or somehow be involved in the work
 - Big focus on corporations in CSR world to have volunteer opportunities for employees, so in person aspect is very helpful

- Do phone calling through 1% for the planet to let them know about the ways they can fulfill their obligation for that program
 - Corporate grants, submit proposal
 - Do a lot of network mapping, like who on their board might know a decision maker somewhere
 - Don't take size into consideration at all
 - Have always been surprised that smaller businesses are more generous or willing to partner
 - Larger ones tend to be more transactional rather than longer term invested partnerships
4. Do they want naming rights or recognition?
- Every application asks that but none require it for fulfillment
 - They want social media posts
 - Do site recognition for some capital projects that have been funded by corporate partners
 - Not usually a requirement
 - A lot ask about volunteer opportunities but few partake in it
5. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising?
- Benevity, a lot of corporations use that
 - Paypal giving
 - Candid, charity navigator, but those are becoming less relevant in recent years than they'd been
 - 1% for the planet
 - Have a social media presence, use instagram which automatically posts to facebook but they don't use it actively
 - Social media is not a fundraising tool
 - Newsletters via email
 - Very few mailing addresses
6. How much time do you spend fundraising?
- 20% of her time
7. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?
- Capacity, not having enough time
8. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes discovery? Why or why not?
- That's what charity navigator and candid was meant to be
 - Would require an entire culture shift in how discovery is done
 - Benevity is doing that on the corporate side
 - For GG it's just another platform that funders won't use because there's so much demand for grants
9. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?
- Something that's been top of mind is opening lines of communication between funders and nonprofits
 - They operate in silos
 - Grantmakers have all these events but no nonprofits are part of the conversation
 - Elements of how do we shift the whole culture of how philanthropy is done
 - Was recently part of large grantmaking initiative where nonprofits were selected to create a grant program through participatory grantmaking
10. How would you like to see that culture shift?
- Not really any ideas right now

Aya Kuratani, Liquid I.V.

Insights/Analysis:

- Giving is mostly in-kind donations of product
 - More about giving product and focusing on water access than volunteering
 - Ask for a quarterly distribution report from nonprofit partners
 - More interested in lasting relationship than transactional relationship
1. Can you tell me a bit about your role and your organization?
 - a. Associate project manager on impact team, manages in-kind, donate 15m servings of product per year, have a grants manager, supports her in partner relationship and management and grant cycle process,
 - b. Whenever there are impact related marketing projects, like impact report, world water day, she manages those projects from start to end, works with design and creative teams
 - c. Confluence is their signature program, makes them stand out, focused on domestic water access, year long network, bring together nonprofit orgs in US water space, currently 16, can be advocacy, legal, community engagement, provide them with grants, once a year bring a leader from each org to a summit, opp for leaders to connect, find opps to collaborate, manages that summit and supports network as a whole
 - d. Started with only in-kind donations, had 1-1 model, for every purchase one serving was donated, moved away from that model a few years ago, wasn't feasible to continue with that model
 - e. Have 4 strategic partners on in-kind side, 15m is sweet spot where they can support partners but not dumping excess product on them, focuses primarily on humanitarian and disaster relief responses, focused on clean water access
 2. What does volunteering and community engagement look like at your organization?
 - a. Don't do much on volunteer side with existing partners
 - b. As an impact team they want to make sure it's not just another volunteer day but want to make sure it's intentional
 - c. If they're bringing employees in want to make sure there's a clear connection
 - d. Do a beach cleanup once a year but that's with the people and culture team
 3. How does your organization approach volunteer management? Do you use a platform / tool?
 - a. If there's going to be volunteering, try to tap into existing relationships, opps usually come through Aya's team to see if there's an opp
 - b. Don't use a platform to manage volunteerism
 4. How do you currently find and select nonprofits to support? Does your organization select nonprofits to support based on the recommendation of your employees? Roughly, how much time do you spend searching and selecting? (weekly / monthly)
 - a. From in-kind side, have 4 partners, haven't changed over past four years, going into next year trying to bring on new partners and
 - b. Since they're focused on humanitarian relief and disaster response, follows that, checks Charity Navigator to make sure they're reputable
 - c. On grants side, do desktop research on orgs working on clean water access, focused on infrastructure, do both domestic and international
 - d. If they seem like a good fit, will get on a call
 - e. Have had nonprofits reach out directly
 5. What goes into the relationships with the nonprofits?
 - a. Emails with them throughout the year, gets on a call with them at the end of the year to see how the year has gone, any feedback, what their needs are for the following year, what is their ideal need for the following year
 - b. Sign a formal agreement before the end of the year
 - c. Always staying in contact throughout the year, open conversations

- d. Ask for a quarterly distribution report
- e. Bi-monthly check-ins with grantees, require midpoint and end of project report
- f. If there are challenges they don't have to wait till the report to find out about it
- g. Relationships are trust-based, don't dictate where product goes, trust partners to distribute product as they see fit, do have deliverables
- h. Want to make sure it's not just transactional
- 6. Does your organization match employee donations?
 - a. No matching
 - b. When the wildfires happened, company ran a donation matching program because it was close to home but that was a one-time situation
- 7. Employee-driven donations?
 - a. Always open to recommendations but have clear focuses
- 8. What challenges do you face in managing your CSR portfolio?
 - a. Partners are great to work with, challenges are internal
 - b. Produce product to give, not giving excess product, packaging is different from product getting sold, has oral rehydration designation on packaging, makes sure they're producing what they need
 - c. 1% of revenue goes toward impact program
 - d. Production date might get pushed back because sales are more important, work through that with internal team
 - e. If challenges come up they work through them with their partners
 - f. Try to be flexible with their nonprofit partners
- 9. How important is transparency and progress tracking in your giving decisions?
- 10. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes nonprofit discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not?
 - a. Charity Navigator, Guidestar
 - b. CyberGrants to manage in-kind donations
- 11. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with corporate giving?
 - a. Been a part of their DNA since company started
 - b. Having leadership that believes in the work is important
 - c. Is part of marketing team, when Aya started they were their own separate department, the change has allowed them to work better with marketing in terms of how they share with consumers
 - d. Having clear focuses helps too, has been to some social impact conferences, some challenges she hears is that when they get requests it's hard to manage because they don't have clear focuses, liquid IV has those clear focuses that allows them to evaluate opportunities more easily

Tanya Steinhof, Redwood Grove Wealth Management

Insights/Analysis

- Giving is employee driven
- 1. How does your organization currently approach corporate social responsibility (CSR)?
 - a. We try to live by the values outlined on our website and are a B Corp and member of One Percent for the Planet.
- 2. What does volunteering and community engagement look like at your organization?
 - a. We volunteer once a quarter as a team (most recently at the SF Marin Food Bank), but each of us also has our own volunteer commitments. Two of us are active members of our local industry association and I'm on a committee for it.

3. How does your organization approach volunteer management? Do you use a platform / tool?
 - a. No tool as we are a 3-person team. We use a spreadsheet to track all of our volunteer hours.
4. What types of causes or projects does your organization typically support?
 - a. Being a member of One Percent for the Planet, we are committed to donating 1% of revenue to environmental non-profits. We also support several organizations in the financial literacy and poverty areas. We volunteer for the Food Bank.
5. How do you currently find and select nonprofits to support? Does your organization select nonprofits to support based on the recommendation of your employees? Roughly, how much time do you spend searching and selecting? (weekly / monthly)
 - a. The last time we added nonprofits, we asked our employees what nonprofits they wanted to support. Others have come from client referrals or my own involvement. Sometimes we use Charity Navigator or similar sites to learn more
6. Does your organization match employee donations?
 - a. No
7. What challenges do you face in managing your CSR portfolio?
 - a. The biggest challenge is the onerous nature of the B corp certification process on a small firm like ours.
8. How important is transparency and progress tracking in your giving decisions?
 - a. We're transparent with the organizations we support, but don't really track the progress they are making on their stated goals.
9. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes nonprofit discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not?
 - a. No. Other than occasionally looking at Charity Navigator or similar sites. Just hasn't occurred to us to do so.
10. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with corporate giving?
 - a. It's important and I wish more companies committed to giving a portion of their revenue to nonprofits.

Alexiss Flores, The Wonderful Company

Insights/Analysis

- Giving is founder driven and one focus is on benefitting employees
1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?
 - CSR associate, main role is supporting COO and SVP of CSR, help with projects, grant review process, receive grant app or recommendation and present it to chairmen who will approve and then they can share a certain amount to the applier
 2. How does your organization currently approach corporate social responsibility (CSR)?
 - CSR is a main priority, Linda Resnick makes CSR priority, will email me videos, went to plants and met with employees and asked how they could help provide more resources for them, happy and healthy employees make company thrive more, when she saw where they needed help that's where CSR went into effect, education is a priority, employees for over 2 years are in Wonderful education program, goes from elementary to AA degree, can also lead to employment, took off in 2012, then wanted to prioritize health, have 5 clinics that provide employees and families with free healthcare, grant applications roll out in August, open till October, try to prioritize people who are in low-income, diverse communities, last year prioritized LA area due to wildfires, other than that it's usually in Central CA where their farms are, allot every employee one grant and they can submit an offer to any nonprofit, in January everyone has a new grant, can choose how much, Wonderful Neighbor hours are volunteer hours, can do on their own

- or as a team
3. What types of causes or projects does your organization typically support?
 - Create a brief overview of applications, have execs come to them with interest areas based on their own findings, other than that use grant application process, present to chairmen how grant will help the organization and what impact it will have, try to prioritize people who haven't received assistance or who are struggling to receive assistance, prioritize higher education and health, new initiative is people who have gone through domestic violence, so women's resources or shelters, can come from anywhere not just CA
 4. How do you currently find and select nonprofits to support? Roughly, how much time do you spend searching and selecting? (weekly or monthly)
 - Haven't had to seek out nonprofits since 2019, when they created the application process
 5. If they can't fulfill application one year, what happens?
 - Have a whole team dedicated to communicating with everyone who applies, try to make sure they create a real relationship with all applicants, teams in LA and Central CA to build those relationships, if not approved in first year they are encouraged to apply the next year
 6. How important is transparency and progress tracking in your giving decisions?
 - They do receive it but more due to the relationship rather than a requirement
 7. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not?
 - Use CyberGrants
 10. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with corporate giving?
 - Usually host an event twice a year in the LA office, around Christmas, able to meet a lot of the people they're able to help
 11. Would you be interested in participating in future testing or providing feedback on our platform?
 - Yes

Saxon Miller-Jones. *TreePeople*

Insights/Analysis

- Volunteering is pipeline to giving
 - Look for natural connections with donors
 - Storytelling is big part of attracting donors
 - Corporate giving is challenging because when contact leaves relationship changes
 - CSR people want to know how their giving compares to other corporate donors (gamification)
1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?
 - Director of Development, role is overview of development, specifically private revenue: individuals, corporate giving, planned giving, monthly giving; building infrastructure connecting mission with donors so they feel inspired
 2. How do you currently attract and retain donors?
 - Storytelling, tells stories in a digestible way, a lot of work in education and environmental spaces, dev synthesizes information and makes it digestible for average donor, leans on hope, especially being in environmental space, inspires people, cadence, making outreach regularly, everyone gives on their own timeline, being attuned to giving cycles
 3. How do you get in touch with corporate partners? What size businesses are working with you on average?
 - Research first, finding those they feel there is a natural connection with, capacity and inclination, just because they have a lot of money doesn't mean they're interested in

- supporting, making sure the juice is worth the squeeze, getting on an intro call, getting people to the park, events, capitalizing on events and park rentals that could transform into a larger relationship
4. Do you work with partners who just give and don't want to have a larger relationship?
 - Yes, with individuals as well, especially with DAFs, interest in not being contacted, always lets the donor lead the way
 5. Do they want naming rights or recognition?
 - Some do and some don't, some are super nonchalant, just want, for some their giving is completely tied to naming or sponsorship
 6. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising? How much time do you spend fundraising? Do you have a dedicated team for fundraising? Do you currently use a platform that centralizes discovery? Why or why not?
 - Direct mail, social media, mass emails, Classy just got bought by GoFundMe, newsletter, Facebook, LinkedIn especially for corporate donors, able to be unabashedly honest to the needs of fundraising on LinkedIn, more so than they can on something like Instagram, YouTube
 7. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?
 - Internal, not being afraid to ask for money, doesn't need to be so precious and such a big deal to ask for money, that is what the job is, if it's a cause worth asking money for people will understand, there is a lot of need out there in nonprofit space, there are a lot of great causes and it feels like there is so much going on and a lot of areas that need support, figuring out when and where and how to advocate for your cause, ex. During wildfires, they gave space for organizations that were involved directly in recovery, also had an obligation as one of the biggest environmental nonprofits in CA to highlight what they do, important to figure out the timing to make push and ask but also not shying
 8. What features would be most valuable to you in such a platform?
 - Ex. Facebook giving gives lump sum when it's convenient for them and that removes connection between TP and donor, best way would be to have personal connection with donor, looks like a platform where they can quickly move supporter to their own website so they'd make donation through website or make direct contact
 9. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?
 - Excited for TreePeople to expand in corporate giving area, tricky, ethereal
 - Complications is that they're always moving
 - When people move the relationships change
 - Using volunteer TFT program as pipeline to corporate giving
 - TP is nuanced being an environmental org, see heavy pushes in Earth Month, when corporations come out to support
 - Areas like greenwashing, how does TP stay true to what they do without losing the thread
 - Good job of strengthening pipeline of volunteering, having that be its own professional strategy and moving up to corporate sponsorship
 - Tiering out corporate sponsorship, incentivizing corporations to give more, be competitive
 - CSR people want to know how their giving compares to other corporate donors (gamification)
 - Corporations have their own initiatives, lets them lead the way and be the strong partner in them fulfilling their own goals
 - Struggles with putting a pitch deck or something so concrete on the website where it's the conversation where something will play out in cocreation
 - Corporate partnerships are nuanced, need to listen to what they want and are interested in and they can see how they can make dreams come true together

- Job to connect with donors and reflect their mission
- About creating long lasting relationships, takes time to build relationships
- Some of the best relationships have been built through trust building, proving they will be the best stewards of the donor's money

Abby Fuirst, Volunteer NY

Insights/Analysis

- Work with larger businesses mostly
 - Volunteering being a team building activity, they're competing more with happy hours than with other nonprofits
 -
1. Can you tell us a bit about your role and your organization?
 - Volunteer NY is nonprofit organization that is a matchmaker for nonprofits and volunteers, serves anywhere from high school students to seniors looking to volunteer, matches interest of volunteers with needs of nonprofits. Nonprofits can sign up for free, have 300 nonprofits signed up. Something like 50K volunteers mobilized every year. Part of Points of Light, a global organization, LA version is LA Works. Abby works with corporate partners. Biggest partner is Regeneron Pharmaceuticals. Sometimes work with ERGs, CSR employees, social impact employees. One of the programs is AmeriCorps who send out newsletter "from" Volunteer NY.
 2. What are the main goals and missions of your organization?
 - Connect corporate donors who want to volunteer with local nonprofit organizations.
 3. How do you currently attract and retain donors? What donations do you currently accept?
 - There's a donation attached to searching for volunteer opportunities, but can opt out. Corporations have minimum of \$2,000 or 20 people at \$100 each as an engagement fee, not tax deductible. Also receive donations as any other nonprofit would. Have a leadership program, 20 people each year. Some donors are people who have done that program, some is word of mouth, year end appeal, Giving Tuesday campaign, stuff around April breakfast, not many other direct appeals. Just got new Dev Director so some of this will change.
 - Started to go to Chamber of Commerce meetings, business councils, good amount is word of mouth, some businesses opt out once they see there is a fee. They do lose people due to fee. Struggle to bring in new donors.
 4. What size businesses are working with you on average?
 - Average is couple thousand of employees because there are some huge companies they work with, Morgan Stanley, PepsiCo, etc. 5-10 corporations that are 100 employees or fewer.
 5. What tools or platforms do you use for fundraising? How much time do you spend fundraising? Do you have a dedicated team for fundraising?
 - Not much social media for donation side. Recently switched to Classy, weren't aware of how many fees there were associated with Classy, encourage checks due to high fees. Not involved with things like Charity Navigator or Guidestar.
 6. What challenges do you face in gaining visibility and funding?
 - People sometimes don't see the value because they think they can go straight to the nonprofit, Volunteer NY is the middleman and that's their appeal. Usually an employee steps up to do the project but it's not part of their job, competing more against happy hour locations than other nonprofits.
 7. How do you manage donor relationships and communications?
 - Emails, calls, has meeting with corporations in new year to talk about what the year looks like. Morgan Stanley does a bunch of events in June for example that they talk about in January. Send suggestions of upcoming opportunities.

8. Do corporations set up their whole calendar at a certain point in the year?
 - Each corporate partner has a time when they are volunteering, most plan at the top of the year, some do it in different parts. Corresponds with their own fiscal calendars.
9. Do you currently use a platform that centralizes discovery, donation, and tracking? Why or why not?
 - Not to her knowledge, not involved in that side of things.
10. What features would be most valuable to you in such a platform?
 - Would probably be interested because of the interests of the new Dev Director
11. How do you handle tax documentation and reporting for your donations?
 - Not involved but manual process.
12. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with fundraising?
 - Get a good amount of money through city and state grants. Dev director's concern is that they're not getting individual donors. Issue they have is that they get used as a search engine without completing process.
13. Would you be interested in participating in future testing or providing feedback on our platform?
 - Yes.
14. Do you have any questions for us?
 - How would we approach matching donation from employers? Dive into Benevity and CyberGrants

Respondent Name	Title	Organization	Org Type	Key Themes
Warren Gorowitz	Director of Corporate Social Responsibility	Hunter Industries	Business	High volume requests, impact measurement, Benevity user
Max Bracey	Founder	Diver Sea Fy	Non-Profit	Grants focus, visibility challenge, would value local funding tool
Avery Edwards	Donors Relations Manager	Interfaith Community Services	Non-Profit	Uses GoFundMe Pro, emphasizes storytelling, ROI concerns
Olav Sorenson	Professor of Strategy	UCLA Anderson	Other	Centrality metrics, PageRank, simulations
Ryan Horne	Digital Research Specialist - GIS and Visualization	UCLA Anderson	Other	Clustering, brokerage, GIS storytelling
Fermin Nunez	Chef / Owner	Suerte	Business	Bandwidth limits, peer visibility valuable, local focus
Abbey Glauch, Sara Hale	Director Marketing / Dir Communications	Bitchin' Sauce	Business	In-kind giving, authenticity, scaling issue for cash
Lisa Rodman	CEO	Agua Hedionda	Non-Profit	Membership model, CRM system, chamber networking

		Lagoon Foundation		
Megha Poliki	Board Member	EduCare	Non-Profit	Resource constraints, credibility/verification needs, success-based pricing model

Paul Popon, InMarket

Summary

Logan Wood, an MBA student, conducted an interview with Paul Popon from InMarket to gather insights for a capstone project on charitable donations. Paul Popon explained InMarket's past use of Fidelity Charitable and their current direct donation process, emphasizing the verification of 501c3 organizations for both company-wide and employee-matched donations. Key discussion points included charity verification, the employee matching process, managing credit card fees and tax documentation, and fraud prevention through separation of duties.

Details

- MBA Capstone Project** Logan Wood is undertaking a capstone project for their MBA program at UCLA, which involves researching and developing a potential business idea. As part of this, Logan is conducting interviews and primary research, choosing to start with contacts at InMarket to gather insights into charitable donations.
- InMarket's Historical Donation Platform (Fidelity Charitable)** Paul Popon explained that InMarket previously utilized Fidelity Charitable for donations. This platform allowed preloading funds and restricted usage to only 501c3 organizations by requiring their federal ID, ensuring tax-deductible donations and preventing misuse of funds.
- InMarket's Current Donation Process** Paul Popon stated that InMarket now handles donations by direct contribution to charities using a corporate credit card, after receiving employee receipts for matching donations. This simplified approach was adopted as the company grew, allowing finance to manage the process directly.
- Company-Wide Donations and Employee Matching** Paul Popon confirmed that InMarket engages in both company-wide donations, often in response to major events like floods or fires, and employee matching programs. The company has made significant direct donations, such as \$15,000 for Texas floods, in addition to supporting employee-initiated charitable giving.
- Charity Verification and Donation Specifics** Paul Popon mentioned that InMarket verifies charities through the IRS tool to ensure they are registered 501c3 organizations, especially for company-wide donations, to ensure legitimacy and tax-deductibility. They added that large organizations like the Red Cross often allow donors to specify contributions to particular campaigns or general funds, or even local branches.
- Employee Matching Process** For employee matching, Paul Popon detailed that employees submit their donation information, including receipts, via a Google form,

which then populates a Google Sheet for matching. Employees are consistently reminded that only donations to 501c3 organizations are eligible for matching

- **Credit Card Fees and Tax Documentation** Paul Popon noted that many organizations ask donors to cover credit card fees, which InMarket considers depending on the amount. InMarket maintains receipts for all donations for their records and tax purposes, claiming deductions for the company's matched amounts. Employees are also advised to keep proof of their donations for their own tax deductions.
- **Tracking Donations and Communication from Charities** Paul Popon indicated that InMarket does not typically track the progress of projects after making a donation; this follow-up is generally left to the individual employee who initiated the donation. Paul also shared that charities often send frequent updates and solicitations via email and physical mail after a donation, which can be an annoyance due to the volume.
- **Potential Business Angles and Pain Points** Paul Popon suggested potential business opportunities in optimizing donation processes, such as saving on credit card fees or offering rewards for donations. Paul noted that a current pain point is the volume of communications received from charities, but otherwise, their direct donation process is quite convenient.
- **Fraud Prevention in Donations** Paul Popon emphasized the importance of separating duties within the donation process to prevent fraud and misuse of funds, such as having one person handle the charge and another process the expense report. This layered approach helps ensure accountability and prevents misappropriation, which is crucial for any business handling donations.

Logan Takeaways:

- Company does not have much direct need for project tracking or charity discoverability
- Individual employees do, and the current process for donation matching could be easier
 - Employee has to find and verify charity, make donation, get receipt, submit to IM (fill out Google form), get approved for match, IM makes matching donation
 - Inconvenient process, tax receipts are left up to the user
- IM used to use this platform through fidelity
 - <https://www.fidelitycharitable.org/giving-account/gift4giving.html>
- Allowed individuals to find charities
- Could preload with money, CEO used to preload, then other person has access to go make donations
- Good:
 - Can restrict people from misusing money
 - Can only use when inputting federal ID of 501c3 org
 - Then if you find it through the site you can donate money to them
 - Controlling for "fake" donations is a big bonus
- Bad:
 - Too much work to reach out to CEO and get money reloaded
- Now finance just looks at donations made by employees and matches by directly donating
-
- Other centralized solutions exist but are slow

- Charity navigator for example
- Took 3-4months to complete donation
- Only good if you want to donate to small charity who doesn't have online payment
- Some small ones need you to mail a check
- Currently primary channel of donation is employee matching, but IM also does some donations as a charity for big causes
 - Like big natural disasters
 - Usually goes straight to the charity
 - Occasionally client might have suggestion
 - Usually in response to large enough event that it's easy to find a charity handling
 - Big concern is making sure you're donating to reputable charities
 - IRS has tool where you can search charities to make sure they're legit: <https://apps.irs.gov/app/eos/>
 - When donating to large org's, they usually have different/multiple campaigns which you can specify your donation to. Also they have option for "general fund". Or you can pick a more local branch
- Employee match:
 - Currently using google form
 - Submit proof of donation, goes into google sheet, match and make donation manually
 - Many orgs have option to cover credit card fees when making a donation
- IM keeps receipt for our records. Goes into "donations" account, when KPMG does our taxes they take that total and then we have receipts if needed
 - When employee does taxes, they can just claim donation amount on taxes. Might get audited rarely, but generally kind of honor system
- Not much motivation to perform post-donation followups from the company standpoint
 - From employee standpoint, might be more motivation to follow up later and get more personalized updates
- Volume of post-donation charity email followups becomes annoying as donor
 - They often send physical followups too, paper receipts get to be a pain to deal with
 - **Waste of money and effort**
- Employee matching growing
- Saving on credit card fees could be big
 - If its cheaper to donate through a private company than the charity
 - Rewards
- Separation of responsibilities:
 - One person donates, another person checks receipt
 - Big point for business is preventing fraud/misappropriation of funds

Maston McMahon, Rivian

- Companies want programs that unlock volunteerism rather than create friction. The issue isn't lack of interest it's lack of coordination and permission structures.
- Internal challenge: getting clear approval pathways so employees know they're allowed to step away from work for volunteer activities.
- Practical question leadership struggles with: How do we communicate that taking two hours off to volunteer is not only acceptable but encouraged?

- Employee engagement depends on:
 - Standardizing messaging around volunteer policies.
 - Avoiding the perception that volunteering is a burden on team productivity.
 - Creating visible signals from leadership that participation matters.
- Decision-Maker Dynamics
 - Hard to identify who actually “owns” volunteer programs internally—HR, ESG, People Ops, Community Partnerships, or a random culture committee.
 - If a solution helps companies navigate internal org structures and get to the right approvals, it’s immediately valuable.
 - Consultative support is almost more important than the tool itself.
- Benevity: Mixed Experience
 - Cost Concern: “It’s too much money for what it does” was a recurring theme—budget is a constant friction point.
 - Lack of actionable support: They felt Benevity’s advice often boiled down to: “Cold call nonprofits yourself.”
 - Team response: Why are we paying for a platform if we still need to manually source opportunities?
 - Perception that Benevity offers a giant database, not a partnership.
 - Useful Component: Matching donations worked well—highly automated, simple, predictable.
 - Major gap: No help in identifying labor-based volunteer opportunities at scale.
- Core Problem: Employee Volunteer Demand vs. Nonprofit Capacity
 - Rivian has thousands of employees who want to participate, but the company can’t reliably find enough relevant, hands-on opportunities.
 - The only consistently available opportunities are:
 - Donation requests (nonprofits always want money).
 - Events that are easy but superficial (axe throwing, happy hours, etc.).
 - “Fallback” activities like beach cleanups feel like a facade of impact. Employees know it’s low-value but do it because nothing else is available.
 - Pain point: Nonprofits are stretched—many cannot manage large groups of volunteers, even when demand exists.
- Scaling volunteer events is difficult because:
 - Nonprofits don’t have capacity to host large groups.
 - Corporate teams don’t have the bandwidth to coordinate logistics across multiple locations.
 - There’s no structured marketplace for “volunteer-ready” opportunities.
 - Companies are willing to host events—but default to low-impact, turnkey activities when nonprofit coordination fails.

Michelle Woo, For Freedoms

Runs national arts organization

50% of job is fundraising

Works in field of arts and culture

Civic oriented

- Sometimes qualify for some democracy funding
- Philanthropy often siloed by field or discipline
- Not often that arts and culture funders are familiar with democracy orgs or vice versa
- Work in labor rights -> not familiar with the arts etc
- Fields very specialized
- Often recruit officers who are experienced in those fields
- Makes sense because they have to steward millions of dollars
- Need to make sure that the folks in charge of those dollars are connected to the most impactful people in those fields
- Fundraising very relationship based
- All about who you know, cultivating those connections
- Funders introduced to michelle by people she was close to
- Quite rare to be successful with a funder that she didnt know or wasnt introduced to
- Tries doing some cold calling, but generally rejected in those scenarios where they dont have a warm contact
- Would be interesting to have a tool that shows funders who they are connecting with, funders often staying in their own realm of contacts as well
- Most good program officers who are thinking more interdisciplinary/holistically about what support means, outreach starts with people they know and trust but try to ask them things like "who are you interested in?"
 - **Good officers field map**
 - **Would you mind introducing me to this person, that person?**
 - **Looking for trends, patterns**
 - **Want to identify when people are starting to look at a specific thing**
 - **Lots of field research involved**
- "We want to encourage multi year support, more often than not you're funded for a specific project because the funder finds it compelling at that moment"
- Hard to find multi-year dollars that allow you the freedom to innovate
- Get stuck in trap of funded for specific dollars
- **There isn't often transparency around leadership in nonprofit industry**
- **Hard to find out who is on the board: "we have to do our own research"**
- **Would be very valuable to provide this info and allow nonprofits to narrow in on trends**
- Also interesting from a DEI perspective
 - Org might tout diversity but not reflected on the board
- Good to know who you are really dealing with
- **Doesn't know of a platform that does this**
- Both focused on larger scale single donors *and* more grassroots outreach plays
 - Some funders are biggest orgs in the world: with them, focusing on unrestricted donations which allow them to be creative, focus on new ideas, think innovatively about how to sustain the business itself
 - Currently trying to figure out how to diversify revenue streams
 - 85% coming from foundations
 - Want to balance scale so not so dependent on one stream of funding
 - Usually works in campaign cycles. Funding follows political calendar
 - Use political events to try to excite/galvanize people into funding things
 - Often go to funder to try to get them to fund a specific initiative
 - "Give us 250k to build the project, then 250k more next year to actually do the project"

- "A lot of funders don't think of it this way, they think I just give you a pot of money and you go do it"
- In reality, you have to do a lot of pre work to get these projects ready to go which requires funds
- "Usually before we go out to folks, strategy is to look at who is funding you already. One person could already be funding you, but could still fund you for a different specific project"
- Have to pay a lot of attention to the overall scene: who's doubling down, who's pulling away, etc
- Michelle and team have been lucky in being successful with conventional marketing. Not because they invested a ton of money, but because they "are hustlers"
 - Tap journalists
 - Before coming into org, had a lot of press contacts already
 - Existing relationships with journalists
 - Could more organically get attention
 - Does retain PR firm
 - Has comm team who posts on social media, publishes newsletter etc
 - When gearing up a campaign, starts to go hard on press etc
 - Press attention has definitely helped with fundraising
 - Both giving legitimacy when going after funders proactively *and* getting more grassroots support as people discover them organically
- Biggest other pain points:
 - Most nonprofits have regular cadence of programming → there is a consistency to their activity
 - Michelle's team is primarily project based, all creatively driven
 - Often investors are investing in them as leaders and long term vision, don't always know how that is going to translate
 - **Hard to fundraise because its very chicken and egg: "show us what you're going to do and we'll give you money <-> give us money and we'll show you what we're doing"**
 - Funders want to know harder questions like "how many people are you trying to reach", and they often aren't there yet at the time of soliciting funds
 - Other nonprofits might have an easier time because they have a clearer/more regular mission statement and can just increment on top
- Most mission-based work has long term strategy: "thats not sexy. People want to see immediate impact"
 - Very difficult because most donations are one-off, and donors expect immediate "return"
 - Trap of only being able to do short term stuff for "spectacle", deeper work that actually needs investment gets put on the backburner because you have to do the splashy thing that convinces donors that you're having an impact
- **"If you guys did this for real we would pay for it in a second"**

Nick Jones, InMarket

Tech Sales:

Leads? Process? Time spent? Closing?

- Process depends on outcomes/use case

- First sales job was a PEO
 - JustWorks
 - Similar to ADP, a PEO is an HR software that helps small companies
 - Approaches small companies and says “we’re going to hire your full company, you keep control and they stay on our larger employee pool insurance plan”
 - Then they get a favorable rate on insurance b/c more employees, pass on savings to “employees”
 - “Professional Employer Organization”
 - Has a nice UI
 - Key to driving sales:
 - Could call and say “I know rates are X, I can get you rate Y”
 - Any sales job: what is the value prop?
 - For pairwell: sounds like “it’s a time suck”. Costing money to manage donations
 - Ask Airbnb/Vrbo how they solve disintermediation
- Idea: one-time fee
 - To address disintermediation
- Can we create value to build the market?
 - From sales perspective:
 - What am I saying when I call a company?
 - “Do you have a giving program?” or “you should have a giving program!”
 - Some companies do this. Can you *make* companies do this?
 - You have to create larger market by getting people to sign up
 - Going to have very long sales cycle, lots of approvers to get through
 - On a sales call, you need to get to a decision maker (DM)
 - Need to identify *who* is the decision maker at companies who *do* this and who *don’t* do this
 - Who needs to say yes to this? Value proposition impacts this. If value is taxes, CFO is going to have to look at it etc
 - What is ROI and timeline to ROI?
 - If I have to pay you in July and not going to get benefit until next tax season, that is a burn without a lot of return for a very long time
 - If it’s a culture thing, there are some people who will chase this
 - Tax benefit?
- **This is something that would fit into an HR management platform**
 - Could be potential exist: acquisition by an ADP etc
 - There is a “startup culture, we offer cool perks” aspect to it, but that doesn’t move the DM needles
- How does this manifest into bottom line profit? Need that value prop to businesses
- Need to talk to companies that do this already and talk about how it actually impacts their bottom line. “If you guys facilitate the giving of \$1M, how does that impact your bottom line?”
- Need to understand tax implications of giving
- Looks cool as employee perk, has intangible benefits, tangibly will reduce tax burden and give good PR/optics
- Look on glassdoor etc to see whether charity matching is a desirable perk
- Value prop for non-initiated: create a value
- For existing donors: they are familiar with benefit, touch on the other benefits “we will lessen hours required for donations → make more donations happen → increase writeoff”

- Interesting idea:
 - NPR fall funding drive happening rn
 - Member supported institution
 - "If we get 300 sustaining donors in the next two days, we will get an extra \$100k donation from the X foundation"
 - How do we approach foundations to sponsor events like this?

Bill Chertok, OneLegacy

OneLegacy

Key Takeaways:

- 1. Businesses often want to donate to get good PR. They want to be seen as doing good in the community and get publicity.**
 - a. Social recognition is key**
- 2. Nonprofits often struggle heavily with name recognition: they want people to be familiar with them**
 - a. Social recognition is key**
- 3. Nonprofits will be willing to pay because our platform is bringing the money to them**
- 4. Need to find additional value driver to get donors on board: they are the ones it will be harder to incentivize**

Challenges:

- No name recognition
- When people approached, challenge was to judge how they would show results. Very elusive to measure impact of marketing etc.
- "outfits that couldn't give us anything here we didn't consider:
- Bill works on the board of OneLegacy, a big organ donation organization
- At one point they attempted to launch a nonprofit arm
 - This struggled heavily because they got individual wealthy donors on board to gift money initially, but were unable to get any public fundraising going
 - "We couldn't raise any money because no one knew who we were"
 - Started down path to get publicity
 - New nonprofits want name recognition, good standing in community
 - So do for-profit organizations who want to donate
- OneLegacy now utilizing many channels for PR
 - Billboards
 - Events
 - Spectrum
 - Booths
 - Education: going into schools to discuss organ donation etc
 - Worked with legislation on DMV language
 - Spent \$2M funding project at UCLA to transfer stem cells to help with organ rejection, got it in contract that UCLA will mention OneLegacy whenever they talk about it
 - **Primary Goal: getting positively embedded in organ donation community**
 - **Underlying focus: name recognition**

- **Good for community as well: mutual benefit when nonprofit org successfully gets things done**
 - “Find companies who want to give back *and who want to be seen doing so*”
- Usually connect with external companies who are the experts in particular channels of outreach
- “It’s stunning how inefficient the current outreach organization is”
 - Had a huge event, brought in 15k people, turned out all of them were either recipients or had loved ones who were donors
 - Waste of outreach: no new eyeballs
- Process:
 - CEO, top of company put together plan for board
 - Board asks questions, approves
 - Board approves funding based on goalposts/checkpoints: “When this portion of the money is gone, where do we want to be?”
- “All nonprofits want to get their name out there and meet their relevant community”
- “If people have money to donate and are interested in getting their name out there, they will be willing to pay money for it”
 - Everyone is paying somehow: PR firms, opportunity cost of time spent soliciting donations, etc. Might as well pay that to a discoverability platform
- Businesses want good PR and to do good for the community. Bigger ones might start a nonprofit arm, but small-medium ones will have too much logistical trouble with this and would prefer to just donate a chunk of money. But they still want the recognition
- “Who’s paying the money?”
 - In Bill’s opinion, need to get the nonprofits on board to approach the donors
 - Nonprofits have no downside early on especially with free trial or no charge until donation occurs: why would they say no to extra discoverability?
 - Donors won’t be interested until there’s something to look at/some value to give to them
 - **Note:** could this value be provided in making it easy to track/organize/have social interactions around employee donations?
 - **“You’re bringing the money to the nonprofits: they won’t say no and will be willing to pay a fee”**
- Bill also recommended familiarizing ourselves with the various types of nonprofit organizations. He thinks this will go a long way towards presenting as experts and getting buy in
- Bill recommended that we reach out to local councilpeople and ask their staff about their preferred nonprofits, etc. He believes that local government loves being seen to do good for the community and would happily join on initiatives that allow them to freely publicize this, like “helping out a new platform that is helping nonprofits connect with their communities”

- Salesforce platform:
 - SF is overall business tool, enterprise resource planning solution
 - Foundationally was originally a tool to track sales
 - Led to better close rates, original value driver
 - Grew to encompass more different technologies
 - Datacloud incorporates many different platforms, data connections
 - Now comprehensive internal and external offering
 - Bought SteelBrick (?)
 - Can basically do anything in SF now
 - Org62: main SF, now linking up with Slack
 - Lots of end to end tracking
- Nonprofit identity
 - VTO: volunteering time off
 - Big dedication to charities, etc
 - People flying to Cambodia etc
 - Has internal tracking system
 - Quarterly performance evaluation includes how much volunteering you do
 - “One to one to one model”
 - 1% of time, 1% of revenue, 1% of products dedicated to charitable activities
 - For example letting NP’s use SF licenses for free (1% of products)
- [Salesforce.org](https://www.salesforce.org):
 - SF stuff but specifically for nonprofits
- Used to have “VolunteerForce”, now have Tableau dashboards that track volunteering
 - Can only see direct reports’ activity
 - Larger finance org
 - Lots of team meetings and always talking about **“how much impact our employees are having”**
 - Smaller scale meetings start to call out individual high performers to motivate them
 - Used to be using Salesforce, go into profile and look up events to track/log (can also create your own)
 - Logging hours, saving, etc
 - No one really auditing, just an honor system thing
 - Don’t need auditing because kind of scummy thing to lie about
- SF also provides grants to donate to NP’s
 - In order to do so, had to log a request, get it approved
 - Larger grants need higher level approvals
 - This happens at same place as the volunteering hours portal
 - A few thousand dollars were pretty easy to get approved, then SF automatically donates
- In “events”, can sign up for events, provide info, etc then market event around to other employees. Like a Facebook event, can get people to sign up and join
-
- VolunteerForce was better than newer iterations
- **SalesForce UI still entirely “pull” based**
 - Have to search for events, groups, etc

- Will proactively post in Slack etc “we’re gonna go do this tomorrow”
- Often going to do actual in person events with team
- “Super easy to get VTO in office because there’s always events happening, can just join in”

Interview: Barrett Helms

Sr. Engineer (SalesLoft, former)

Date: 11/13/2025

Team Composition & Roles

- Recommends 3 full-time backend engineers for a lean early-stage SaaS.
- Recommends 1 UX designer (FT or contract).
- Each team member needs:
 - MacBook Pro (M2 ~ \$2,000)
 - Cursor Ultra
 - Linear (project/issue tracking)
 - GitHub (version control)

Developer Compensation

- Senior engineer salary: \$140k–\$220k.
- Equity does *not* meaningfully offset under-market salaries for top talent.
- At SalesLoft: 8–10% annual raises typical.
- Recommends paying upper-midpoint of market to attract strong engineers.

Tech Stack Recommendations

- Backend hosting: Fly.io
 - More expensive than AWS/GCP but easier for small teams.
 - Future migration cost is a tradeoff.
- Database: Fly.io Postgres cluster
 - Recommended setup:
 - 3 small machines
 - 1–2 cores
 - ~2048MB RAM
 - ~40GB storage
 - Approx cost: ~\$150/mo.

Authentication & Compliance Tools

- Strongly recommends WorkOS / works.os for SSO + enterprise auth.
- WorkOS is fully SOC 2 aligned.
- Pricing may be usage-based and can become a meaningful cost center.

AI Usage Considerations

- Must track token usage per feature.

- AI costs scale quickly as user base expands.
- Early testing required to estimate actual cost per workflow.

SOC 2 Observations

- His company uses WorkOS heavily for SOC 2 compliance.
- Suggests exploring WorkOS + lightweight compliance tool vs. full automation platforms (Vanta/Drata).

Interview: Erin Eriksson

CSR Specialist (ex-Johnson & Johnson & M·A·C)

Date: 09/19/2025

CSR Structures at J&J

- ~15–20 HIV-focused grantee partners.
- Grants up to ~\$2M.
- Invite-only; no unsolicited proposals.
- Emphasized co-created programs with grantees.
- Mid-year and final reporting required.
- Provided capacity-building support (e.g., M&E evaluators).
- Intensive vetting and internal presentations for approvals.

CSR Structures at M·A·C

- ~600 grantees globally.
- Grants range \$1k–\$4M.
- Mix of:
 - Open-call rounds (housing, food/nutrition, harm reduction).
 - Targeted partnerships tied to ambassadors (Caitlyn Jenner, Miley Cyrus).
- Valued multi-year continuity but avoided being >X% of any org's budget.
- Systems progression:
 - CyberGrants → custom Salesforce → Benevity.

How Corporates Choose Partners

- Driven by:
 - Mission alignment
 - Leadership values
 - Consultation with subject-matter experts
- Used pillars such as:
 - Treatment linkage
 - Prevention
 - Basic needs (food, housing)

Impact & Reporting

- Both J&J and M·A·C emphasized:
 - Output metrics (people served, tests, treatments, meals, needles exchanged)
 - Qualitative stories

- Principle used: “No numbers without stories, no stories without numbers.”

Common Reporting Challenges

- Final reports not always completed.
- Staff turnover leads to missed emails.
- Data inconsistencies across grantees.
- System migrations cause data loss.
- Different orgs count “people served” differently.

Open Calls vs. Invite-Only

- Open calls increase access but increase workload.
- Invite-only allows deeper partnerships.

Willingness to Pay

- Corporates value good reporting and alignment.
- Nonprofits with limited capacity have the least ability to pay.
- Was unsure how much either side would pay for software support.

Interview: Nancy Himmelfarb

Corporate Sustainability & CSR Consultant

Date: 08/26/2025

Corporate Strategy Gaps

- Many companies have no coherent CSR strategy.
- CSR reports often contain “a mix of unrelated small initiatives.”
- Companies don't always know:
 - Why they give
 - How to choose partners
 - What outcomes they want
 - How to measure impact

Corporate–Nonprofit Mismatches

- Nonprofits prefer unrestricted funds.
- Companies want:
 - Custom volunteer experiences
 - Branded activities
 - Employee engagement programs
- Larger nonprofits can impose terms; smaller nonprofits must justify partnerships more.

Employee Engagement

- Central to CSR programs.
- Two models:

- Employee-choice
 - Curated options defined by the company
- Suggested hybrid model (company chooses themes; employees choose within them).

Reporting & Storytelling

- Companies need:
 - Clear metrics
 - Credible stories
 - Narratives aligned with corporate purpose
- Terminology shifts (CSR → Sustainability → ESG → Impact).

B Corps

- See them as:
 - More mission-locked
 - Less likely to cut partnerships
 - More stable long-term partners
- Good early target audience.

Suggested Tools/Frameworks

- Decision-tree filters for:
 - Geography
 - Beneficiaries
 - Issue areas
 - Exclusion criteria
- Templates for impact metrics and storytelling.

Interview: Bruce Nelson

Retired Executive, Museum Board Chair

Date: 08/05/2025

Corporate Giving Dynamics

- Large gifts often tied to CEO's or board member's personal causes.
- Corporate philanthropic budgets determined early; hard to redirect.
- Foundations rarely reach out; nonprofits must get on their radar.

Board Relationships

- Board "give/get" expectations drive introductions.
- Trustees provide access to corporate foundations.
- Warm introductions important; cold outreach rarely effective.

Trust/Efficiency Indicators

- Donors often look at:

- Overhead ratios
 - Guidestar / Charity Navigator ratings
- Some funders (e.g., Robin Hood) underwrite overhead to let donor contributions go “100% to programs.”

Corporate Volunteer Engagement

- Corporations use volunteer days for:
 - Team-building
 - Feel-good content
- These experiences often lead employees to become advocates.

Event-Based Fundraising

- Gala events can raise enormous amounts quickly.
- Example: Robin Hood gala raised \$34M in minutes through auctions.
- High-status experiences (e.g., backup singing with Aerosmith).

Marketing & Communication Pain Point

- Donors feel overwhelmed by excessive nonprofit outreach.
- Suggested software that:
 - Tracks donor communication preferences
 - Controls cadence, channels, and content types

Corporate Budgeting

- Some local managers have discretionary budgets.
- Corporate philanthropy budgets tied to:
 - Company profitability
 - PR strategy
 - Leadership preference

Interview: Gayle Northrop

Adjunct Professor, UCLA Anderson; Principal, Northrop Consulting

Date: 08/04/2025

Corporate Giving Landscape

- Motivations include:
 - Brand halo
 - Supply-chain value
 - Talent engagement
 - New market entry
 - Executive passion
 - Reputation management

CSR vs. CSV

- CSR: usually a budget-line item; vulnerable to cuts.

- CSV (Creating Shared Value): tied to core business; more durable.
- Shared examples:
 - Starbucks supporting farmers
 - Nestlé supporting agricultural production

Partnership Models

- Warby Parker → VisionSpring (one-to-one)
 - Complementary growth
 - Easy to pivot together
- Bombas (many partners)
 - High reach but complex management
- ViewSonic case
 - Cause-marketing effort via hot-air balloon; unclear impact.

Nonprofit Funding Volatility

- Shared Spark's experience with J&J:
 - One-year grant cycles
 - Staff turnover
 - Reorganization leading funder to pivot focus
- MAC example: lipstick campaigns led to variable funding year-to-year.

Target Segments

- Best early targets:
 - Mid-tier companies lacking CSR staff
 - B Corps with built-in mission alignment
- Large corporates have structured processes and less need.

Metrics Preferences

- Corporates typically want:
 - Output metrics (people served)
 - Not long-term system-change metrics

International vs. U.S. Differences

- U.S.: highly philanthropic culture.
- Canada/UK: more government-sponsored philanthropy; less corporate structure.
- Mentioned GIZ, FCDO equivalents.

Recommended Contacts & Cases

- Suggested:
 - Warby Parker case
 - Bombas
 - Group Elephant
 - Kurt Wieden's *Corporate Social Investing*
 - HBR's "Creating Shared Value"
- Potential contacts:

- Erin Eriksson
 - Kimberly Liszka (“Dog Tag Diaries,” Nike sponsorship)
- Suggested looking at B Lab registry for target companies.